

The Prop Firm Option

The prop-firm programmes worth trading under each firm's rules and the plan's compliance policies, optimised setting by setting and derived step by step: how much one person can expect per month, and the mathematics behind every number.

\$62,198 expected per month in the first year, one person, recommended plan

Expected values under a model of fair prices, for a trader with no predictive skill, under each firm's written rules as read on 4 October 2026. Firms may refuse payouts or apply behavioural rules at their discretion (Chapters 29 and 31). Not investment advice. Do not share or sell this plan: several firms close traders who run the same marketed strategy together.

Expected cash per month, one person

\$62,198

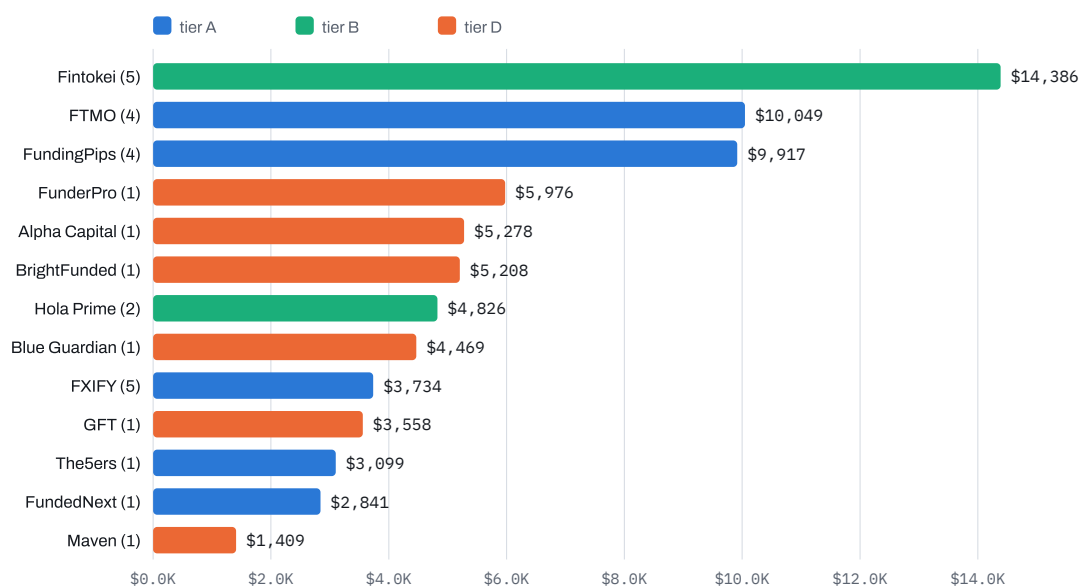
a month in the first year, $\pm$ \$2,116 (95%)

That is the expected cash, after the fees modelled (evaluation fees, activation and monthly fees, refunds and credits as each firm's rules give them; not taxes or payment costs), that one person receives per month in the *first year* of the recommended plan: 28 accounts at 13 prop firms, each traded with zero predictive skill under every rule of its firm that the model contains and the plan's own policies (flat every evening; no trade and no day above 40% of a target; at least 10 minutes between trades and no target or stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations; an account near its floor traded out with a last stop at the floor, so that it ends in a breach that frees its allocation). In 90% of simulated first years the total lies between \$96,538 and \$1,564,866 (median \$710,994).

\$70,488 Months 2–12 average (first year)	\$73,157 Average of months 13–36 of 36-month lives ($\pm$ \$1,974)	\$168,447 Value still to come at month 12 from accounts then open	\$74,751 Sum of the accounts' long-run rates (Part II)
\$42,403 If payouts are refused 2% / 5% / 15% by tier (Chapter 29)	\$28,593 If refused 5% / 10% / 30%	\$44,146 If every trading cost is twice the assumption	\$27,517 First year with only \$20,000 of starting cash
\$25,306 Tier A firms only (15 accounts)	\$41,571 Tiers A and B (22 accounts)	\$71,913 Every firm at its full modelled allowance (35 accounts)	\$68,223 Recommended + futures (53 accounts)

What changed from version 7

A second detailed review, of version 7, raised 27 findings (Appendix A); fixing them, and checking the corrected engine with new tests, found 16 further errors: n1–n7 in version 7, n8–n11, n14 and n15 in version 8's own first engine and checks, and n12, n13 and n16 in both. Every rule finding was checked against the firms' own pages and every model finding against the code. The figure moves from version 7's \$70,128 a month to \$62,198. The changes push in both directions. **Lower:** at FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, GFT, Hola Prime, Maven and Alpha Capital the daily loss limit is a share of the day's starting balance, so it shrinks after losses, and at FunderPro the stricter of its two possible bases is used; FXIFY Classic returns no fee; Maven needs three profitable days for every payout, and the plan keeps Maven's funded profit at or below \$4,900 so that its 50% rule (above \$5,000) never applies; Alpha's first payout needs five trading days; FunderPro Classic has minimum trading days; no position re-enters within 10 minutes of a close; no target or stop is closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations; and every trade is now decided, and its result counted, on the day it opens, and a payout no longer restarts the day's caps (versions 7 and 8's first engine let some days exceed the 40% cap and GFT's day cap, n12 and n13). **Higher:** Hola Prime's 40% rule belongs to on-demand payouts, not the bi-weekly option; Fintokei's and GFT's minimum payouts were overstated; an account near its floor is now traded out (a small chance to recover) instead of abandoned. **Neither way by construction:** the random numbers of every stage and market are now independent streams, the paths have one-minute sub-steps, and micro futures are valued at the path's price. Programme by programme (Chapter 9.4), 19 of 24 chosen settings are below their version 7 value by more than their interval, 0 above it, and the rest within it. The figure is a new measurement under the corrected rules, not version 7's plus a list. Version 6's \$138,412 rested on bold play, which several firms forbid; version 7 replaced it with the 40% policy.



Long-run value per month by firm in the recommended plan (number of accounts in brackets): each account's renewal–reward value on fresh paths. Colour: reliability tier (Chapter 29).

Where it comes from

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month per account (95%)	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	A	Nasdaq	4 × 100K	1.5% / 8 / 0.75 / 20%	\$2,512 ± \$217	\$10,049
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	A	USDJPY	4 × 100K	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 20%	\$2,479 ± \$287	\$9,917
The5ers HS Classic	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.5% / 10 / 0.75 / 30%	\$3,099 ± \$216	\$3,099
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,097 ± \$159	\$2,097
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 50K	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$936 ± \$81	\$936
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 25K	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$458 ± \$41	\$458
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 10K	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$173 ± \$17	\$173
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 5K	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$71 ± \$9	\$71
FundedNext Stellar	A	EURUSD	1 × 200K	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 20%	\$2,841 ± \$310	\$2,841
Fintokei ProTrader	B	Nasdaq	5 × 100K	1.75% / 10 / 1 / 20%	\$2,877 ± \$199	\$14,386
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	B	gold	2 × 100K	1.75% / 6 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,413 ± \$210	\$4,826
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	\$5,278 ± \$415	\$5,278
FunderPro Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 8 / 1.07 / 30%	\$5,976 ± \$426	\$5,976
GFT Standard	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 3.5 / 1.07 / 15%	\$3,558 ± \$231	\$3,558
BrightFunded Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$5,208 ± \$518	\$5,208
Blue Guardian 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 15%	\$4,469 ± \$324	\$4,469
Maven 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.5% / 3 / 1 / 4.9%	\$1,409 ± \$82	\$1,409
28 accounts at 13 firms						\$74,751

Risk / k / m / X: risk per trade and payout target as a share of the account, reward-to-risk, stop in hourly standard deviations. Per-account values are long-run rates from sixteen fresh paths; their sum (\$74,751) is a different quantity from the first-year average (\$62,198), see 8.5.

What the number means, and what it does not

- It is an **expected value under a model**: the average over many possible years if prices are fair random walks with the measured volatility and costs. The ± is the simulation's precision, not a range for real income.
- It assumes **zero skill**: the value comes from the contract (a capped loss, a share of gains), not from predicting prices.
- It assumes the firms **pay as their rules say** and do not judge the plan's trading to break their behavioural rules (Chapter 31.2). The refusal scenarios above price random refusals only.
- It assumes every slot is **refilled at once**, which needs cash for fees; with a finite budget the first year is lower (Chapter 28.7).
- It is **per person**: every firm limits what one person may hold. Accounts in anyone else's name are not allowed and are not in the plan.

How it was found

1. Part I derives every formula and says which model it is exact for; the exact chain of 5.5 implements the plan's actual rule near the floor. tests_v8.py checks every new rule mechanism of the engine directly (Chapter 11).
2. Every programme's settings (risk, *k*, stop, payout target, market) were searched over 10,857 grid settings and 397 refined ones (28 million simulated attempts), then re-measured on sixteen fresh paths each.
3. The engine was checked against the chain with the daily rules switched off (Chapter 11), and the rules' own effect measured with them on.
4. The accounts were run together, one person at a time, each simulated life on its own new paths: 8,400 first years, 800 three-year lives, and the budget and stress scenarios.

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Notation and conventions

Symbol	Meaning
S	account size
F	fee per attempt
A, A_1, A_2	profit target of a phase
B	maximum loss of a phase (distance to the floor)
b	safety buffer above the floor (\$100 per \$100K)
d	daily loss limit
D	funded allowance
α	profit split
R	fee refund
X_1, X	funded payout target: first, later
L, l	risk per trade: the plan's, and the one actually used
k	reward-to-risk setting
w	net win of a trade, after caps and costs
c, ρ	round-trip cost of a trade; per dollar of risk, $\rho = \kappa / (m\sigma)$
σ	hourly standard deviation of the log price
m	stop distance in hourly standard deviations
N	notional of a position, $l / (m\sigma)$
κ	round-trip cost as a fraction of the notional
λ	leverage (1: λ)
p	win probability of one bracket
P, P_1, P_2	pass probability
q_1, q	probability that a funded cycle reaches its payout target
X_{end}	balance at which an attempt or account ends
V, C, T	value of an attempt, funded cash, duration
K	expected total cost of a phase or cycle
EV/month	$30.44 \mathbb{E}[V] / \mathbb{E}[T]$ in days, a long-run rate

Money is in US dollars. A 100K account is \$100,000 of simulated capital. $\pm$ is a 95% Monte Carlo interval under the model. "Fresh paths" are synthetic price paths that played no part in choosing the setting they measure. "Engine" is the rule-by-rule simulation; "chain" the exact trade-level equations; "Brownian" the continuous approximation. Tiers A, B, D are the firms' reliability classes (Chapter 29).

The mathematics, from zero

Every result in this document follows from a handful of facts about fair games. This part derives each of them, says exactly which model each formula is exact for, and works the numbers of the plan through at every step. Where a formula is an approximation it is labelled as one, and the engine (the rule-by-rule simulation) supplies the figure that is used.

What is being bought

A proprietary trading firm ("prop firm") sells an *evaluation*. You pay a fee, you trade a simulated account under written rules, and if you meet the profit targets without breaking a loss limit, the firm gives you a *funded* account. On the funded account you keep a share of every profit you withdraw, and the firm absorbs every loss. You never owe the firm money beyond the fee.

That last sentence is the whole opportunity. Your downside is capped at the fee, and your upside is a share of profits that, as Chapter 7 shows, have a positive expected size even when every trade is a coin flip. The contract is an *option*: you pay a premium (the fee) for the right to keep part of the gains of a game whose losses fall on someone else.

1.1 The parts of the contract

Symbol	Meaning	FTMO 2-Step 100K, as an example
S	account size (simulated money)	\$100,000
F	fee for one attempt	€540 = \$607.82 at 1.1256
A_1, A_2	profit targets of phase 1 and phase 2	\$10,000 and \$5,000
B	maximum loss: the floor sits B below the starting balance and never moves ("static")	\$10,000
d	daily loss limit, measured from a reference level set at each day's reset	\$5,000
D	maximum loss on the funded account (the "allowance")	\$10,000
α	your share ("split") of every profit withdrawn	80%
R	fee refund, paid with the first payout	\$607.82
—	minimum trading days, payout cycle, other rules	4 days per phase; payouts every 14 days

1.2 The value of one attempt

Call the cash an attempt brings you V . It is the fee (always paid), plus, if both phases are passed, whatever the funded account pays out (the refund included):

VALUE OF ONE ATTEMPT

$$V = -F + \mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\} \cdot C, \quad \mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass}) \cdot \mathbb{E}[C \mid \text{pass}]$$

Here $\mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\}$ is 1 if both phases are passed and 0 otherwise, and C is the total cash from the funded account. Where a firm returns part of the fee as non-cash credit when a phase is passed (The5ers), that credit is a third term, counted separately from cash (Chapter 14).

1.3 The whole argument in five lines, in an idealised model

Before the details, the result in its simplest form: no trading costs, every phase ending exactly at its target or its floor, and payouts of a fixed cycle target X from a static allowance. Chapter 5 proves that a fair game reaches $+A$ before $-B$ with probability $B/(A+B)$ in that model; Chapter 7 proves that a funded account then withdraws on average exactly D before it is lost, and reaches its first payout with probability $q = D/(D+X)$. The refund comes only with that first payout, so it is weighted by q :

FTMO 2-STEP, ZERO COST, ZERO SKILL, IDEALISED

$$\Pr(\text{pass}) = \frac{B}{A_1 + B} \cdot \frac{B}{A_2 + B} = \frac{10,000}{20,000} \cdot \frac{10,000}{15,000} = \frac{1}{3}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass})(\alpha D + q R) = -632 + \frac{1}{3} \left(8,000 + \frac{10,000}{10,000+X} 632 \right)$$

At the version 6 fee of \$632 this is \$2,140.00 with a cycle of $X = \$10,000$ and \$2,087.33 with $X = \$30,000$; version 6 printed \$2,245, which counts the refund on every pass and is only the limit as $X \rightarrow 0$. At the correct fee of \$607.82 and $X = \$10,000$ it is $-607.82 + \frac{1}{3}(8,000 + 303.91) = \$2,160.15$.

Everything else in this document refines this number: trading costs lower it; the plan's policies (flat every evening, at most 40% of a target from one trade or one day, at least 10 minutes between trades, targets and stops at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations from the entry, and a last trade with its stop at the floor when an account has too little room left) change both the value and the time; and the settings are then chosen to make the most of it per month and per person. The sign is already visible here; its size needs the full engine.

1.4 Why the firm still makes money, and what that implies

The firm's revenue is the fees of everyone, and most traders are not zero-skill traders with a plan built around the contract: they over-trade, break rules, abandon accounts and stop after one failure. A plan that treats the contract as a mathematical object and repeats it many times is the case the firm's pricing does not cover. Firms know this, and their terms contain behavioural rules (against "gambling", "all-in" trading, one-trade target attainment, account rolling) that are written broadly and applied at their discretion. The plan is built to meet every rule that can be stated as a condition on trades, and Chapter 31 lists the behavioural rules that cannot, firm by firm, as conditions under which the figures here apply.

The probability toolkit

Seven ideas carry the analysis. Each is stated with the conditions it needs.

2.1 Expected value and linearity

A random quantity X that takes values $x_1, x_2, \dots$ with probabilities $p_1, p_2, \dots$ has expected value $\mathbb{E}[X] = \sum_i p_i x_i$. For any random quantities, dependent or not,

$$\mathbb{E}[X + Y] = \mathbb{E}[X] + \mathbb{E}[Y], \quad \mathbb{E}[cX] = c \mathbb{E}[X].$$

Linearity says that the expected cash of many accounts *over one horizon, under one policy* is the sum of their expected cash over that horizon, however strongly they move together. It does not say that a first year's average equals a long-run rate (they are different quantities, Chapter 8.5), and it does not make correlation irrelevant: correlation leaves the sum of the means alone and changes everything else (the spread, the cash needed for fees, the chance of many failures at once).

2.2 Variance

$\text{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[(X - \mathbb{E}X)^2] = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - (\mathbb{E}X)^2$. For independent X, Y variances add; for dependent ones a term $2 \text{Cov}(X, Y)$ is added. Variance enters the time a fair game takes (Chapter 8) and the confidence intervals of every simulated figure.

2.3 Fair games and martingales

A sequence of balances $X_0, X_1, \dots$ is a *martingale* if $\mathbb{E}[X_{n+1} | X_0, \dots, X_n] = X_n$. "Zero skill" means this for the balance before costs: the price is a martingale, the balance is a sum of positions times price changes, and no rule for direction, size or timing that uses only the past can change that. With costs the expected next balance is lower by the cost: a *supermartingale*.

2.4 Stopping times and the optional stopping theorem

A *stopping time* τ is a rule for when to stop that uses only information available at the time. The *optional stopping theorem*: if X is a martingale, τ is almost surely finite, and the stopped process $X_{n \wedge \tau}$ is bounded (or, more generally, uniformly integrable), then

$$\mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = X_0.$$

Each use below states why the condition holds. For one phase it holds because the balance stays between the floor and the target plus one win. For a funded account whose profits are withdrawn the balance plus everything withdrawn is *not* bounded, so Chapter 7 applies the theorem to one payout cycle at a time, where it is.

2.5 Wald's identity

If the steps $Y_1, Y_2, \dots$ are independent and identically distributed with finite mean μ , and τ is a stopping time with $\mathbb{E}[\tau] < \infty$, then $\mathbb{E}[\sum_{n \leq \tau} Y_n] = \mu \mathbb{E}[\tau]$. Having the same *unconditional* mean at every step is not enough: with $Y_1 = \pm 1$ equally likely, $Y_2 = -Y_1$, and stopping after the first step if $Y_1 = +1$ and after the second otherwise, every step has mean 0 but the stopped sum has mean $\frac{1}{2}$. The form used here is the martingale one: if the *conditional* mean of each step given the past is $-c_n$ (a cost known when the trade is placed), the conditional absolute means are bounded and $\mathbb{E}[\tau] < \infty$, then $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau - X_0] = -\mathbb{E}[\sum_{n \leq \tau} c_n]$, because $X_n + \sum_{i \leq n} c_i$ is a martingale with bounded increments in mean and optional stopping applies. Every trade of the plan has conditional mean minus its own cost given everything before it (4.3), so this holds even when the cost varies from trade to trade.

2.6 Brownian motion

The continuous-time limit of a fair random walk is Brownian motion W_t : it starts at 0, has independent increments, and $W_{t+h} - W_t$ is normal with mean 0 and variance h . A process $X_t = \mu t + \sigma W_t$ has three martingales that carry the approximations of Chapters 5 and 8:

$$X_t - \mu t, \quad (X_t - \mu t)^2 - \sigma^2 t, \quad \exp\left(-\frac{2\mu}{\sigma^2} X_t\right).$$

The third follows from Itô's formula: $de^{\lambda X} = e^{\lambda X}(\lambda \mu + \frac{1}{2} \lambda^2 \sigma^2) dt + (\dots) dW$, whose dt term vanishes for $\lambda = -2\mu/\sigma^2$. These formulas are exact for Brownian motion; applied to a sum of bracket trades, which jump, they are approximations (5.2).

2.7 The reflection principle

For a Brownian path from a to b over a time with variance v , the chance that it rose above $y \geq \max(a, b)$ in between is

$$\Pr(\max \geq y | a \rightarrow b) = \exp\left(-\frac{2(y-a)(y-b)}{v}\right).$$

This gives the *marginal* distribution of the maximum of a bridge (and, by symmetry, of the minimum). The maximum and the minimum of one bridge are dependent, and the marginal alone does not say which of a high and a low level was touched first. Section 3.3 bounds the error of drawing them independently.

The price model

3.1 Hourly volatility

Over one hour the log price changes by a random amount with standard deviation σ , the *hourly volatility*, measured on two years of real hourly bars (Yahoo Finance, 2024–26, only hours that follow another trading hour):

Market	Price, 2 Oct 2026	Hourly σ	Daily σ	Round-trip cost κ	κ/σ	Entry hours used (UTC)
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0064%	0.023	01–18
USDJPY	157.83	0.1193%	0.58%	0.0051%	0.043	00–18
EURUSD	1.126	0.0853%	0.42%	0.0062%	0.073	07–18
gold (XAUUSD)	4,176.80	0.2838%	1.36%	0.0108%	0.038	01–18
micro Nasdaq futures (MNQ)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0027%	0.010	01–18

σ : standard deviation of hourly log returns on 2024–26 data (sigma_v32.json); daily = hourly $\times \sqrt{23}$ (indices, gold) or $\sqrt{24}$ (currencies). κ : spread + commission + slippage allowance as a fraction of the notional, per round trip (calibrate.py). κ/σ is the cost of one hourly standard deviation of movement. Entry hours: the market's hours, cut at 19:00 UTC by the daily flat (no entry from 19:00, everything closed at 20:00).

Over h hours the standard deviation grows like $\sigma\sqrt{h}$: the Nasdaq moves about 1.31% in a 23-hour trading day. Every stop in the plan is a multiple of σ , so the same rules fit every market.

3.2 Zero drift, stated precisely

The model gives the *price* no expected change: $\mathbb{E}[P_{t+h} | P_t] = P_t$. That is the zero-skill assumption, and it is a modelling choice, not a theorem. For the price itself to be a martingale, the log price must drift down by $\sigma^2/2$ per hour (about 0.0004% for the Nasdaq): $\log P_{t+h} - \log P_t$ is normal with mean $-\sigma^2 h/2$ and variance $\sigma^2 h$. The Nasdaq's real long-run rise (about 0.0025% per hour, a hundredth of σ) is left out. Version 7 justified that by saying the plan is long and short equally often; equal counts do not settle it, because the drift's effect depends on the signed exposure over each trade's holding time. In the model the direction of every account's first position is chosen by a rule that is symmetric in up and down moves, so, with the price a martingale, a real drift would add its effect to longs and subtract it from shorts in expectation; the plan's results are therefore stated for the zero-drift model, and a real drift is one of the things that could make them wrong (Chapter 31.6).

3.3 Synthetic paths

- Each hour is split into 60 one-minute sub-steps of normal increments of the log price with variance $\sigma^2/60$ and mean $-\sigma^2/120$ (version 7: 12 five-minute sub-steps).
- Within each sub-step, the highest and the lowest point are drawn from the exact marginal distributions of a Brownian bridge between the sub-step's end points (2.7):

$$\max = \frac{1}{2} \left(a + b + \sqrt{(b-a)^2 - 2v \ln U} \right), \quad U \sim \text{Uniform}(0, 1),$$

and the minimum is the mirror image with an independent draw. Each is exact on its own; drawing them independently is not exact jointly, because a bridge that rises far is a little less likely to fall far as well.

- When a stop and a target both fall inside one hourly bar, the engine replays that hour's sixty sub-steps in time order and takes the level the path touched first; it also uses the exit minute for the 10-minute gap between trades (10.4) and for the trade's duration. Only if both levels fall inside the *same* one-minute sub-step does it fall back to the trade's overall fair chance, which is not the right conditional probability.
- How large the error can be.** The independent draw and the fallback differ from an exact Brownian path only on sub-steps whose path reaches both the stop and the target of an open trade. If the bracket has log-width W and a sub-step has variance v , the independent draw gives that event probability at most $e^{-2[(u-a)(u-b)+(a-\ell)(b-\ell)]/v} \leq e^{-W^2/v}$ (with end points a, b inside the bracket, the exponent is smallest when both sit at its middle), and the exact bridge gives it at most the chance that the sub-step's range exceeds W , which is smaller still. With one-minute sub-steps and a stop of m hourly standard deviations, $W \geq m\sigma$ and $v = \sigma^2/60$, so the error is at most e^{-60m^2} per minute of a trade: 4×10^{-10} at the plan's smallest stop of 0.6, 2×10^{-15} at 0.75. The engine adds this bound up over every simulated trade (Chapter 11). Within it, the construction is exact.
- Markets that close at weekends are closed in the path from Friday to Sunday, but the price keeps moving underneath, so Monday can open with a gap. Under the plan's daily flat (6.5) no position is open then.
- Random streams.** Every path is drawn from its own stream of random numbers, a numpy SeedSequence keyed by the path number, the market group, the length, the sub-steps per hour and the correlation. Each stage has its own path numbers: the grid search 101–104, the refinement 111–114, the final value of every chosen setting 121–136 (sixteen paths), the sensitivities 141–144, the checks 401–6131, the rule tests 901, and the portfolio simulation one new path number per simulated life (100,000 and up; 300,000 and up for three-year lives). Gold, USDJPY and EURUSD use the life's number with their own key, so their paths are independent of the Nasdaq and of each other. Version 7 gave other markets offset numbers (+50, +60, +70), which made, for example, gold's validation paths reuse the random numbers of yen's search paths; streams_v8.py lists every stream of every stage and checks that no two independent stages share one (stream_manifest_v8.json). The Nasdaq CFD and the micro Nasdaq future share one stream on purpose: they follow the same index. Chapter 28 measures what a correlation of 0.3 between all four markets changes.

3.4 What the model leaves out

Real prices have volatility that changes (calm and wild months), fat tails, jumps at news, and spreads that widen at the daily break and around releases. The plan's stops and targets are at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations from the entry, so that average costs are a fair description and no trade is a scalp, and the cost stress tests of Chapter 31 double every cost. The synthetic model is the right tool for the question asked (what is the contract worth to a trader with no edge), not a forecast of any particular year.

The bracket trade

Every trade in the plan is a *bracket*: one position with a stop-loss and a take-profit attached the moment it opens, never moved, and closed at the latest at 20:00 UTC the same day.

4.1 Set-up

Open a long position at price e with notional N dollars (a short is the mirror image), stop a fraction s below the entry and target a fraction u above. The plan fixes three things and derives the rest:

- the **risk** l : what a stopped trade loses before costs. Normally $l = L$ (1–1.75% of the account, searched in Chapter 9), but never more than the room left, net of the trade's own cost (5.4);
- the **stop distance** $s = m\sigma$: m hourly standard deviations;
- the **win** w the trade nets after costs if it reaches its target: $w = \min(\max(\min(kl, \text{distance to the target}), w_{\min}), \text{caps})$, where k is the reward-to-risk setting, the caps are the plan's 40% concentration policy (6.7) and any firm cap, and $w_{\min} = l(0.6/m - \rho)$ keeps the take-profit at least 0.6 hourly standard deviations from the entry (a target closer than that is reached a little past it). If a cap leaves less than $w_{\min}$: with nothing made yet that day, the risk is lowered until the cap is a full minimum-distance win (a small payout target, Maven's ceiling), never below one futures contract; with profit already made that day, no further trade until tomorrow.

POSITION AND TARGET

$$N = \frac{l}{s}, \quad Nu - c = w \Rightarrow u = \frac{s(w + c)}{l}.$$

A win pays $+w$ and a loss costs $-(l + c)$, where $c = \kappa N$ is the round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage allowance) of this position.

4.2 The win probability

The price is a martingale and the trade ends at the first touch of the stop or the target. If nothing else can end it and fills are exact, the exit price is bounded, so optional stopping (2.4) gives $pe(1 + u) + (1 - p)e(1 - s) = e$, i.e. $p = s/(s + u)$:

WIN PROBABILITY OF A ZERO-SKILL BRACKET (FIXED COST, EXACT FILLS)

$$p = \frac{l}{l + w + c} = \frac{1}{1 + w/l + c/l}.$$

4.3 The mean and the variance of one trade

With outcomes $+w$ (probability p) and $-(l + c)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[\text{pnl}] &= pw - (1 - p)(l + c) = \frac{lw - (w + c)(l + c)}{l + w + c} = -c, \\ \text{Var}(\text{pnl}) &= p(w + c)^2 + (1 - p)l^2 = l(w + c). \end{aligned}$$

These hold for the binary trade of 4.2 with a cost known at entry. Two things in the plan make some outcomes non-binary. A trade still open at 20:00 UTC is closed at that hour's price, somewhere between stop and target; the price is still a martingale and the closing time a bounded stopping time, so the mean is still $-c$, but the variance is smaller and the distribution has three parts. And a price that gaps through a level fills at the gap. The engine simulates both; the chain of Chapter 5 uses the binary trade.

4.4 What a trade costs

The round-trip cost is a fraction κ of the notional, so per dollar of risk

$$\rho \equiv \frac{c}{l} = \frac{\kappa N}{l} = \frac{\kappa}{m\sigma}.$$

Market	ρ at $m = 0.6$	0.75	1.0	1.25	at cost $\times 2$, $m = 0.6$	$m = 1.0$
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	3.90%	3.12%	2.34%	1.87%	7.79%	4.68%
USDJPY	7.12%	5.70%	4.27%	3.42%	14.25%	8.55%
EURUSD	12.12%	9.70%	7.27%	5.82%	24.24%	14.55%
gold (XAUUSD)	6.34%	5.07%	3.81%	3.04%	12.68%	7.61%

The round-trip cost in units of the risk, $\rho = c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$, for stops of m hourly standard deviations. The plan holds nothing through a daily reset, so there is no financing to add (version 6 paid up to 16% of the risk per night held at a tight Nasdaq stop).

Version 6 held winning trades through nights and paid overnight financing φN per rollover, a cost that is random (it depends on how long the trade lasts) and was not in the formulas. Versions 7 and 8 hold no position through a daily reset (6.5), so there is no financing to add, and ρ is the whole cost.

4.5 The plan's trade on the Nasdaq, worked through

The plan's FTMO setting is risk $L = \$1,500$ (1.50% of \$100,000), a stop of $m = 0.75$ hourly standard deviations, $k = 8$ and a payout target of \$20,000. The first trade of phase 1 aims at $w = \min(kL, A, 0.4A) = \min(\$12,000, \$10,000, \$4,000) = \$4,000$. With the Nasdaq at 31,070:

Stop distance: $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price, i.e. 63.8 index points.

Notional: $N = l/s = \$730,758$, i.e. \$23.52 per index point. If one lot is worth \$1 per point (read the contract specification), 23.52 lots, rounded down.

Cost: $c = \kappa N = 0.0064\% \times \$730,758 = \$46.77$, so $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$.

Target: $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.2053\% \times 4,046.77/1,500 = 0.5538\%$, i.e. 172.1 points from the entry.

Win probability: $p = l/(l + w + c) = 1,500/(1,500 + 4,000 + 46.77) = 0.2704$.

Mean $-c = -\$46.77$; check: $p w - (1 - p)(l + c) = -46.77$. Variance $l(w + c) = 6,070,153$, standard deviation \$2,464.

Margin at 1:50: $N/50 = \$14,615 = 14.6\%$ of the starting balance; the engine re-checks it against the current balance at every entry (10.2).

Duration (8.1, approximate): $m^2(w + c)/l = 1.52$ hours of open market on average; losers 1.20 h, winners 2.38 h. A trade still open at 20:00 UTC is closed there.

On the funded account (payout target \$20,000) a full win is $\min(kL, X, 0.4X) = \$8,000$: take-profit 342 points away, $p = 0.1571$, winners 7.4 hours of open market on average, so some are cut by the daily flat and some wait for the next day's cap. No take-profit is ever closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations (51 points): a target closer than that is reached a little past it.

4.6 Ways a simulation can flatter a trade

1. **Skipping the entry bar.** Checking levels only from the next hour ignores stop-outs inside the entry hour. (Measured in version 4: +0.14 R per trade, all fake.)
2. **Sampling prices too rarely.** A few prices an hour miss touches in between, and the nearer level (the stop) is missed more often. The bridge extremes of 3.3 remove it.
3. **Ties inside one bar.** When one bar's range contains both levels, the bar alone does not say which came first. Version 5 used the fair chance; versions 6 and 7 replay five-minute sub-steps; version 8 replays one-minute sub-steps, and the remaining error is bounded in 3.3.
4. **Gaps.** A price that opens beyond the stop fills at the open. Under the daily flat there is no overnight or weekend position to gap.
5. **A rounding error at the target.** A win sized to close the gap to the target lands a few billionths of a dollar short in floating point; version 6's exact comparison then placed a pointless extra trade (risking \$1,500 to make \$1). Since version 7 the engine compares with a one-cent tolerance.
6. **Re-entering at once.** Checking only whole hours lets a trade close at 12:59 and the next open at 13:00. The engine uses the exit minute and waits at least 10 minutes (10.4).

Reaching a target before a floor

A phase is passed when the balance gains A before it loses B : the gambler's ruin. This chapter solves it in an idealised model, then exactly for the plan's actual rule.

5.1 The idealised model: $P = B/(A + B)$

Let X_n be the balance after n trades, a martingale with $X_0 = 0$, and τ the first time it reaches $+A$ or $-B$. If every trade is sized so the balance lands exactly on one of the two, X_τ is $+A$ with probability P and $-B$ otherwise, and optional stopping gives

$$0 = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = P A - (1 - P) B \Rightarrow P = \frac{B}{A + B}.$$

The exact-landing assumption is what this formula needs. Under the plan's rule every failure does end exactly on the floor (5.4), but a pass can end a little above the target (the minimum target distance of 4.1 and the \$20 filler margin of 6.3), so the formula is the benchmark and 5.5 gives the exact value.

5.2 With costs, approximately: the Brownian formula

Treat the balance as a Brownian motion with drift $-c$ and variance $v = l(w + c)$ per trade. By 2.6, $e^{\theta X}$ with $\theta = 2c/v$ is a martingale, and optional stopping gives

PASS PROBABILITY WITH COSTS (BROWNIAN APPROXIMATION)

$$P \approx \frac{e^{\theta B} - 1}{e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1}, \quad \theta = \frac{2c}{v} = \frac{2\rho}{l(w/l + \rho)}, \quad P \approx \frac{B}{A + B} \left(1 - \frac{cA}{v}\right).$$

This is accurate when each trade is small next to A and B and its size does not change. The plan's trades are capped (40% of the target), shrink near the floor and the daily limit, and jump: the exact chain of 5.5 is used instead, and the Brownian value is shown only for comparison.

5.3 How many trades, approximately

With a constant trade, $(X_n)^2 - nv$ is a martingale before costs, so $\mathbb{E}[\tau] = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau^2]/v = AB/v$ in the idealised model. With trades that change size the relevant quantity is the accumulated variance $\sum_n v(X_n)$, not v times the count; the chain computes the expected count exactly.

5.4 The plan's rule near the floor

Version 6's written rule could leave an account a few dollars above its floor with no trade ever allowed. Version 7 ended the attempt there and bought a replacement; but an account that has not breached is still open, and at firms with a per-person limit (FTMO's \$400,000, FXIFY's one account per size) it may still count against it. Version 8 ends every account in a way the firm records: a breach. At a balance x (relative to the start), with floor $-B$, buffer b (\$100 per \$100K) and the cost per dollar of risk ρ :

RISK OF THE NEXT TRADE, AND THE TERMINAL TRADE

$$\text{room}(x) = \frac{x + B - b}{1 + \rho}, \quad l(x) = \min(L, \text{room}(x), \text{today's room}, \text{margin room}) \quad \text{if } \text{room}(x) \geq l_{\min} = \max(0.1L, \text{one fut})$$

otherwise (the terminal trade): $l(x) = \min\left(\frac{x + B}{1 + \rho}, \text{today's room}\right)$ (at least the smallest lot; one contract on futures), wit

On futures L in the first line is at least one contract: where one contract at the planned stop risks more than L , the plan trades one contract if the rooms allow it (Appendix A, n11).

A normal trade loses at most $l(1 + \rho) \leq x + B - b$, so it never reaches the floor. A terminal trade is an ordinary bracket at the plan's reward:risk, small (under a tenth of the normal risk), whose stop sits at the floor: a loss ends the account in a breach, which the firm closes, freeing the allocation; a win continues it, and the account returns to normal trades once the room allows. So every failure ends exactly at $-B$, the text, the engine and the chain follow the same rule, and no account is left open and unused. (When only today's room is too small, the account waits for tomorrow; today's room resets, the static room does not.)

5.5 The exact chain

The balance after each trade is a Markov chain on $[-B, A]$, plus a small overshoot above A . At x the next trade has risk $l(x)$ as in 5.4, win $w(x) = \min(\max(\min(kl, A - x), w_{\min}, \$1), \text{cap})$ (4.1), cost $c(x) = \rho l(x)$ and win chance $p(x) = l/(l + w + c)$, and moves to $x + w$ (a pass if $x + w \geq A$, possibly above A) or to $\max(x - l - c, -B)$ (a failure at $-B$ after a terminal trade). Four functions solve the same recursion with different end values:

ONE STEP OF THE EXACT CHAIN

$$\begin{aligned} V(x) &= p V(x + w) + (1 - p) V(x - l - c), & V &= 1 \text{ from } A \text{ up, } 0 \text{ at } -B, \\ N(x) &= 1 + p N(x + w) + (1 - p) N(x - l - c), & K(x) &= c(x) + p K(x + w) + (1 - p) K(x - l - c), \\ T(x) &= p T(x + w) + (1 - p) T(x - l - c), & T &= \text{the balance where the attempt ends.} \end{aligned}$$

V is the pass probability, N the expected number of trades, K the expected total cost and T the expected final balance. They are solved by value iteration on a grid of about 8,000 points (analytic_v8.py). Because every trade's conditional mean is exactly minus its own cost (4.3), the stopped balance is bounded and the number of trades has finite mean, optional stopping (2.4, 2.5) gives the accounting identity, which the solver checks:

THE ACCOUNTING IDENTITY, EXACT

$$P \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + (1 - P) \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -K(0), \quad \text{and with every failure at } -B: \quad P = \frac{B - K(0)}{\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + B}.$$

The textbook form $P = (B - K)/(A + B)$ is the special case where every pass ends exactly at A . Under the plan's rule a pass ends a little above A , so the textbook form overstates P slightly (0.04 to 1.93 percentage points over the chosen programmes).

FTMO phase 1 ($A = B = \$10,000$, buffer \$100) at the plan's setting (risk \$1,500, $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, $\rho = 3.12\%$). No win can exceed $0.4A = \$4,000$, so no single win ends the phase from the start; the first trades along the all-loss path:

Trade j on the all-loss path	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win w_j	p_j	A win ends the phase?
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
2	-\$1,547	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
3	-\$3,094	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
4	-\$4,640	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
5	-\$6,187	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
6	-\$7,734	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
7	-\$9,281	\$601	\$18.73	\$4,000	0.1300	no

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4575$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.81$, $K(0) = \$793$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$.

Identity: $P_1 \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + (1 - P_1)(-B) = 0.4575 \times 10,125 - 0.5425 \times 10,000 = -792.66 = -K(0)$ (gap +0.0000); the mean balance at a pass is \$10,125, above A by the \$20 filler margin and the small overshoot of minimum-distance targets.

Exact form $P = (B - K)/(\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{pass}] + B) = 0.4575$; the textbook form $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4599$ (with A the target the engine trades to, the firm's target plus the \$20 filler margin of 6.3) is 0.24 percentage points higher, because a pass ends a little above A . Every failure ends exactly at $-B$ under the terminal rule (5.4).

Brownian approximation (5.2) with a constant full-size trade: $P_1 \approx 0.4616$.

Phase 2 ($A = \$5,000$, wins capped at \$2,000): $P_2 = 0.5972$, 18.76 trades, $K = \$846$. Both: $P = 0.2732$ (chain).

The engine (with the daily limit, the daily flat, minimum days, the per-day concentration cap and weekends), on sixteen fresh paths: $P = 0.2730 \pm 0.0056$. With those rules switched off (11.2) it gives 0.2711 ± 0.0099 , against the chain's 0.2737.

5.6 Bold play, and why the plan does not use it

Each trade costs c on average, so a phase's pass probability falls with its expected total cost (5.5). The way to pay the least cost is to need the fewest trades: stake enough to reach the target in one win. This is *bold play*, which Dubins and Savage (1965) proved optimal for reaching a goal in a fair or slightly unfavourable game. Version 6's search found it: left free, every programme moved to k of 20–30 and payout cycles of 25–30% of the account, so that a single trade could pass a phase or fill a payout.

Version 7 gave that up, deliberately, and version 8 keeps it so. Several firms forbid exactly this behaviour: Fintokei forbids reaching a target "in one or a few identical trades", The5ers bans "one-trade target attainment" permanently, Alpha forbids "all or nothing" trading, FundingPips' Profit Concentration Policy reacts to one trade idea above 60% of a target, and FundedNext, Hola Prime, FTMO and FXIFY reserve the right to treat concentrated outcomes as gambling. The plan therefore caps every trade and every day at 40% of the current target (6.7), so that every phase takes at least three winning days (a payout taken on its date before the target can rest on fewer, 6.7). Under that cap one win can never end a phase, the product formula for bold play (the chance of passing as a sequence of all-or-nothing trades) never applies, and the chain of 5.5 is the exact value.

For reference, the bold product formula, $P = \sum_j p_j \prod_{i < j} (1 - p_i)$ with $x_{j+1} = x_j - l_j - c_j$, is exact only if *every* possible win ends the phase, i.e. $k l(x_j) \geq A - x_j$ at every state on the all-loss path; $kL \geq A + B$ is not enough, because $l(x)$ shrinks near the floor. Version 6's tables printed wins of $A - x_j$ even where $k l(x_j)$ was smaller; those rows described trades the plan would not place.

k	Phase 1 trades, 40% cap	P , 40% cap	Attempt value, 40% cap	Phase 1 trades, no cap	P , no cap	Attempt value, no cap
1.5	31.3	0.2535	+\$761	31.3	0.2577	+\$783
2	23.9	0.2652	+\$984	23.9	0.2762	+\$1,050
3	18.2	0.2730	+\$1,210	16.5	0.2917	+\$1,334
4	18.0	0.2731	+\$1,306	12.7	0.3025	+\$1,513
6	17.9	0.2732	+\$1,381	9.2	0.3111	+\$1,686
8	17.8	0.2732	+\$1,382	7.3	0.3158	+\$1,779
12	17.8	0.2733	+\$1,383	5.9	0.3185	+\$1,856
20	17.7	0.2733	+\$1,384	5.8	0.3187	+\$1,904
30	17.7	0.2733	+\$1,384	5.7	0.3189	+\$1,907

Exact chain, FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's stop $m = 0.75$, risk \$1,500 and payout target \$20,000. Without the cap the value keeps rising with k toward bold play; with it, k beyond the cap changes nothing.

In the engine, at the plan's setting: \$2,512 $\pm$ \$217 a month with the 40% policy, \$3,336 $\pm$ \$937 with a 60% cap and \$4,077 $\pm$ \$847 with no cap at the same k (paths 141–144). Version 6's uncapped FTMO setting ($k = 20$, $m = 0.5$, $X = 30\%$) was worth \$5,463 a month in its own final run.

The evaluation in full

6.1 Two phases

Always, $\Pr(\text{pass both}) = P_1 \cdot \Pr(\text{pass 2} \mid \text{passed 1})$. In the simulation's model the second phase starts on a fresh account and its trades are independent of the first's, so the conditional probability equals the unconditional P_2 and the product $P_1 P_2$ holds. On real markets a volatile month that carries from one phase into the next could link them; zero edge alone does not rule that out, and the product is a model statement, not a theorem about markets. The engine simulates the two phases in sequence on one path, so whatever its path carries over is included.

Version 6 also said that putting the larger target first saves time and cost. It does not in general: with the Brownian trade count of 5.3 and targets A, C over a common B , the expected number of trades is $AB/v + \frac{B}{A+B} \cdot CB/v$, which for $A = 10,000, C = 5,000, B = 10,000$ and $v = 1,500^2 \times 5$ is 11.11 trades, against 10.37 with the targets reversed. The claim is withdrawn.

6.2 The daily loss limit

Most firms add a floor that is reset every day: the account may not fall more than d below a reference level fixed at the reset. Firms fix that level differently:

Firm	Reference fixed at the reset	Reset	Allowance	Engine
FTMO	balance at the reset	00:00 Prague (22:00/23:00 UTC)	5% of the initial balance	fixed
FundingPips	higher of the day's opening balance and equity	platform midnight, UTC+3 (21:00 UTC)	4% of that level	relative
The5ers	higher of the previous day's closing balance and equity	00:00 server time	5% of that level (\$5,500 at \$110,000)	relative
FXIFY	previous day's balance	17:00 New York	4% of that balance	relative
FundedNext	the day's starting balance	00:00 server time	5% of the initial balance	fixed
Fintokei	equity at the start of the day	00:00 server time	5% of that equity	relative
Hola Prime	previous day's closing balance	17:00 New York	5% of that balance	relative
Alpha Capital	the day's starting balance (close of the daily candle)	00:00 broker time	5% of that balance	relative
GFT	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York	5% of that level	relative
FunderPro	the day's starting balance (balance-based)	00:00 GMT+3	5%; base not stated	the stricter of the two
BrightFunded	higher of balance and equity at rollover	rollover, Prague time	5% of the original size	fixed
Blue Guardian	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York	4% of the initial balance	fixed
Maven	higher of equity and balance	00:00 UTC	4% of that level (4% of \$1,100 in its example)	relative

As published (4 October 2026; rules_snapshot_v8.json quotes the pages). Engine: 'fixed' subtracts a share of the initial balance from the reference; 'relative' a share of the day's reference itself, recomputed at every reset (version 7 used 'fixed' everywhere but Fintokei). Every reset falls between 20:00 UTC and 00:00 UTC, while the plan holds no position, so balance and equity are equal whenever a reference is fixed.

Two things differ by firm: the *reference* fixed at the reset (balance, equity, the higher of the two, the previous day's close) and the *base* of the percentage. At FTMO, FundedNext, BrightFunded and Blue Guardian the allowance is a fixed share of the initial balance, subtracted from the day's reference. At FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, GFT, Hola Prime, Maven, Alpha Capital and Fintokei it is the same share of the day's reference itself: The5ers' own example is a \$100,000 account at \$110,000 of equity at the reset, whose loss allowance for the day becomes \$5,500; a FundingPips account starting a day at \$94,000 has \$3,760, not \$4,000. FunderPro says only that its 5% is balance-based at the start of the day; the engine takes the stricter of the two bases there. Version 7 used the initial balance at every firm except Fintokei, and its response said that being flat at the reset made the engine's limit the firm's. Being flat makes balance and equity equal at the reset; it does not change the base. Version 8 recomputes each firm's allowance at every reset with its own base (acct_mc_dll_at).

With an open position at the reset, an equity-based or higher-of reference rises with the open profit, and a smooth reversal can then break the day's limit with no gap at all. The plan is flat at every reset (6.5), so the reference is the balance. Within the day, every trade's risk plus its cost fits the room left (5.4); after two or three losses the account waits for the next day.

6.3 Minimum trading days: the joint condition

FTMO (4), FundedNext (5), BrightFunded (5), FXIFY Classic (4), FunderPro Classic (4), Alpha (3), Hola Prime (3) and Fintokei (3) require days with at least one trade in each phase; Fintokei also before every payout, and Alpha five before its first. A phase is passed when the target is met *and* the days are complete. If the target is reached first, the plan stops trading the strategy and places one minimal filler trade (smallest lot, held at least 2 minutes, stop at most \$3 per \$100K) on each of the next trading days not yet traded, found on the market's real calendar (version 7 added 1.4 calendar days per missing day, an average: a target reached on a Friday needs its next filler on Monday). The target the engine trades to is the firm's target plus \$20 per \$100K, and at most five fillers with stops of \$3 cannot take the balance back under the firm's target unless a price gaps through a stop. At Alpha's funded accounts minimal-lot fillers are not allowed; there the plan places at most one normal trade a day until it has five trading days. Fillers are not used where a rule counts *profitable* days (6.4).

6.4 Profitable-day rules

The5ers, Maven, Blue Guardian, GFT (whose days count only with +0.5%) and FundingPips' 95% option require days with at least +0.5% profit in each phase; FundingPips' 95% option, GFT (4), Hola Prime, Maven and, in its stricter reading, Blue Guardian also in each payout cycle. (Version 7 also applied +0.5% to Fintokei, whose rule counts any trading day.) While such days are missing, the plan trades normally until the day's profit reaches

$$g_{\text{today}} = \max\left(0.55\% S, \frac{\text{distance left to the target}}{\text{profitable days still needed}}\right)$$

and then stops for the day; every trade is a full fair bracket whose take-profit is capped at what is left of today's target (but never closer than the minimum distance of 4.1). Stopping at a daily target is a stopping time, so in a cost-free fair game the pass probability is unchanged; with costs, every extra trade costs c , so these rules lower the value as well as stretching the time. The engine measures their effect in every programme's chapter. Under Maven's funded ceiling (profit kept at or below \$4,900, 7.4) the plan also keeps room for the days still needed: every win leaves 0.55% of the account below the ceiling for each profitable day still needed after today, and for today as well if the win would leave today short of +0.5%; otherwise it is cut, or the plan waits for tomorrow. Without that reserve an account can reach the ceiling a profitable day short and never be paid (Appendix A, n10).

6.5 The daily flat, weekends and news

The plan opens no position from 19:00 UTC and closes every position at the 20:00 UTC open, every weekday. Every daily reset in the plan falls between 20:00 and 00:00 UTC (FTMO and BrightFunded near midnight Prague time, GFT and Blue Guardian at 5 pm New York, Fintokei and Maven at 00:00 UTC), so the account is flat at each of them. This also removes overnight financing, overnight and weekend gaps, and the widened spreads of the daily break. The cost is time: a trade still open at 20:00 is closed between its stop and its target (a fair outcome) and the next one waits until the next day's open. Such a trade is decided at that open, with that day's loss allowance and caps: every daily figure in the engine (loss, profit, profitable and trading days) belongs to the day a trade opens, and a payout requested during a day does not restart that day's caps (Appendix A, n12 and n13).

News. Restricted news windows differ by firm (Maven: no opening or closing within 2 minutes of a red-folder release, in evaluations too; FundingPips: profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after may be deducted; FTMO funded: no new orders within 2 minutes; FundedNext: 40% of news profit counted on funded accounts). A bracket opened earlier can still reach its stop or target inside a window. The plan closes positions before any release that a firm restricts for the account's stage and market (US, euro-area and Japanese releases alike) and opens nothing until the window has passed. The engine has no news calendar, so the headline is a model without news restrictions. Chapter 28 runs a stylised news-hours sensitivity in which every account is flat from 12:00 to 14:00 UTC (and 08:00 to 09:00 on EURUSD) every weekday; it is a scenario, not a bound: those hours do not contain every restricted release, and removing trading hours has no proven one-way effect on cash per month (it changes which trades happen, when days qualify and when payouts fall).

6.6 Review time

Firms take one to three working days to check a passed phase and issue the next account. The engine adds one day after phase 1 and the firm's stated time after phase 2.

6.7 The concentration policy

On every account the plan caps the win of every trade at 40% of the current target (the phase target in an evaluation, the payout target on a funded account), and stops for the day once the day's profit reaches 40% of that target. Three consequences follow:

- every phase needs at least three winning days, so no pass rests on one trade or one day. A funded cycle that reaches its target needs three too, but a payout taken on its date before the target can rest on fewer: where a firm requires profitable days per payout, that is a rule of the programme (6.4), not a consequence of the cap;
- FundingPips' Profit Concentration Policy (60% of a phase target from one trade idea) can never trigger, and FXIFY's 25% best-day rule is met by its own tighter cap;
- the effective reward-to-risk is capped: in phase 2 of a 5% target on 100K a win is at most \$2,000, so at 1.75% risk at most 1.14 : 1. The search (Chapter 9) therefore covers smaller k and the risk per trade.

Chapter 9 measures what the policy costs against the uncapped strategy of version 6, programme by programme.

What a funded account pays

On the funded account the plan trades each *payout cycle* to a profit target X above the starting balance, stops, requests the payout on the first allowed day, and withdraws everything above the start. The balance is back at the start, the static floor is still D below it, and the next cycle begins. If a payout date comes before the target, the plan withdraws whatever profit there is (where the firm's rules allow) and starts a new cycle; the cycle formulas below describe the simpler policy of paying only at the target, and the engine simulates the plan's. The account ends in a breach at the floor under the rule of 5.4 (or, at a few firms, after a fixed number of payouts).

7.1 The withdrawal identity, with its conditions

Take one cycle. Its balance (relative to the start) is a stopped sum of trades, bounded between $-D$ and X plus one win, and each trade has conditional mean minus its own cost, so optional stopping applies to it (2.5). Let cycle i end with balance Z_i after costs K_i , and let $Q_i \geq 0$ be any profit removed from the account without being paid to the trader or counted as a cost (a firm's deduction of profit above a day cap, profit voided by a rolling cap). Then $\mathbb{E}[Z_i] = -\mathbb{E}[K_i] - \mathbb{E}[Q_i]$. The account's total withdrawal is $W = \sum_i Z_i \mathbf{1}\{\text{cycle } i \text{ paid}\}$ and it ends with balance X_{end} in its last cycle. Adding the cycles (the number of cycles has finite mean because each fails with a probability bounded away from zero):

THE WITHDRAWAL IDENTITY, GENERAL FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[W] = -\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{total funded cost}] - \mathbb{E}[Q].$$

External credits (The5ers' hub credit, refunds) are paid outside the account and are added separately. Under the plan $Q = 0$ in the model: wins are capped at what is left of GFT's daily cap and of Maven's ceiling and 30-day window, and no position is open through a gap, so nothing is deducted or voided. (In practice a take-profit filled a few points better than its price at an exact cap gives up those few points.) Under the terminal rule of 5.4 every account ends at the floor, $X_{\text{end}} = -D$, and the identity becomes $\mathbb{E}[W] = D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$, the form version 6 stated without its conditions. It fails when the account can end elsewhere: a daily-limit breach part-way down, a closure after a fixed number of payouts (Apex), or a floor that moves (Topstep, Apex); for those accounts only the engine's figures are used. The cycle-by-cycle argument is needed because the balance plus withdrawals is not bounded.

7.2 Cycle by cycle

Each cycle is a fresh run of the chain of 5.5 from 0 to its target X_i before the abandonment level, with success chance q_i . Cycles continue until one fails, so cycle j is paid with probability $\prod_{i \leq j} q_i$. With a first cycle X_1 and later ones X (chances q_1, q):

FUNDED CASH, CYCLE FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \left(X_1 q_1 + X \frac{q_1 q}{1 - q} \right) + R \cdot q_1 q^{r-1},$$

where the refund R comes with the r -th payout ($r = 1$ at most firms; Blue Guardian 4, Maven 3; FundingPips Flex, FXIFY Classic and BrightFunded without its paid add-on return no fee, and none is assumed at Alpha Pro); a refund in r equal parts with the first r payouts (Hola Prime) contributes $\frac{R}{r} \sum_{j=1}^r q_1 q^{j-1}$. With *two* special first cycles (GFT: the first two payouts are capped, so the first two cycles have target X_a and chance q_a , later ones X_b, q_b):

TWO SPECIAL FIRST CYCLES (GFT)

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q_a + q_a^2 + \frac{q_a^2 q_b}{1 - q_b} = q_a + \frac{q_a^2}{1 - q_b}, \quad \mathbb{E}[W] = X_a (q_a + q_a^2) + X_b \frac{q_a^2 q_b}{1 - q_b}.$$

(Version 6 printed $q_1/(1 - q)$ for GFT, the one-special-cycle formula; its number came from the correct one.) In the zero-cost idealised model $q = D/(X + D)$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = D/X$ and $\mathbb{E}[W] = D$, which is where the zero-cost example of 1.3 takes q from.

7.3 What the cycle target changes

In the idealised zero-cost model, nothing about the average. With costs, at fixed l and k , the expected number of funded trades grows with X : by 5.3 it is about XD/v per cycle times $(X + D)/X$ expected cycles, i.e. $D(X + D)/v$. So a larger cycle means *more* trades and more cost over the account's life, and more time between payouts; a smaller one means more payout requests and more waiting for payout dates. Version 6 said larger cycles mean fewer trades and less cost; that contradicted this formula and is withdrawn. With caps, daily targets and payout calendars the balance between the two effects is found by search (Chapter 9), and the measured effect of X is shown in each programme's chapter.

7.4 Funded rules and what they change

- **Best-day rules.** If no day may exceed a share β of a payout's profit, each day's take-profit is capped at βX less what the day has made (FXIFY 25%, measured against the account's best day ever; the plan's own 40% everywhere), and a payout is requested only when the rule holds.
- **Maven:** above \$5,000 of profit, no "day" (a run of trades without a 24-hour gap) and no trade may exceed 50% of the cycle's profit. Under daily trading a week is one such day, so the plan keeps every Maven account's profit at or below \$4,900, \$100 under the threshold so that a take-profit filled a few points better than its price cannot bring the rule in, and the rule never applies. At most \$10,000 of profit may be closed in any 30 days, the excess voided, so no win is placed that could take any window above it.
- **Profitable days per cycle** (FundingPips 95%: 3; Hola Prime: 3; GFT: 4; Maven: 3; Blue Guardian, stricter reading: 3) and **trading days** (Fintokei: 3 per payout; Alpha: 5 before the first): the daily target of 6.4, or filler days of 6.3 (not at Alpha).

- **Payout calendars.** The first payout is allowed 14 to 30 days after the first trade on the funded account (FTMO, FundingPips, Fintokei, GFT, Alpha and Maven count from the first trade; the engine does so for every firm, which for the others is at most hours later than funding), then every 10 to 30 days. A cycle that reaches its target early waits, flat.
- **Minimum payouts:** FundingPips 1% of the account, FXIFY \$50, Fintokei, GFT, FunderPro, Blue Guardian and Alpha \$100, The5ers \$150.
- **Payout caps** (GFT: the first two payouts at most 6% or \$10,000): the first two cycles aim at the cap.
- **Daily profit caps** (GFT: \$3,000 a day at every size): the take-profit is capped at what is left of the day's cap, so nothing is deducted.

Without costs, rules that only cap or delay wins leave the average withdrawal unchanged; with costs, each extra trade costs c . The engine includes all of them.

7.5 The plan's funded account, worked through

FTMO's funded account at the plan's setting: allowance $D = \$10,000$ (static), payout target $X = \$20,000$, wins capped at $0.4X = \$8,000$, split 80%, refund $R = \$607.82$ with the first payout.

One cycle is the chain of 5.5 from 0 to X : $q = 0.3064$, with 17.9 trades per cycle on average.

$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q/(1 - q) = 0.4417$; $\mathbb{E}[W] = \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{paid}}] q/(1 - q) = \$8,871$, where a paid cycle withdraws its target plus any overshoot.

General identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,129 = \$8,871$ (gap +0.00). Under the terminal rule every account ends at the floor, so $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] = -D$ and the static form $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$ holds again; no profit is forfeited under the plan ($Q = 0$).

$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \mathbb{E}[W] + Rq = 0.8 \times 8,871 + 607.82 \times 0.3064 = \$7,283$ (chain).

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6936	\$0
1	0.2125	\$16,608
2	0.0651	\$32,608
3	0.0200	\$48,608
4	0.0061	\$64,608

Chain values. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: many pay nothing, a few pay several cycles.

The engine, on fresh paths, pays \$7,528 per funded account (the chain with the daily rules switched off in the engine: $\$7,577 \pm \424).

Time, and value per month

8.1 How long one trade lasts, approximately

For a driftless *arithmetic* Brownian motion with variance σ^2 per hour, $Z_t^2 - \sigma^2 t$ is a martingale, and stopping at $+d_t$ or $-d_s$ gives $\mathbb{E}[\tau] = d_s d_t / \sigma^2$. For the bracket, $d_s = m\sigma$ and $d_t = m\sigma(w + c)/l$:

EXPECTED DURATION OF A BRACKET (HOURS OF OPEN MARKET), APPROXIMATION

$$\mathbb{E}[\tau] \approx m^2 \frac{w+c}{l}, \quad \mathbb{E}[\tau \mid \text{win}] \approx \frac{m^2}{3} \left(\left(\frac{w+c}{l} \right)^2 + 2 \frac{w+c}{l} \right), \quad \mathbb{E}[\tau \mid \text{loss}] \approx \frac{m^2}{3} \left(1 + 2 \frac{w+c}{l} \right).$$

The synthetic price is geometric: its log has drift $-\sigma^2/2$ per hour, and the barriers sit at log distances $-\ln(1-s)$ and $\ln(1+u)$, not s and u . For the plan's brackets (s and u a fraction of a percent to a few percent) the difference is of the order of s and u themselves, a fraction of a percent of the duration. The daily flat also cuts long trades at 20:00 UTC. So these formulas are used only to explain orders of magnitude; every duration reported in Part II is measured by the engine.

8.2 How long a phase lasts

In the idealised model the number of trades is AB/v (5.3) with $v = l(w+c)$, and each lasts about $m^2(w+c)/l$ hours, so the market time is about $(A/l)(B/l) m^2$ hours, independent of k . For FTMO phase 1 at $m = 0.75$ and $l = \$1,500$: $6.67^2 \times 0.56 \approx 25$ hours of open market. The calendar is set by the rules instead: minimum and profitable days, the concentration policy's three winning days, the daily flat, weekends, reviews and payout dates.

8.3 Value per month: the renewal–reward theorem

The plan runs *slots*: one account position at a firm, refilled with a new evaluation as soon as an attempt ends. A slot completes attempts with values V_i and durations T_i . If those pairs were independent and identically distributed, the renewal–reward theorem would give the long-run rate directly:

RENEWAL–REWARD THEOREM

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n V_i}{\sum_{i=1}^n T_i} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T]}, \quad \text{EV per month} = 30.44 \times \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T \text{ in days}]}.$$

They are not quite: a new attempt starts on the weekday and at the hour where the last one ended, and at a few firms it carries a credit (The5ers) or a rolling window (Maven). Resetting the balance does not reset the calendar. What holds instead is a Markov renewal argument. Let S_i be the state at the start of attempt i : the position in the week (a finite set at the engine's hourly resolution), plus the carried credit or window where a firm has one. Given S_i , the attempt depends only on price increments no earlier attempt has seen, which in the model are independent of the past, so (S_i) is a Markov chain and (V_i, T_i) depend on the past only through S_i . For the calendar part the chain is finite and, because attempt lengths are spread over many hours, irreducible and aperiodic, with a stationary distribution π ; the Markov renewal–reward theorem then gives the long-run rate $\mathbb{E}_\pi[V]/\mathbb{E}_\pi[T]$, the ratio of the stationary means. Each slot's figure in Part II is an estimate of this ratio: attempts start at random points of each path, and the cluster interval of 8.4 covers the dependence of attempts on one path. (Credits and windows enlarge the state space but not the argument; the engine carries them.) This is a *long-run rate*: a ratio of expectations, not the expectation of ratios, and the objective each programme's settings are chosen for.

8.4 How precise a simulated figure is

With n independent attempts the ratio estimate $\hat{r} = \bar{V}/\bar{T}$ has, by the delta method, standard error $\text{sd}(V_i - \hat{r} T_i) / (\sqrt{n} \bar{T})$. Attempts that start at random times on the *same* synthetic path share its history, so they are not fully independent. The final figures therefore use 16 independent paths per programme (1,500 attempts on each) and treat each path as a cluster:

CLUSTER-ROBUST INTERVAL FOR A RATIO

$$\widehat{\text{Var}}(\hat{r}) = \frac{G}{G-1} \frac{\sum_{g=1}^G (V_g - \hat{r} T_g)^2}{(\sum_g T_g)^2},$$

where V_g, T_g are the totals on path g . With only G clusters the multiplier for a 95% interval is the Student t quantile with $G-1$ degrees of freedom, not 1.96: 2.13 for 16 paths, 3.18 for 4. Every "±" for a programme is the larger of that cluster interval and 1.96 attempt-level standard errors. The checks of Chapter 11 use 24 independent paths per programme for the same reason: with thousands of attempts on one path, the same stretch of price history is traded dozens of times, and an attempt-level interval would be several times too narrow. Portfolio lives each run on their own new path, so they are independent and the ordinary standard error applies. These are Monte Carlo intervals *under the model*: they say how well the model's expectation is estimated, not how much a real year can differ from it, and they carry no allowance for wrong rules, wrong costs or a wrong model.

8.5 A first year is not the long-run rate

A new portfolio pays every fee in its first weeks and receives its first payouts a month or more later; at the end of any finite horizon some accounts are part-way through and hold value not yet paid. So the first year's average cash, the average of later months, and the long-run renewal rate are three different quantities, and nothing requires them to be equal. Chapter 28 reports them separately: the first-year average from 12-month lives,

and the average of months 13–36 and the value of the accounts still open at month 12 from 36-month lives. The months 13–36 average is a finite-window estimate: Chapter 28.6 compares its two annual windows with a paired interval before reading it as the long-run rate.

8.6 The plan's attempt, timed

Engine, sixteen fresh paths: an attempt lasts $\mathbb{E}[T] = 17.54$ days on average, from the purchase to the failed phase or the closed funded account.

So one slot buys $30.44/17.54 = 1.74$ evaluations a month and pays $1.74 \times \$607.82 = \$1,055$ a month in fees before refunds.

Value of an attempt: $\mathbb{E}[V] = \$1,448$; pass rate 27.3%; cash per funded account \$7,528.

Renewal–reward (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,448/17.54 = \$2,512$ per month, $\pm \$217$ (95%, cluster-robust over 16 paths; attempt-level $\pm \$148$).

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): an attempt that fails in the evaluation lasts 10.5 days on average; one that passes spends 20.4 days in the evaluation and 14.1 days funded, with 0.54 payouts on average; 37.6 trades per attempt.

Optimising the settings

Four numbers define how the plan trades a programme: the risk per trade L , the reward-to-risk k , the stop m and the funded payout target X ; a fifth choice is the market. This chapter explains what each does, how they were searched, and what the search can and cannot claim.

9.1 What each setting does

Setting	Value of an attempt	Time of an attempt	Range searched
Risk L	with the 40% cap on a win, a larger L means a smaller effective reward:risk	market time $\propto 1/L^2$	1.0%, 1.5%, 1.75% of the account (every firm's 2% rule stays out of reach after costs); FTMO at most 1.5%, its own guidance
Reward:risk k	fewer trades, less cost, until the 40% cap binds	little in theory (8.2)	1.5 to 12
Stop m	cost per trade $\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$	market time $\propto m^2$	from the leverage floor (Chapter 10) or 0.6, whichever is larger, to 1.25 (0.6: no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations, 4.1)
Payout target X	more funded trades and cost with larger X (7.3)	payout waiting against cycle length	4% to 30% of the account, within each firm's payout rules (Maven: 2–4.9%, so at most \$4,900)
Market	cost per unit of movement κ/σ	trading hours	those the firm's leverage and copy rules allow

9.2 The search

- Grid.** For every programme and every market it may trade, every combination of L , m (up to four stops from the leverage floor up), $k \in \{1.5, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 12\}$ and five or six payout targets: 10,857 settings, each 2,000 attempts on four paths (101–104): 21.7 million simulated attempts.
- Refine.** For each programme and market, the fourteen best grid settings, plus k half-way to its neighbours around the best (or 16 and 1.2 where the best sat at the end of the k grid) and a payout target 5 points larger, at most 30%, where the best sat at the top of its grid (not at Maven, whose grid ends at the plan's \$4,900 ceiling), re-run for 16,000 attempts on four *different* paths (111–114), plus FTMO's best grid settings inside its 1.5% ceiling: 397 settings, 6.4 million attempts.
- Choose.** The highest refined value per month with a stop of at least 0.6 hourly moves, a payout target of at most 30% of the account and, at FTMO, a risk of at most 1.5% (its own guidance, 10.5).
- Report.** The chosen setting is run a third time on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts in all, with the cluster-robust interval of 8.4. Every figure reported for a programme comes from this run, so none is inflated by having been picked as the best of many noisy estimates. The inflation is visible: the chosen settings average 4% less on the fresh paths than on the paths that chose them.

What the search establishes. The best setting found in this grid, for these programmes and these markets, under the model. It is not a proof of a global optimum over every possible rule, product, size or market; Part II lists what was searched for each programme and what was left out.

9.3 What the search found

The policy moves the optimum. Under the 40% cap no win can end a phase, so the version 6 corner (k of 20–30, one trade per phase) is gone. The chosen settings use risk 1.50% (6), 1.75% (18), k from 3 to 12, stops from 0.75 to 1.25 and payout targets from 4.9% to 30% of the account.

Risk per trade. With wins capped at 40% of the target, a larger risk mainly makes the account move faster (market time $\propto 1/L^2$, 8.2) at almost the same pass probability, which favours the largest risk the plan allows: 1.75%, set by the firms' 2% rules, and 1.5% at FTMO (10.5). 19 of 24 chosen settings use that ceiling. The others chose a smaller risk because a lower setting measured higher on the refinement paths: FundedNext Stellar on gold at 1.50% (\$2,588 $\pm$ \$504 in the refinement, against \$2,525 $\pm$ \$528 for the best setting at 1.75%); The5ers HS on Nasdaq at 1.50% (\$2,737 $\pm$ \$1,225 in the refinement, against \$2,644 $\pm$ \$962 for the best setting at 1.75%); The5ers HS Classic on Nasdaq at 1.50% (\$2,971 $\pm$ \$1,126 in the refinement, against \$2,946 $\pm$ \$655 for the best setting at 1.75%); FunderPro Classic on USDJPY at 1.50% (\$2,574 $\pm$ \$507 in the refinement, against \$2,488 $\pm$ \$496 for the best setting at 1.75%); Maven 2-Step on Nasdaq at 1.50% (\$1,393 $\pm$ \$97 in the refinement, against \$1,356 $\pm$ \$63 for the best setting at 1.75%). Where the two intervals overlap, the choice between them is within the search's noise.

Payout targets. 9 of 24 chosen settings use the plan's ceiling of 30% of the account (one payout of more than 30% invites review); a larger target means fewer payout dates to wait for and, under the 40% cap, larger wins per trade, against more funded trades (7.3). Firms with payout caps or ceilings (GFT, Maven) are held below them.

9.4 Every programme

Programme, market	Chosen L / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Version 7
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	\$2,653 $\pm$ \$214	26.9%	16.6	\$3,199
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 15%	\$2,231 $\pm$ \$159	30.1%	19.1	\$2,328
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	1.75% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$2,607 $\pm$ \$259	29.4%	19.6	\$2,766
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.5% / 8 / 0.75 / 20%	\$2,512 $\pm$ \$217	27.3%	17.5	\$2,930
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,097 $\pm$ \$159	28.7%	28.2	\$2,877
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 30%	\$1,909 $\pm$ \$249	27.1%	25.4	\$2,277
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	1.75% / 5 / 1.07 / 15%	\$1,755 $\pm$ \$116	29.0%	25.9	\$2,113
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	\$1,528 $\pm$ \$221	26.4%	23.3	\$1,621

Programme, market	Chosen L / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Version 7
Fintokei ProTrader, Nasdaq	1.75% / 10 / 1 / 20%	\$2,877 ± \$199	29.7%	18.6	\$3,209
FundedNext Stellar, gold	1.5% / 4 / 1 / 15%	\$2,207 ± \$246	29.2%	20.4	\$2,761
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 20%	\$1,389 ± \$155	26.3%	22.1	\$1,590
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	1.75% / 8 / 1.07 / 30%	\$2,919 ± \$209	29.2%	18.6	\$3,406
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	1.5% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$2,186 ± \$242	25.9%	17.8	\$2,467
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 20%	\$2,479 ± \$287	26.7%	26.7	\$2,829
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 30%	\$1,866 ± \$196	25.4%	23.7	\$2,399
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 20%	\$1,560 ± \$149	21.0%	24.3	\$1,703
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$1,235 ± \$136	20.9%	23.9	\$1,380
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	1.75% / 3.5 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,197 ± \$135	29.2%	21.7	\$2,534
GFT Standard, USDJPY	1.75% / 3 / 1.25 / 10%	\$1,834 ± \$135	27.5%	21.8	\$2,034
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	1.75% / 6 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,413 ± \$210	29.6%	18.2	\$2,813
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$1,343 ± \$159	23.5%	17.8	\$1,247
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.5% / 3 / 1 / 4.9%	\$1,409 ± \$82	26.3%	24.4	\$1,627
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	1.5% / 10 / 0.75 / 30%	\$3,099 ± \$216	30.5%	18.0	\$3,592
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	1.5% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$2,941 ± \$272	29.1%	18.9	\$3,290

One 100K account, sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts each; 95% interval: the larger of the attempt-level and the cluster-robust interval (Student t, 15 degrees of freedom). L: risk per trade; X: payout target, both as a share of the account. Shaded: in the recommended plan. Version 7: its chosen setting's value under version 7's rules and engine (fixed daily-loss bases, FXIFY's refund, Fintokei's stricter days, Hola Prime's 40% rule, no Maven funded days, abandonment near the floor, no minimum target distance, five-minute sub-steps, trades booked to the day they were decided); not a measure of the same thing.

Position size, leverage and margin

10.1 From risk to lots

The stop distance in price points is $m\sigma \times \text{price}$. If one lot gains or loses V dollars per point (the firm's contract specification), then

LOTS FOR A GIVEN RISK

$$\text{lots} = \frac{l}{m\sigma \text{ price } V}, \quad \text{notional} = \frac{l}{m\sigma}.$$

Lots are rounded *down* to the lot step, so the realised risk is never above l . Micro Nasdaq futures trade in whole contracts of \$2 per point. The synthetic Nasdaq path starts at 100, so at every entry the engine converts its price to the index level, $P_{\text{index}} = 31,070 \times P/100$, values one contract's stop at $2 P_{\text{index}} m\sigma$ dollars, and rounds the number of contracts down (never below one). Version 7 used 31,070 at every entry: at a path level of 125 that understated one contract's risk by a fifth. A futures account whose room is below one contract's stop makes its terminal trade with one contract (5.4). Where one contract at the planned stop risks more than the planned l (on a path whose index has risen several-fold), the plan trades one contract if the floor and daily rooms allow it; the first version 8 engine waited instead, and those accounts never traded again (Appendix A, n11).

10.2 Leverage and margin, at every entry

A position of notional N needs margin N/λ at leverage $1:\lambda$. The plan keeps margin at most 60% of the *current* balance at every entry (version 6 checked it on the starting balance only):

MARGIN CONDITION AT ENTRY, AND THE SMALLEST STOP AT THE START

$$\frac{l}{m\sigma\lambda} \leq 0.6(S+x) \iff l \leq 0.6\lambda m\sigma(S+x), \quad m_{\min} = \frac{L/S}{0.6\lambda\sigma}.$$

The engine applies the first form to every trade, lowering the risk when the balance has fallen; the search starts its stops at $m_{\min}$. Where a firm's leverage differs between evaluation and funded accounts (GFT: 1:20 then 1:10 on indices), the funded leverage sets $m_{\min}$. FunderPro's funded accounts have a rule of their own: at most 20% of the *starting* balance as margin per asset class. At 1:30 on the Nasdaq that needs $m \geq L/(S \times 0.2 \times 30 \times \sigma)$: 1.066 at the plan's 1.75% risk (0.913 at 1.5%; version 7's rule sheet quoted 0.92, the 1.5% figure, next to a 1.75% risk). GFT's funded 1:10 with the plan's 60% cap gives the same 1.066 at 1.75%. Version 6's FunderPro setting ($m = 0.35$) used about 52% and broke the rule.

Programme	Market	Leverage: evaluation / funded	Risk	$m_{\min}$	Plan's m	Notional per 100K	Funded margin / start balance
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	0.75	\$852,551	43%
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.25	\$511,530	51%
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1	\$639,413	32%
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:50 / 1:50	1.50%	0.183	0.75	\$730,758	15%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	60%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	USDJPY	1:30 / 1:30	1.75%	0.815	1.25	\$1,173,426	39%
FXIFY Classic (80%)	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	60%
FXIFY Classic (80%)	USDJPY	1:30 / 1:30	1.75%	0.815	1	\$1,466,782	49%
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	1:50 / 1:50	1.75%	0.213	1	\$639,413	13%
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1.25	\$1,642,208	16%
FundedNext Stellar	gold	1:10 / 1:10	1.50%	0.881	1	\$528,477	53%
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	1:30 / 1:30 (20% cap)	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	20%
FunderPro Classic	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100 (20% cap)	1.50%	0.629	1	\$1,257,242	13%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.244	1	\$1,466,782	15%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	\$2,052,760	21%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.244	1.25	\$1,173,426	12%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	\$2,052,760	21%
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	60%
GFT Standard	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:50	1.75%	0.489	1.25	\$1,173,426	23%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.028	1.03	\$598,598	60%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	EURUSD	1:50 / 1:50	1.75%	0.684	1	\$2,052,760	41%
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.50%	0.457	1	\$548,068	27%
The5ers HS	Nasdaq	1:25 / 1:25	1.50%	0.365	1	\$548,068	22%
The5ers HS Classic	Nasdaq	1:25 / 1:25	1.50%	0.365	0.75	\$730,758	29%

10.3 Which market each account trades

- **Nasdaq 100** (US100 CFD, or micro Nasdaq futures): every firm that allows the position and the same trades as your own accounts elsewhere.
- **USDJPY**: FundingPips (leverage), and any firm whose Nasdaq stop the leverage pushes too wide, where the search found it better.
- **Markets of their own** for the firms that forbid copying from other firms' accounts or into funded accounts: FundedNext and Hola Prime each trade a market (EURUSD, gold) that no other account trades.

Inside each group every account takes the same direction (Chapter 28), so no two accounts are ever on opposite sides of one market.

10.4 The ten-minute rule

FundingPips groups positions on one market and direction into one "trade idea" limited to 2% on funded accounts above \$25K; Hola Prime treats a position opened within 10 minutes of closing one in the same direction and market, profitable or not, as the same trade idea, whose combined risk may not exceed 2%. The plan waits at least 10 minutes after *every* close before the next entry on that account, at every firm. Version 7 said that an entry at a later hour's open already met this; a close at 12:59 and an entry at 13:00 does not. The engine now knows each exit's minute from the one-minute sub-steps (3.3) and, after an exit later than minute 50, waits one more hour; tests_v8.py measures the shortest time from an exit to the next entry over thousands of consecutive trades (10382 consecutive trades: shortest time from an exit to the next entry 10 minutes).

10.5 Risk per trade

Version 6 fixed the risk at 1.5% and argued from time alone. Under the 40% cap a larger risk lowers the effective reward:risk of a capped win, so the risk now matters for value too, and it is searched (1.0%, 1.5%, 1.75%). The upper end is 1.75% because Alpha forbids risking or losing 2% or more on a trade, FundingPips closes a trade idea at 2%, Hola Prime and FunderPro cap funded risk at 2%, and Blue Guardian's shield and GFT's Goat Guard act at a 2% open loss: 1.75% plus cost stays below all of them. FTMO publishes a recommendation of 1–1.5% of the initial balance per trade and says larger risk can trigger its risk monitoring; it is not a written rule, but the plan treats it as one and caps FTMO at 1.5%.

Risk per trade	EV per month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.00%	\$1,921 ± \$350	\$1,206	26.7%	19.1
1.25%	\$2,272 ± \$371	\$1,331	27.3%	17.8
1.50%	\$2,215 ± \$463	\$1,237	26.9%	17.0
1.75%	\$2,268 ± \$417	\$1,226	27.2%	16.5
2.00%	\$2,410 ± \$388	\$1,301	25.9%	16.4

FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 20K, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per row, same random numbers in every row. 2% is shown for reference only.

Checking the engine against the formulas

The engine and the chain were written separately. The chain leaves out daily limits, minimum and profitable days, the per-day part of the concentration policy, payout dates (it pays only at the payout target, while the plan withdraws whatever profit there is on each payout date), the daily flat, weekend closes, the 10-minute gap and Maven's 30-day window; the engine includes them. Both include the terminal rule of 5.4 and the minimum target distance of 4.1. One effect exists only in the engine and only if positions are held over a weekend: a gap through the floor is absorbed by the firm, a gap through the target is kept. The plan is flat at weekends, so it does not arise; the verification stays flat at weekends too. Agreement where both apply is supporting evidence that each implements its model as described. It is not proof that either is right: two programs can agree because they share a wrong rule input or a wrong assumption. Where they differ, the difference should come from what the chain leaves out, and the third column of 11.2 measures exactly that, by running the engine with those rules switched off.

11.1 Basic checks

Check	Theory	Engine
Win rate of brackets with costs, 1 : 1, 1 : 2, 1 : 3, 1 : 6, stop $m = 1$ (60,000 trades each)	49.4% / 33.1% / 24.9% / 14.2%	49.2% / 32.8% / 24.7% / 14.5%
The same at the plan's tightest stop $m = 0.6$	49.0% / 32.9% / 24.8% / 14.2%	49.3% / 32.8% / 24.3% / 14.4%
Average result per trade in units of risk, 1 : 3, $m = 1$ (theory $-\rho$)	-0.0234	-0.0325 $\pm$ 0.0147
Sub-step convergence: win rate of cost-free brackets at $m = 0.6$, $k = 1, 2, 3, 6$, with 12 sub-steps per hour	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	49.91% / 33.31% / 24.66% / 14.27%
The same with 60 sub-steps (the plan's paths)	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	49.92% / 33.35% / 24.94% / 14.04%
The same with 240 sub-steps	50.00% / 33.33% / 25.00% / 14.29%	50.04% / 33.24% / 24.84% / 14.26%
Path-generator error bound of 3.3, added up over every chosen programme's trades	0	$\leq 2e-48$ per trade
Trades that may have closed within 2 minutes, every chosen programme	< 0.1%	0.002% of trades ≤ 2 min
Rule tests of the engine (tests_v8.py: daily-loss bases, terminal breach, 10-minute gap, target distance, calendar fillers, payout clocks, Alpha's and Maven's gates, futures at the path's price, streams, every day's loss and profit against the firm's allowance and the day caps by each trade's entry day, FXIFY's best day at every payout, no stalled account)	all pass	14 of 14 pass
FTMO phase 1, no costs, no daily rules, $k = 3$: pass rate (chain, with the plan's floor rule)	49.92%	50.18% $\pm$ 0.93%
FTMO funded account, no costs, no daily rules: average withdrawn before the split (chain)	\$10,000	\$10,160 $\pm$ \$526
200K account against two 100K accounts, same seeds, 1,500 attempts: with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee (FTMO, Fintokey, The5ers, GFT)	exactly 2 $\times$ where every rule scales	fee doubled: FTMO, The5ers, Fintokey exact; real fees: see text
Accounting identity of 5.5, largest gap over every chosen programme's phases and cycles	0	\$0.0000
FTMO with the plan's direction rule against a coin flip	equal	per trade +0.0040 / +0.0099 R (± 0.014)

Sub-step convergence. At the tightest stop the plan allows (0.6 hourly standard deviations), cost-free brackets on six independent two-year paths per cell (120,000 each) win at rates that differ from $1/(1+k)$ by $k = 1$: -0.09 ± 0.28 points at 12, -0.08 ± 0.35 points at 60, $+0.04 \pm 0.28$ points at 240; $k = 2$: -0.02 ± 0.87 points at 12, $+0.01 \pm 0.52$ points at 60, -0.09 ± 0.40 points at 240; $k = 3$: -0.34 ± 0.51 points at 12, -0.06 ± 0.79 points at 60, -0.16 ± 0.55 points at 240; $k = 6$: -0.01 ± 0.27 points at 12, -0.24 ± 0.66 points at 60, -0.03 ± 0.56 points at 240 sub-steps per hour (the larger of the binomial and the cluster interval). Every cell lies inside its interval. These intervals say how far each estimate can be from the truth under the model; they are not a bound on the generator's error, which is the bound of 3.3 below. Version 7's claim of a quarter-point bound did not follow from its own cells and is withdrawn.

The scaling test, twice. *Rules:* with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee, a 200K attempt equals twice the matching 100K attempt, path by path, for FTMO, The5ers, Fintokey (largest difference \$0.00 over 4,500 pairs). GFT is not exact, because its \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap are flat amounts: \$1,394 per 100K at 200K against \$1,515 at 100K. *Contracts:* with the firms' real 200K fees, FTMO \$1,845 per 100K at 200K against \$1,845 at 100K (fee \$1,215.65 against $2 \times \$607.82$); Fintokey \$1,454 per 100K at 200K against \$1,519 at 100K (fee \$1,249.00 against $2 \times \$549.00$); GFT \$1,424 per 100K at 200K against \$1,515 at 100K (fee \$974.00 against $2 \times \$524.00$) (The5ers sells no 200K account of this programme, so its 200K row checks the rules only.) The fee difference is the whole of the gap where the rules scale; 27.2 values it.

The direction rule. Per trade (cost-free 1 : 3 brackets on the Nasdaq, 60,000 each), the plan's momentum rule averages $+0.0040 \pm 0.0143$ R and a coin flip $+0.0099 \pm 0.0143$ R. Per month (FTMO, 48,000 attempts each on paths 141–144) the momentum rule gives \$2,330 $\pm$ \$2,254 and the coin flip \$2,330 $\pm$ \$448. The momentum rule's interval is wider because attempts that overlap on one path take the same direction at the same time, so they are correlated. Under the model no rule that uses only past prices can have an edge (2.3); the plan uses the momentum rule only so that all of one person's accounts take the same side.

11.2 Every chosen programme: chain against engine

Programme	P: chain	P: engine, chain's rules	P: engine, all rules	Funded cash: chain	engine, chain's rules	engine, all rules
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.274	0.271 $\pm$ 0.010	0.273	\$7,283	\$7,577 $\pm$ \$424	\$7,528
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	0.258	0.250 $\pm$ 0.010	0.254	\$8,067	\$7,347 $\pm$ \$682	\$7,688
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	0.218	0.224 $\pm$ 0.010	0.209	\$7,178	\$7,793 $\pm$ \$747	\$7,013

Programme	P: chain	P: engine, chain's rules	P: engine, all rules	Funded cash: chain	engine, chain's rules	engine, all rules
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	0.271	0.266 ± 0.011	0.267	\$9,927	\$9,441 ± \$517	\$10,016
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	0.218	0.226 ± 0.011	0.210	\$8,531	\$9,200 ± \$684	\$8,297
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	0.266	0.261 ± 0.009	0.263	\$6,583	\$6,518 ± \$672	\$5,909
FundedNext Stellar, gold	0.298	0.293 ± 0.011	0.292	\$7,000	\$6,830 ± \$494	\$6,950
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	0.289	0.284 ± 0.011	0.291	\$7,464	\$7,059 ± \$808	\$7,780
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	0.305	0.313 ± 0.010	0.305	\$7,277	\$7,344 ± \$629	\$7,600
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	0.292	0.285 ± 0.010	0.287	\$8,637	\$8,281 ± \$564	\$8,671
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	0.274	0.272 ± 0.011	0.271	\$8,316	\$7,940 ± \$988	\$7,924
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	0.292	0.283 ± 0.011	0.290	\$6,909	\$6,764 ± \$629	\$7,052
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	0.260	0.255 ± 0.008	0.264	\$6,360	\$6,411 ± \$506	\$6,514
Fintohei ProTrader, Nasdaq	0.302	0.306 ± 0.009	0.297	\$7,487	\$7,290 ± \$657	\$7,767
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	0.295	0.295 ± 0.014	0.296	\$7,009	\$7,085 ± \$630	\$6,905
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	0.240	0.234 ± 0.010	0.235	\$6,137	\$6,168 ± \$586	\$5,897
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	0.269	0.278 ± 0.010	0.269	\$7,191	\$7,154 ± \$657	\$7,214
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	0.292	0.289 ± 0.013	0.292	\$7,128	\$6,746 ± \$376	\$7,177
GFT Standard, USDJPY	0.274	0.266 ± 0.009	0.275	\$6,653	\$6,423 ± \$276	\$6,686
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	0.292	0.287 ± 0.011	0.292	\$7,547	\$6,483 ± \$752	\$7,955
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	0.261	0.257 ± 0.011	0.259	\$7,038	\$6,148 ± \$712	\$7,041
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	0.289	0.293 ± 0.012	0.294	\$7,386	\$7,537 ± \$826	\$7,621
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.298	0.288 ± 0.007	0.301	\$6,318	\$6,025 ± \$461	\$6,554
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.270	0.272 ± 0.013	0.263	\$5,601	\$5,639 ± \$269	\$5,964

Chain: analytic_v8.py. Engine with the chain's rules: the same engine with the daily loss limit, minimum and profitable days and the daily flat switched off, the concentration caps applied per trade, and payouts only at the payout target; it stays flat at weekends, because a position held through a weekend gaps and a gap is not in the chain. 24 independent two-year paths × 500 attempts, intervals cluster-robust over paths (Student t, 23 degrees of freedom). Engine with all rules: the final run. The middle columns test the implementation; the gap between them and the last columns is what the daily rules do.

Implementation. With the chain's rules, the engine's pass rate is within its 95% interval of the chain's in 23 of 24 programmes and its funded cash in 20 of 24; the largest standardised differences are -1.3 and -1.4 intervals. Remaining differences come from Monte Carlo noise and from what the engine still does that the chain does not: it closes positions at the Friday close (a fair outcome between stop and target, which the binary chain does not have), and the chain is solved on a grid. They go both ways, so neither is 'the conservative one'.

What the daily rules do. Switching the daily rules back on changes the value of an attempt by −\$339 to +\$462 across programmes. These are the effects the formulas of Part I do not contain; every reported figure comes from the engine with every rule on.

Every programme in the plan

One chapter per firm, for the programme and market the plan uses there: the rules as published; exactly what the engine simulates; the search; the chosen setting and its alternatives on fresh paths; one trade in dollars and points; the evaluation and the funded account from the exact chain; value per attempt and per month; sizes and number of accounts; higher costs; and how the plan meets the rules.

FTMO 2-Step Challenge

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,512 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$217); in the plan: $4 \times 100\text{K}$, \$10,049 a month.

12.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	€540 for 100K (\$607.82 at 1.1256), €1,080 for 200K (\$1,215.65); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5% of the initial balance
Maximum daily loss	5% of the initial balance, measured from the balance at 00:00 CE(S)T
Maximum loss	10% of the initial balance, static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase (a day with at least one position opened)
Funded split and payouts	80% (90% after scaling); first reward on the 14th day after the first trade on the account, then every 14 days; \$20 minimum by bank transfer
Consistency rule	none on the 2-Step (the 1-Step has a 50% best-day rule)
Leverage	1:50 on indices (Normal account)
News and weekends	funded Standard account: no new orders 2 minutes around restricted news; no weekend holding
Per person	\$400,000 per trader or strategy across all accounts, evaluations included; the same strategy may run on several accounts within the cap
Prohibited	gambling (no plan, all-in), account rolling, opposite positions across accounts or providers, gap trading (opening within 2 hours of a market close to profit from the gap), latency arbitrage
Risk guidance	FTMO recommends risking 1–1.5% of the initial balance per trade; larger risk can trigger risk monitoring (a recommendation, not a written rule)

12.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$607.82
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 80%; \$607.82 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:50 (evaluation), 1:50 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

12.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 29 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	3	0.75	20%	\$2,441 $\pm$ \$566	26.8%	16.4
1.75%	7	1	20%	\$2,422 $\pm$ \$841	28.7%	17.9
1.75%	5	1	20%	\$2,417 $\pm$ \$829	28.7%	17.8
1.75%	6	0.75	15%	\$2,360 $\pm$ \$1,039	26.6%	16.9
1.75%	8	1	20%	\$2,352 $\pm$ \$740	28.9%	17.9
1.75%	12	1	20%	\$2,351 $\pm$ \$740	28.8%	17.9
1.50%	8	0.75	20%	\$2,342 $\pm$ \$530	26.6%	17.2
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$2,324 $\pm$ \$756	28.1%	17.6

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.66	1.65	1.84	1.50	1.74	1.74
2	1.63	1.76	1.57	1.96	1.62	1.66
3	1.86	2.07	2.23	2.18	2.30	1.88
4	1.81	1.99	2.29	2.29	1.99	1.99
6	1.89	2.16	2.22	2.29	1.98	2.48
8	1.96	2.13	2.05	2.12	2.41	2.32
12	1.93	2.28	2.10	2.39	2.68	2.11

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.4$ – $1.0K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,500 and stop $m = 0.75$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

12.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.5% / 8 / 0.75 / 20%	\$2,512 $\pm$ \$217	27.3%	\$7,528	17.5	+\$1,448

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,930 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

12.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$730,758$; **\$23.52 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$46.77$, $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 172.1 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.2704$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 6,070,153$; duration about 1.52 h of open market (losers 1.20 h, winners 2.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$8,000 at risk \$1,500: take-profit 342 points away, $p = 0.1571$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:50: \$14,615 = 14.6% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.183$.

12.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4575$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.81$, $K = \$793$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4599$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5972$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.76$, $K = \$846$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6094$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4575 \times 0.5972 = 0.2732$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2730 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

12.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3064$; expected paid cycles 0.4417; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,871.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,129 = \$8,871$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,283 per funded account, of which the refund term \$186.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,528** per funded account; 10.1% of attempts reach a payout; median 34 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6936	\$0
1	0.2125	\$16,608
2	0.0651	\$32,608
3	0.0200	\$48,608
4	0.0061	\$64,608

Chain values.

12.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2732 \times 7,283 - 607.82 = \$1,382$; engine \$1,448.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 17.54$ days per attempt, so 1.74 attempts a month per slot and \$1,055 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 10.5 days on average; a passed one 20.4 days, then 14.1 days funded with 0.54 payouts; 37.6 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,448 / 17.54 = \$2,512 \pm \$217$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

12.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$607.82	\$608	\$2,512 $\pm$ \$217	\$2,512
200K	\$1,215.65	\$608	\$5,024 $\pm$ \$434	\$2,512

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included. **Copying:** your own accounts, within the cap. **The plan:** $4 \times 100K$, worth \$10,049 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $4 \times 100K$, worth \$10,049 a month (4 accounts).

12.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,215 $\pm$ \$463	+\$1,237	17.0	26.9%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,888 $\pm$ \$701	+\$1,012	16.3	24.6%
$\times 2$	\$1,590 $\pm$ \$427	+\$814	15.6	22.3%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

12.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq 100 CFD, one position per account, shared direction with every other Nasdaq account
- 1.5% risk (inside FTMO's stated 1–1.5% guidance) with the stop attached at entry
- minimum days filled with one minimal trade per day after the target, where needed
- every account traded the same way; none abandoned or sacrificed (no account rolling)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: ftmo.com/en/faq/how-do-i-withdraw-my-profits/ (first reward 14 days after the first trade); ftmo.com/en/faq/how-many-accounts-can-i-have/ (\$400,000 per trader); <https://ftmo.com/en/blog/how-much-should-you-risk-on-one-trade/>; ftmo.com (trading objectives, forbidden practices).

FundingPips 2-Step Flex

USDJPY; plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,479 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$287); in the plan: $4 \times 100K$, \$9,917 a month.

13.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$499 for 100K (largest size); no registration-fee refund on Flex
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 8%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the higher of the day's opening balance and equity (relative: \$3,760 on a day that opens at \$94,000), reset at platform midnight (UTC+3) / 12% static
Minimum days	80% option: 1 trading day per phase (accounts from 26 August 2026); 95% option: 3 profitable days (at least +0.5%) per phase
Funded split and payouts	chosen at purchase and locked: 80% with 1 minimum trading day, or 95% with 3 profitable days (+0.5% of the starting size) in every reward cycle; every 14 days from the first executed trade on the Master account; minimum reward 1% of the account
Risk per trade idea	at most 2% above \$25K; a trade idea is all positions on one market in one direction, including one opened within 10 minutes of closing a loss; a breach closes the account
Profit Concentration Policy	evaluations from 27 June 2026, \$25K and up: if one trade idea makes more than 60% of a phase target, the funded account needs 4 profitable days (+0.5%) before every reward request, permanently
Leverage	1:100 on forex; indices and metals on dynamic leverage falling to 1:5 above 0.5 lots
Weekends and news	overnight and weekend holding allowed on evaluations; on Master accounts only with the Swing add-on; profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after restricted news may be deducted
Per person	\$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts
Copying	only between your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services
Risk per trade idea (Master)	accounts above \$25K: a trade idea (related positions, realised and floating) may not lose 2%; immediate closure

13.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$499
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$12,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$12,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Funded account	maximum loss \$12,000, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 95%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$1,000; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:100 (evaluation), 1:100 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

13.3 The search

Searched: 1008 grid settings (EURUSD, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on USDJPY:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	12	1.25	20%	\$2,733 $\pm$ \$847	28.2%	27.8
1.75%	8	1.25	20%	\$2,726 $\pm$ \$897	28.1%	27.8
1.75%	12	1.25	30%	\$2,715 $\pm$ \$741	27.6%	27.2
1.75%	6	1.25	30%	\$2,688 $\pm$ \$707	27.7%	27.2
1.75%	8	1.25	30%	\$2,682 $\pm$ \$861	27.7%	27.2
1.75%	12	1.25	15%	\$2,666 $\pm$ \$741	28.0%	28.5
1.50%	12	1	15%	\$2,465 $\pm$ \$241	26.4%	27.7
1.50%	8	0.75	30%	\$2,413 $\pm$ \$436	22.9%	22.9

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.55	1.88	1.95	1.77	1.63	1.26
2	1.68	1.84	2.15	1.94	2.14	1.68
3	1.65	2.31	1.96	2.32	2.30	2.09
4	1.67	2.13	2.12	2.42	2.28	2.05
6	1.76	2.01	2.09	2.27	2.34	2.71
8	1.75	2.01	2.20	2.35	2.61	2.65
12	1.81	1.94	2.21	2.56	2.55	2.74

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $1.0K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.25$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

13.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 20%	\$2,479 $\pm$ \$287	26.7%	\$10,016	26.7	+\$2,171
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 30%	\$1,866 $\pm$ \$196	25.4%	\$7,688	23.7	+\$1,454
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$1,235 $\pm$ \$136	20.9%	\$7,013	23.9	+\$970
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 20%	\$1,560 $\pm$ \$149	21.0%	\$8,297	24.3	+\$1,243

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,829 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

13.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.1193\% = 0.1491\%$ of the price; at 157.83 that is **23.5 pips**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,173,426$; **\$74.35 per pip**; at \$6.34 per pip per standard lot, **11.73 lots** (round down).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$59.84$, $\rho = c/l = 3.42\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,333$; take-profit 45.6 pips away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3403$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,938,062$; duration about 3.03 h of open market (losers 2.54 h, winners 4.0 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$8,000 at risk \$1,750: take-profit 108 pips away, $p = 0.1784$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:100: \$11,734 = 11.7% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.244$.

13.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$12,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4974$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.05$, $K = \$1,035$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$12,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4984$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5455$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$12,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5443$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.38$, $K = \$1,055$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$12,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5473$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4974 \times 0.5443 = 0.2707$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2666 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

13.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$12,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 95%; per-trade cap \$8,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3430$; expected paid cycles 0.5220; expected withdrawn before the split \$10,450.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 12,000 - 1,550 = \$10,450$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): \$9,927 per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$10,016** per funded account; 12.5% of attempts reach a payout; median 39 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6570	\$0
1	0.2253	\$19,000
2	0.0773	\$38,000
3	0.0265	\$57,000
4	0.0091	\$76,000

Chain values.

13.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2707 \times 9,927 - 499.00 = \$2,189$; engine \$2,171.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 26.66$ days per attempt, so 1.14 attempts a month per slot and \$570 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 18.2 days on average; a passed one 26.7 days, then 23.7 days funded with 0.91 payouts; 41.4 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 2,171 / 26.66 = \$2,479 \pm \$287$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

13.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$499	\$499	\$2,479 $\pm$ \$287	\$2,479

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts. **Copying:** your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services. **The plan:** 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$9,917 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$9,917 a month (4 accounts).

13.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,629 $\pm$ \$604	+\$2,341	27.1	27.6%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,237 $\pm$ \$415	+\$1,889	25.7	24.7%
$\times 2$	\$1,970 $\pm$ \$462	+\$1,611	24.9	23.2%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

13.11 How the plan meets the rules

- USDJPY or EURUSD at 1:100 (the Nasdaq would need 1:7 and FundingPips gives 1:5 at that size)
- risk at most 1.75% plus cost, below the 2% trade-idea limit; at least 10 minutes after any close before the next trade
- the 40% concentration policy keeps every trade idea under the Profit Concentration Policy's 60%
- 4 $\times$ 100K Flex (the largest Flex size) fills the \$400,000 cap
- own entry on each account; no copier service
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation

- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: <https://help.fundingpiips.com/hc/en-us/articles/47835196271249-2-Step-Flex> (2 Step Flex, read 4 Oct 2026); <https://help.fundingpiips.com/hc/en-us/articles/48174287980177-Risk-Per-Trade-Idea> (Risk Per Trade Idea; Profit Concentration Policy).

The5ers High Stakes

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 10$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$3,099 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$216); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$, \$3,099 a month.

14.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	New (10% / 5%): \$491 for 100K; Classic (8% / 5%): \$545; smaller sizes \$19–\$278
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	New 10% / 5%; Classic 8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the previous day's closing balance or equity, the higher (relative: the firm's example is \$5,500 at \$110,000), reset 00:00 server time / 10% of the initial balance, static
Profitable days	3 per phase (at least +0.5%); may not be manufactured
Funded split and payouts	80% rising with scaling; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; \$150 minimum
Fee return	10% of the fee as hub credit (not cash) after phase 1, 20% after phase 2, 70% added to the funded account and paid with the first payout (at least \$150, 14 days after funding); the model keeps the credit apart from cash and spends it on the next The5ers evaluation
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:25 metals and indices
News	no new orders from 2 minutes before to 2 minutes after high-impact news
Per person	Classic: one 2.5K, one 5K, one 10K or 25K, one 50K or 100K; New: three each of 2.5K, 5K and 10K, one 25K, one 50K or 100K; the 50K/100K account is one across both programmes
Copying	allowed across your own accounts
Prohibited	one-trade target attainment (permanent ban)

14.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$545
Fee credit	non-cash credit of \$54.50 and \$109.00 on passing phase 1 and phase 2, spent on the next evaluation
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; \$381.50 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$150; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:25 (evaluation), 1:25 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

14.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.50%	10	0.75	30%	\$2,971 $\pm$ \$1,126	29.9%	17.6
1.75%	8	1	30%	\$2,946 $\pm$ \$655	32.1%	18.5
1.75%	12	1	30%	\$2,943 $\pm$ \$840	32.3%	18.7
1.50%	12	0.75	30%	\$2,910 $\pm$ \$931	30.0%	17.7
1.75%	6	1	15%	\$2,893 $\pm$ \$556	32.6%	19.5
1.50%	8	0.75	30%	\$2,807 $\pm$ \$926	29.6%	17.5
1.75%	4	0.75	15%	\$2,804 $\pm$ \$497	30.3%	18.2
1.50%	16	0.75	30%	\$2,787 $\pm$ \$1,212	30.0%	17.6

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.83	1.92	2.05	2.17	1.80	1.85
2	2.15	2.07	2.41	2.28	2.36	3.00
3	2.23	2.37	2.71	2.57	2.60	2.96
4	2.07	2.63	2.76	2.95	2.74	2.66
6	2.35	2.42	2.88	2.86	2.90	2.86
8	2.13	2.63	2.94	2.57	3.03	3.25
12	2.50	2.59	2.88	2.96	2.79	3.61

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $1.0K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,500 and stop $m = 0.75$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

14.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.5% / 10 / 0.75 / 30%	\$3,099 $\pm$ \$216	30.5%	\$7,600	18.0	+\$1,833
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	1.5% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$2,941 $\pm$ \$272	29.1%	\$7,780	18.9	+\$1,826

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$3,592 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

14.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$730,758$; **\$23.52 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$46.77$, $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 115.4 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3560$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,070,153$; duration about 1.02 h of open market (losers 0.87 h, winners 1.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$12,000 at risk \$1,500: take-profit 512 points away, $p = 0.1107$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:25: $\$29,230 = 29.2\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.365$.

14.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.5104$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.61$, $K = \$788$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5118$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5976$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 18.71$, $K = \$845$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6103$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.5104 \times 0.5976 = 0.3050$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.3049 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

14.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$12,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2302$; expected paid cycles 0.2990; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,986.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,014 = \$8,986$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,277 per funded account, of which the refund term \$88.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,600** per funded account; 10.1% of attempts reach a payout; median 32 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7698	\$0
1	0.1772	\$24,382
2	0.0408	\$48,382
3	0.0094	\$72,382
4	0.0022	\$96,382

Chain values.

14.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.3050 \times 7,277 + 61 - 545.00 = \$1,736$; engine \$1,833.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.00$ days per attempt, so 1.69 attempts a month per slot and \$921 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.5 days on average; a passed one 19.2 days, then 12.9 days funded with 0.45 payouts; 38.5 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,833 / 18.00 = \$3,099 \pm \$216$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

14.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$545	\$545	\$3,099 $\pm$ \$216	\$3,099
25K	\$176	\$704	\$673 $\pm$ \$67	\$2,691
10K	\$69	\$690	\$275 $\pm$ \$26	\$2,753
5K	\$35	\$700	\$130 $\pm$ \$13	\$2,607
2.5K	\$19	\$760	\$64 $\pm$ \$7	\$2,571

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: one 50K or 100K account across Classic and New together; New also $3 \times 2.5K$, $3 \times 5K$, $3 \times 10K$ and $1 \times 25K$ (Classic's own small slots not used; fees not readable). **Copying:** your own accounts. **The plan:** $1 \times 100K$, worth \$3,099 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 25K$; $3 \times 10K$; $3 \times 5K$; $3 \times 2.5K$, worth \$5,182 a month (11 accounts).

14.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,791 $\pm$ \$1,053	+\$1,635	17.8	30.6%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,185 $\pm$ \$625	+\$1,188	16.5	26.5%
$\times 2$	\$1,932 $\pm$ \$280	+\$1,007	15.9	24.1%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

14.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, shared direction
- daily profit target while profitable days are missing
- one 100K account; optionally New's small accounts ($3 \times 2.5K$, $3 \times 5K$, $3 \times 10K$, $1 \times 25K$), each on New's own contract and fee
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: the5ers.com/faqs/what-is-the-drawdown-rule-for-high-stakes/; the5ers.com/faqs/how-many-high-stakes-accounts-can-i-have/; the5ers.com/high-stakes/.

FXIFY Two Phase Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 15% of the account; **\$2,097 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$159); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 50K$; $1 \times 25K$; $1 \times 10K$; $1 \times 5K$, \$3,734 a month.

15.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549 for 100K (largest Classic size); no refund on Classic (the refund belongs to Two Phase Standard)
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	5% / 10%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the previous day's balance at 5 pm EST (relative) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days, or 100% every 30 days (chosen at purchase); minimum payout \$50
Consistency rule (funded)	no day may exceed 25% of the profit of a payout; the benchmark is the account's best day ever and does not reset
Leverage	1:10 on indices; 1:30 forex and metals (1:50 with an add-on)
Per person	one active account of each size, challenge and funded alike (5K, 10K, 15K, 25K, 50K, 100K, 200K, 400K; \$805,000 in all, rule of 25 November 2024); Classic goes up to 100K; Classic prices 5K \$59, 10K \$89, 25K \$199, 50K \$379, 100K \$549
Copying	between your own FXIFY accounts allowed; into FXIFY from external accounts only with approval (30-day statement); third-party copying prohibited
Prohibited	gambling and all-or-nothing ('YOLO') trading

15.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549
Phase 1	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Phase 2	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 100%; no fee refund; first payout 30 days after the first funded trade, then every 30 days; minimum payout \$50; best day at most 25% of a payout's profit, measured against the account's best day ever; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

15.3 The search

Searched: 840 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	12	1.07	15%	\$2,096 $\pm$ \$530	28.4%	27.8
1.75%	6	1.07	15%	\$2,093 $\pm$ \$504	28.8%	27.9
1.75%	2.5	1.07	20%	\$2,037 $\pm$ \$499	28.4%	26.1
1.75%	6	1.07	20%	\$2,036 $\pm$ \$425	28.3%	26.2
1.75%	3	1.07	20%	\$2,020 $\pm$ \$693	28.3%	25.5
1.75%	3	1.07	15%	\$2,012 $\pm$ \$184	28.6%	27.2
1.75%	2	1.25	20%	\$1,986 $\pm$ \$218	29.1%	27.4
1.75%	1.5	1.07	20%	\$1,976 $\pm$ \$269	27.5%	25.7

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.35	1.80	1.87	1.50	2.22	1.46
2	1.47	1.80	1.87	1.88	1.89	1.81
3	1.55	1.91	1.75	2.24	2.47	1.62
4	1.62	1.74	1.79	2.16	2.17	1.81

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
6	1.47	1.63	1.76	2.36	2.18	2.01
8	1.49	1.80	1.69	2.12	1.91	1.87
12	1.42	1.62	1.88	2.19	2.10	1.77

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $1.0K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

15.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 12 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,097 $\pm$ \$159	28.7%	\$8,671	28.2	+\$1,944
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 30%	\$1,909 $\pm$ \$249	27.1%	\$7,924	25.4	+\$1,594
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	1.75% / 5 / 1.07 / 15%	\$1,755 $\pm$ \$116	29.0%	\$7,052	25.9	+\$1,496
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	\$1,528 $\pm$ \$221	26.4%	\$6,514	23.3	+\$1,167

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,877 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

15.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,000$; take-profit 106.0 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.4620$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 3,566,929$; duration about 1.33 h of open market (losers 1.27 h, winners 1.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$3,750 at risk \$1,750: take-profit 197 points away, $p = 0.3160$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: \$59,758 = 59.8% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

15.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.6193$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.88$, $K = \$584$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6269$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.4706$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.34$, $K = \$557$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4717$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.6193 \times 0.4706 = 0.2914$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2875 $\pm$ 0.0057**.

15.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$15,000$; split 100%; per-trade cap \$3,750.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3645$; expected paid cycles 0.5735; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,637.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,363 = \$8,637$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$8,637 per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$8,671** per funded account; 10.4% of attempts reach a payout; median 54 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6355	\$0
1	0.2316	\$15,000
2	0.0844	\$30,000
3	0.0308	\$45,000
4	0.0112	\$60,000

Chain values.

15.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2914 \times 8,637 - 549.00 = \$1,968$; engine \$1,944.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 28.22$ days per attempt, so 1.08 attempts a month per slot and \$592 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 16.9 days on average; a passed one 23.4 days, then 33.1 days funded with 0.57 payouts; 43.8 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,944 / 28.22 = \$2,097 \pm \$159$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

15.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549	\$549	\$2,097 ± \$159	\$2,097
50K	\$379	\$758	\$936 ± \$81	\$1,872
25K	\$199	\$796	\$458 ± \$41	\$1,831
10K	\$89	\$890	\$173 ± \$17	\$1,729
5K	\$59	\$1,180	\$71 ± \$9	\$1,416

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: one active account of each size. **Copying:** between your own FXIFY accounts. **The plan:** $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 50K$; $1 \times 25K$; $1 \times 10K$; $1 \times 5K$, worth \$3,734 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 50K$; $1 \times 25K$; $1 \times 10K$; $1 \times 5K$, worth \$3,734 a month (5 accounts).

15.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
× 1	\$2,140 ± \$137	+\$2,014	28.6	29.7%
× 1.5	\$1,672 ± \$325	+\$1,456	26.5	27.1%
× 2	\$1,646 ± \$309	+\$1,399	25.9	25.3%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

15.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10 leverage (USDJPY was searched too)
- each day's take-profit capped at 25% of the cycle target less \$1 per \$100K (and 40% per trade), so the best-day rule always holds
- one Classic account of each size: 100K, 50K, 25K, 10K and 5K
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: intercom.help/fxify/en/articles/12130186-2-phase-account-types (refunds by type); intercom.help/fxify/en/articles/14834680-the-2-phase-classic-account; fxify.com/blog/cheapest-path-funded-50k-fxify/ (refund guide, 14 September 2026).

FundedNext Stellar 2-Step

EURUSD; plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$1,389 a month per 100K** ($\pm \$155$); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$2,841 a month.

16.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549.99 for 100K; \$1,049.99 for 200K (from August 2026); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10%
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first reward 21 days after the funded account opens, then every 14 days (the 21-day option); 3-day and on-demand options exist with other conditions
15% challenge reward	for accounts bought from 12 January 2026, paid only on Scale-Up eligibility (not counted)
Consistency rule	none on Stellar accounts; profit around high-impact news counts at 40% on funded accounts
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:10 gold (from January 2026); 1:10 indices (from May 2026)
Per person	\$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	between your own challenge accounts; never into a funded account
Monitored as gambling	one-sided betting (remedy: a 1% risk limit), account rolling, breaching several accounts in a short span, losses exceeding gains (remedies: 40% consistency on on-demand rewards or a lower split)

16.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549.99
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 80%; \$549.99 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 21 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:100 (evaluation), 1:100 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

16.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on EURUSD:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	12	1.25	20%	\$1,536 ± \$554	25.9%	22.2
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$1,522 ± \$355	25.0%	19.6
1.75%	4	1.25	15%	\$1,439 ± \$263	25.2%	22.1
1.50%	12	1	30%	\$1,431 ± \$477	24.2%	20.1
1.75%	4	1	10%	\$1,422 ± \$305	24.8%	20.5
1.50%	6	1	15%	\$1,409 ± \$121	23.8%	20.2
1.75%	5	1.25	20%	\$1,389 ± \$272	25.2%	21.7
1.75%	6	1.25	8%	\$1,376 ± \$124	26.1%	23.9

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	0.93	0.87	0.91	0.81	0.68	0.62
2	1.24	1.42	1.43	1.05	1.32	1.25
3	1.12	1.21	1.26	1.34	1.19	1.51

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
4	1.19	1.63	1.57	1.65	1.70	1.37
6	1.15	1.65	1.28	1.47	1.40	1.11
8	1.18	1.40	1.26	1.21	1.49	1.56
12	1.17	1.45	1.27	1.21	1.51	1.50

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.2$ – $0.8K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.25$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

16.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 12 / 1.25 / 20%	\$1,389 $\pm$ \$155	26.3%	\$5,909	22.1	+\$1,006
FundedNext Stellar, gold	1.5% / 4 / 1 / 15%	\$2,207 $\pm$ \$246	29.2%	\$6,950	20.4	+\$1,477

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$1,590 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

16.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.0853\% = 0.1066\%$ of the price; at 1.1256 that is **12.0 pips**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$1,642,208$; **\$145.90 per pip**; at \$10.00 per pip per standard lot, **14.59 lots** (round down).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$101.82$, $\rho = c/l = 5.82\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,200$; take-profit 22.6 pips away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3464$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,778,180$; duration about 2.95 h of open market (losers 2.49 h, winners 3.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$8,000 at risk \$1,750: take-profit 56 pips away, $p = 0.1776$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:100: \$16,422 = 16.4% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.342$.

16.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4719$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.13$, $K = \$1,460$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4739$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5615$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.58$, $K = \$1,514$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5650$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4719 \times 0.5615 = 0.2650$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2634 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

16.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2864$; expected paid cycles 0.4013; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,031.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,969 = \$8,031$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): \$6,583 per funded account, of which the refund term \$157.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$5,909** per funded account; 9.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 44 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7136	\$0
1	0.2044	\$16,550

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.0585	\$32,550
3	0.0168	\$48,550
4	0.0048	\$64,550

Chain values.

16.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2650 \times 6,583 - 549.99 = \$1,194$; engine \$1,006.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 22.06$ days per attempt, so 1.38 attempts a month per slot and \$759 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 14.2 days on average; a passed one 23.3 days, then 21.9 days funded with 0.65 payouts; 33.9 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,006 / 22.06 = \$1,389 \pm \$155$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

16.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549.99	\$550	\$1,389 $\pm$ \$155	\$1,389
200K	\$1,049.99	\$525	\$2,841 $\pm$ \$310	\$1,420

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$2,841 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$2,841 a month (1 accounts).

16.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$1,560 $\pm$ \$477	+\$1,137	22.2	25.6%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,045 $\pm$ \$179	+\$701	20.4	22.0%
$\times 2$	\$493 $\pm$ \$306	+\$303	18.7	17.7%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

16.11 How the plan meets the rules

- its own market (no other account trades it), with its own direction rule: its trades are never copies
- one account at the larger size if it is worth more
- flat around news
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: <https://help.fundnext.com/en/articles/9430123-is-there-a-minimum-trading-day-and-profit-target-in-the-fundnext-account-of-the-stellar-2-step-model>; help.fundnext.com (copy trading; prohibited strategies).

Fintokei ProTrader

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 10$, $m = 1$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,877 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$199); in the plan: $5 \times 100K$, \$14,386 a month.

17.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549 for 100K; \$1,249 for 200K; \$2,599 for 400K; returned with the first payout as a sign-up bonus
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 6%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the equity at the start of the day (midnight UTC; it rises with open profit at midnight) / 10% static
Minimum days	3 separate trading days (a trade opened on the day, any result) per phase and before every payout request
Maximum risk per trade	3% on open trades (a warning, after which consistency rules can apply)
Funded split and payouts	80%; a request 14 days after the first trade or the last processed payout; minimum \$100 (the 3% minimum profit belongs to SwiftTrader); all positions closed at the request
Discretionary consistency rules	if trading is flagged unsustainable: leverage 1:10, daily profit and loss capped at 1%
Leverage	1:100 forex, gold and silver; 1:50 indices
Per person	€500,000 of accounts in total
Copying	your own trades across your own accounts allowed; other people's signals prohibited
Prohibited	reaching a phase target in one or a few identical trades ('all-in'); token trades to complete days

17.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$6,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,400)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; \$549.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$100; 3 trading days in every payout cycle (fillers allowed); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:50 (evaluation), 1:50 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

17.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	10	1	20%	\$2,760 $\pm$ \$630	30.1%	18.3
1.75%	16	1	20%	\$2,705 $\pm$ \$580	30.1%	18.4
1.75%	12	1	30%	\$2,693 $\pm$ \$798	30.2%	18.1
1.75%	12	1	20%	\$2,690 $\pm$ \$544	30.2%	18.4
1.50%	12	0.75	30%	\$2,657 $\pm$ \$1,262	28.4%	17.1
1.50%	12	1	30%	\$2,618 $\pm$ \$1,138	29.4%	18.9
1.50%	8	0.75	30%	\$2,584 $\pm$ \$1,242	27.6%	16.7
1.75%	8	0.75	30%	\$2,523 $\pm$ \$756	27.5%	16.8

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1, 5	2.03	2.54	2.25	2.45	2.16	1.87
2	2.11	2.32	2.66	2.35	2.91	2.54
3	2.03	2.29	2.43	2.65	2.67	2.52

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
4	2.25	2.22	2.34	2.47	2.34	2.29
6	2.05	2.52	2.57	2.28	2.54	2.63
8	2.05	2.43	2.49	2.42	2.56	2.49
12	2.00	2.32	2.51	2.47	3.27	2.99

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $0.9K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

17.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 10 / 1 / 20%	\$2,877 $\pm$ \$199	29.7%	\$7,767	18.6	+\$1,757

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$3,209 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

17.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$639,413$; **\$20.58 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,200$; take-profit 157.5 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3506$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,671,614$; duration about 1.85 h of open market (losers 1.57 h, winners 2.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): **\$8,000 at risk \$1,750**: take-profit 391 points away, $p = 0.1787$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:50: **\$12,788 = 12.8%** of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.213$.

17.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.5168$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.67$, $K = \$608$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5212$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$6,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5803$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.69$, $K = \$614$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5859$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6250$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,400; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.5168 \times 0.5803 = 0.2999$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2970 ± 0.0058** .

17.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3134$; expected paid cycles 0.4564; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,144.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 856 = \$9,144$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): **\$7,487** per funded account, of which the refund term **\$172**.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,767** per funded account; 11.4% of attempts reach a payout; median 32 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6866	\$0
1	0.2152	\$16,549
2	0.0674	\$32,549

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
3	0.0211	\$48,549
4	0.0066	\$64,549

Chain values.

17.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2999 \times 7,487 - 549.00 = \$1,696$; engine \$1,757.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.59$ days per attempt, so 1.64 attempts a month per slot and \$899 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.4 days on average; a passed one 18.7 days, then 15.8 days funded with 0.61 payouts; 33.3 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,757 / 18.59 = \$2,877 \pm \$199$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

17.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549	\$549	\$2,877 $\pm$ \$199	\$2,877
200K	\$1,249	\$624	\$5,560 $\pm$ \$396	\$2,780

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: €500,000 of accounts. **Copying:** your own trades across your own accounts. **The plan:** $5 \times 100K$, worth \$14,386 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $5 \times 100K$, worth \$14,386 a month (5 accounts).

17.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,810 $\pm$ \$717	+\$1,681	18.2	29.6%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,304 $\pm$ \$276	+\$1,334	17.6	27.7%
$\times 2$	\$1,993 $\pm$ \$292	+\$1,117	17.1	26.0%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

17.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, shared direction; $5 \times 100K$: \$500,000 is about €444,000 at 1.1256, inside the €500,000 cap, and 100K is cheaper per dollar than 200K
- risk 1.75%, below the 3% limit
- every position closed before a payout request
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: <https://support.fintokey.com/en/articles/6538826-how-are-the-daily-loss-limit-and-maximum-loss-limit-calculated>; [support.fintokey.com/en/articles/6538884 \(withdrawals, minimum amount\)](https://support.fintokey.com/en/articles/6538884-withdrawals-minimum-amount); [support.fintokey.com/en/articles/8428030 \(minimum trading days\)](https://support.fintokey.com/en/articles/8428030-minimum-trading-days); <https://support.fintokey.com/en/articles/9464503-what-is-all-in-trading-and-why-is-it-forbidden-to-achieve-profit-target-in-one-trade>.

Hola Prime 2-Step Prime

gold (XAUUSD); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1.03$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,413 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$210); in the plan: $2 \times 100K$, \$4,826 a month.

18.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	about \$599 for 100K (published \$409–\$599 with the payout option); returned 25% with each of the first four payouts
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5% (the 200K size has 4% / 8% limits)
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the previous day's closing balance (relative), reset 17:00 EST / 10% of the initial balance, static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	bi-weekly 80% with 3 profitable days ($+0.5\%$ of the initial balance) within the 14 days; monthly 95% with 7; on-demand 80% with a consistency score of at most 40% and 2% minimum profit
Consistency (funded)	the 40% consistency score applies to on-demand payouts only
Risk (funded)	stop-loss on every trade; at most 2% risk per trade
Leverage	1:50 forex; 1:10 indices and metals
Per person	\$500,000
Copying	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); copying from accounts at other prop firms prohibited
Prohibited	one-sided betting, grid trading, excessive margin use, hedging across accounts, profitability materially dependent on concentrated outcomes
Trade ideas	positions on the same asset and direction that overlap, or one opened within 10 minutes of closing another, are one trade idea; combined risk at most 2%

18.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$599
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; fee returned in 4 equal parts with the first 4 payouts; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

18.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on gold:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	6	1.03	20%	\$2,724 $\pm$ \$535	29.9%	18.6
1.75%	8	1.03	20%	\$2,660 $\pm$ \$643	30.1%	18.8
1.75%	6	1.03	15%	\$2,579 $\pm$ \$388	29.6%	19.1
1.75%	12	1.03	15%	\$2,570 $\pm$ \$488	30.3%	19.4
1.50%	6	1	15%	\$2,536 $\pm$ \$632	29.8%	19.4
1.75%	3.5	1.25	30%	\$2,509 $\pm$ \$701	30.5%	19.8
1.50%	12	1	30%	\$2,508 $\pm$ \$565	29.8%	18.7
1.50%	12	0.89	20%	\$2,499 $\pm$ \$288	29.2%	18.4

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.62	1.46	1.73	1.41	1.70	1.48
2	1.45	1.89	1.64	1.66	2.06	1.74
3	1.89	2.28	2.27	2.14	1.91	1.75
4	1.75	1.91	1.93	2.18	2.30	1.67
6	1.77	2.23	2.01	2.46	2.55	2.14
8	1.69	2.42	2.37	2.22	2.42	2.41
12	1.74	2.24	2.25	2.65	2.26	2.28

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $1.2K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.03$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

18.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 6 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,413 $\pm$ \$210	29.6%	\$6,905	18.2	+\$1,443
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$1,343 $\pm$ \$159	23.5%	\$5,897	17.8	+\$787

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,813 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

18.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.03 \times 0.2838\% = 0.2923\%$ of the price; at 4,176.80 that is **12.2 dollars**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$598,598$; **\$143.32 per dollar**; at \$100.00 per dollar per standard lot, **1.43 lots** (round down).

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$64.65$, $\rho = c/l = 3.69\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,200$; take-profit 22.8 dollars away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3490$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,713,135$; duration about 1.98 h of open market (losers 1.67 h, winners 2.6 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$8,000 at risk \$1,750: take-profit 56 dollars away, $p = 0.1783$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: \$59,860 = 59.9% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.028$.

18.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4979$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.61$, $K = \$953$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5021$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5920$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.99$, $K = \$988$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6000$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4979 \times 0.5920 = 0.2947$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2957 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

18.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3024$; expected paid cycles 0.4335; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,680.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,320 = \$8,680$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,009 per funded account, of which the refund term \$64.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,905** per funded account; 11.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 32 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6976	\$0
1	0.2110	\$16,150
2	0.0638	\$32,300
3	0.0193	\$48,449
4	0.0058	\$64,599

Chain values.

18.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2947 \times 7,009 - 599.00 = \$1,467$; engine \$1,443.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.20$ days per attempt, so 1.67 attempts a month per slot and \$1,002 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.6 days on average; a passed one 18.6 days, then 15.2 days funded with 0.56 payouts; 33.3 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,443 / 18.20 = \$2,413 \pm \$210$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

18.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$599	\$599	\$2,413 ± \$210	\$2,413

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$500,000. **Copying:** only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms. **The plan:** $2 \times 100K$, worth \$4,826 a month (2 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $2 \times 100K$, worth \$4,826 a month (2 accounts).

18.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,129 ± \$443	+\$1,250	17.9	28.5%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,623 ± \$804	+\$904	16.9	25.8%
$\times 2$	\$1,375 ± \$552	+\$734	16.3	22.7%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

18.11 How the plan meets the rules

- its own market, traded by no other account (so nothing is copied from another firm)
- two accounts: one master and one copier, the most Hola Prime allows to share trades
- bi-weekly payouts; daily profit target until 3 profitable days in the cycle
- at least 10 minutes after any close before the next trade, so no two trades are one idea
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: holaprime.com/forex/faq/hola-prime-challenges/hola-prime-2-step-prime-challenge/.

Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$2,653 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$214); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$5,278 a month.

19.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$497 for 100K; \$997 for 200K; refund policy reported inconsistently (assumed none)
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the day's starting balance (relative) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% bi-weekly: the first request 14 days after the first trade on the funded account, with 5 trading days of the same strategy (a trade opened and closed on the day; minimal lots to complete days not allowed) and at least \$100 of profit; then every 14 days (on-demand payouts, with their 40% rule, are a different option)
Risk	never risk or lose 2% or more on one trade or group of trades closed together
Duration	the average trade must last more than 2 minutes, and at least half of the profit must come from trades longer than 2 minutes
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:30 metals
Per person	\$400,000 per household; \$300,000 per strategy
Copying	from your own external accounts with proof of ownership
Prohibited	gambling, 'all or nothing' trading

19.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$497
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$100; first payout only after 5 trading days (no fillers; the plan trades at most once a day until then); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

19.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	12	0.75	30%	\$2,542 $\pm$ \$879	27.0%	16.6
1.75%	6	0.75	30%	\$2,443 $\pm$ \$924	26.8%	16.5
1.75%	8	1	30%	\$2,430 $\pm$ \$635	28.5%	18.0
1.75%	6	1	30%	\$2,420 $\pm$ \$753	28.4%	17.9
1.75%	8	0.6	20%	\$2,341 $\pm$ \$620	25.1%	16.8
1.75%	8	0.75	15%	\$2,323 $\pm$ \$639	26.5%	17.3
1.75%	6	0.75	15%	\$2,319 $\pm$ \$708	26.8%	17.3
1.75%	12	1	30%	\$2,313 $\pm$ \$697	27.8%	17.7

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.59	1.78	1.83	1.58	1.85	1.30
2	1.77	1.97	2.15	1.93	2.05	2.39

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
3	1.90	2.11	2.47	2.45	2.54	2.39
4	1.94	2.52	2.05	2.55	3.02	2.36
6	1.85	2.37	2.37	2.77	2.68	2.90
8	1.88	2.21	2.36	2.69	2.59	2.41
12	1.93	2.22	2.26	2.50	2.32	2.69

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $1.1K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 0.75$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

19.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 12 / 0.75 / 30%	\$2,653 $\pm$ \$214	26.9%	\$7,214	16.6	+\$1,445

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$3,199 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

19.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$852,551$; **\$27.44 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$54.56$, $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 147.8 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3015$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,095,486$; duration about 1.30 h of open market (losers 1.06 h, winners 1.9 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$12,000 at risk \$1,750; take-profit 439 points away, $p = 0.1268$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: \$42,628 = 42.6% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

19.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4571$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.39$, $K = \$794$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4599$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5884$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.64$, $K = \$872$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6077$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4571 \times 0.5884 = 0.2689$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2692 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

19.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$12,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2302$; expected paid cycles 0.2990; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,989.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,011 = \$8,989$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,191 per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,214** per funded account; 9.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 31 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7698	\$0
1	0.1772	\$24,000

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.0408	\$48,000
3	0.0094	\$72,000
4	0.0022	\$96,000

Chain values.

19.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2689 \times 7,191 - 497.00 = \$1,437$; engine \$1,445.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.58$ days per attempt, so 1.84 attempts a month per slot and \$912 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 10.2 days on average; a passed one 18.3 days, then 15.7 days funded with 0.48 payouts; 30.6 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,445 / 16.58 = \$2,653 \pm \$214$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

19.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$497	\$497	\$2,653 $\pm$ \$214	\$2,653
200K	\$997	\$498	\$5,278 $\pm$ \$415	\$2,639

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 per household, \$300,000 per strategy. **Copying:** from your own external accounts with proof. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$5,278 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K; 1 $\times$ 100K, worth \$7,931 a month (2 accounts).

19.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,517 $\pm$ \$409	+\$1,360	16.4	26.5%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,101 $\pm$ \$654	+\$1,082	15.7	24.3%
$\times 2$	\$1,712 $\pm$ \$320	+\$848	15.1	22.1%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

19.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, 1.75% risk (below the 2% rule after cost)
- bi-weekly payouts; until the funded account has 5 trading days, at most one normal trade a day
- trade durations recorded: the plan's trades last hours on average
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/10570531-bi-weekly-performance-fee; <https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8447268-what-is-the-2-minute-average-trade-duration-rule>; help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8420429-alpha-pro-8-10.

FunderPro Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 8$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$2,919 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$209); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$5,976 a month.

20.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$539 for 100K list (often 20% off); \$989 for 200K; refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5%, balance-based, reset 00:00 GMT+3; the base is not stated (the model takes the stricter of the initial and the day's balance) / 10% static
Minimum days	a minimum number of trading days per phase by default (a 'No Minimum Trading Days' add-on is sold for Classic only); 4 per phase as published by reviewers (the official pages read do not state the number)
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days; at least \$100 of profit for every reward
Consistency rule	none on Classic
Risk per trade	at most 2%
Margin (funded)	at most 20% of the starting balance as margin per asset class (FX, metals, energies, US and EU indices, shares, crypto); first breach: the profit of the breaching trades is removed; second: the account fails. No margin rule on challenges.
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:30 indices (Classic and Pro challenges)
Per person	\$200,000
Copying	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts; no copying from accounts you do not own

20.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$539
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the smaller of the initial and the day's starting balance (base not stated by the firm: the stricter); at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the smaller of the initial and the day's starting balance (base not stated by the firm: the stricter); at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the smaller of the initial and the day's starting balance (base not stated by the firm: the stricter); split 80%; \$539.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$100; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:30 (evaluation), 1:30 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry, and at most 20% of the starting balance on the funded account

20.3 The search

Searched: 840 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	8	1.07	30%	\$2,629 $\pm$ \$1,101	28.3%	18.2
1.75%	6	1.07	20%	\$2,625 $\pm$ \$961	29.4%	18.6
1.75%	8	1.07	15%	\$2,545 $\pm$ \$290	28.5%	18.8
1.75%	6	1.07	15%	\$2,493 $\pm$ \$643	28.3%	18.8
1.75%	12	1.07	30%	\$2,490 $\pm$ \$871	28.3%	18.1
1.75%	16	1.07	30%	\$2,488 $\pm$ \$860	28.3%	18.1
1.75%	10	1.07	30%	\$2,472 $\pm$ \$960	28.2%	18.1
1.75%	4	1.07	15%	\$2,461 $\pm$ \$460	28.5%	18.8

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.87	2.01	1.94	2.25	2.25	2.22

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
2	1.91	2.12	2.12	2.28	2.42	2.42
3	2.09	2.67	2.72	2.18	2.05	2.51
4	1.77	2.18	2.68	2.82	2.56	2.43
6	2.15	2.34	2.48	2.77	2.69	2.55
8	2.03	2.10	2.56	3.02	2.68	2.74
12	1.98	2.06	2.33	3.06	2.85	3.07

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.4$ – $1.0K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

20.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 8 / 1.07 / 30%	\$2,919 $\pm$ \$209	29.2%	\$7,955	18.6	+\$1,780
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	1.5% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$2,186 $\pm$ \$242	25.9%	\$7,041	17.8	+\$1,281

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$3,406 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

20.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 210.0 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3023$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,066,929$; duration about 2.64 h of open market (losers 2.14 h, winners 3.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$12,000 at risk \$1,750: take-profit 626 points away, $p = 0.1269$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:30: \$19,919 = 19.9% of the starting balance (limit 20%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

20.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4705$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.40$, $K = \$557$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4717$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6193$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.92$, $K = \$585$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6269$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4705 \times 0.6193 = 0.2914$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2916 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

20.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$12,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2361$; expected paid cycles 0.3090; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,275.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 725 = \$9,275$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,547 per funded account, of which the refund term \$127.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,955** per funded account; 10.8% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7639	\$0
1	0.1803	\$24,539
2	0.0426	\$48,539
3	0.0100	\$72,539
4	0.0024	\$96,539

Chain values.

20.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2914 \times 7,547 - 539.00 = \$1,660$; engine \$1,780.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.57$ days per attempt, so 1.64 attempts a month per slot and \$884 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.4 days on average; a passed one 20.3 days, then 15.8 days funded with 0.58 payouts; 33.5 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,780 / 18.57 = \$2,919 \pm \$209$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

20.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$539	\$539	\$2,919 $\pm$ \$209	\$2,919
200K	\$989	\$494	\$5,976 $\pm$ \$426	\$2,988

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$200,000. **Copying:** no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$5,976 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$5,976 a month (1 accounts).

20.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,671 $\pm$ \$450	+\$1,622	18.5	28.7%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,370 $\pm$ \$402	+\$1,389	17.8	27.1%
$\times 2$	\$2,250 $\pm$ \$207	+\$1,284	17.4	25.8%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

20.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account, the larger size if it is worth more
- risk at most 1.75%, below the 2% limit
- stop at least 1.066 hourly standard deviations on the Nasdaq at 1.75% risk (USDJPY: 0.629 at 1.5%), so the funded margin stays under 20% of the starting balance
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: <https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/421458-is-there-a-margin-rule-on-funded-accounts>; [support.funderpro.com/en/articles/419844 \(rewards, \\$100 minimum\)](https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/419844-rewards-$100-minimum); [support.funderpro.com/en/articles/412020 \(add-ons\)](https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/412020-add-ons); <https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/422676-leverage-on-funderpro-challenges>.

Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 3.5$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 15% of the account; **\$2,197 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$135); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$3,558 a month.

21.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$524 for 100K; \$974 for 200K; refundable
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% subtracted from the higher of balance and equity at 5 pm New York (relative) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 valid days per phase; a day is valid only with at least 0.5% profit
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days from the first trade; 4 valid days (+0.5%) per payout cycle for accounts bought from 25 July 2026; minimum \$100 (the 3% minimum belongs to on-demand rewards); the first two payouts at most 6% of the account or \$10,000
Daily profit cap (funded)	\$3,000 a day at every account size; profit above it is deducted (not a breach)
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	evaluation 1:20 on indices; funded 1:10 on indices, 1:50 forex
Per person	\$400,000 funded
Copying	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts
Goat Guard (funded)	a combined floating loss of 2%: the first time the split falls to 50%, the second time the account is breached

21.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$524
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss 5% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; \$524.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$100; payout caps \$6,000, \$6,000; profit above \$3,000 a day not counted; 4 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

21.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	3.5	1.07	15%	\$2,277 $\pm$ \$204	29.4%	21.9
1.75%	8	1.07	15%	\$2,274 $\pm$ \$206	29.5%	22.1
1.75%	6	1.07	20%	\$2,248 $\pm$ \$395	29.1%	21.9
1.75%	4	1.07	20%	\$2,210 $\pm$ \$521	28.9%	21.6
1.75%	12	1.07	10%	\$2,202 $\pm$ \$217	29.0%	22.0
1.75%	6	1.07	10%	\$2,199 $\pm$ \$109	28.6%	22.0
1.75%	8	1.07	10%	\$2,179 $\pm$ \$266	29.4%	22.2
1.75%	2.5	1.07	15%	\$2,165 $\pm$ \$318	28.9%	21.5

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%	20%
1.5	1.61	1.99	2.07	2.09	1.97	2.02
2	1.67	1.78	2.20	2.06	2.19	1.77
3	1.93	2.20	2.16	2.21	2.66	2.24

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%	20%
4	1.88	2.07	2.10	2.41	2.14	2.33
6	1.77	2.18	2.20	2.43	2.24	2.29
8	1.91	2.45	2.25	2.32	2.45	2.12
12	1.94	2.30	2.13	2.35	2.27	2.28

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $0.9K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

21.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 3.5 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,197 $\pm$ \$135	29.2%	\$7,177	21.7	+\$1,568
GFT Standard, USDJPY	1.75% / 3 / 1.25 / 10%	\$1,834 $\pm$ \$135	27.5%	\$6,686	21.8	+\$1,314

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,534 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

21.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,333$; take-profit 175.3 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3417$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,900,263$; duration about 2.21 h of open market (losers 1.85 h, winners 2.9 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): **\$2,400** at risk **\$1,750**: take-profit 127 points away, $p = 0.4178$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: **\$59,758** = 59.8% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

21.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4709$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.61$, $K = \$558$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4721$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6197$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.03$, $K = \$584$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6277$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4709 \times 0.6197 = 0.2919$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2915 $\pm$ 0.0057**.

21.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$6,000$, $X = \$15,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$3,000.
The first payouts are capped at \$6,000, \$6,000 (7.2: two special first cycles).
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.5860$; expected paid cycles 1.1190; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,526.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 1,474 = \$8,526$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$7,128 per funded account, of which the refund term \$307.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,177** per funded account; 18.1% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.4140	\$0

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
1	0.2426	\$5,324
2	0.2213	\$10,124
3	0.0787	\$22,124
4	0.0280	\$34,124

Chain values.

21.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2919 \times 7,128 - 524.00 = \$1,556$; engine \$1,568.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 21.73$ days per attempt, so 1.40 attempts a month per slot and \$734 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.3 days on average; a passed one 19.4 days, then 28.2 days funded with 1.35 payouts; 36.8 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,568 / 21.73 = \$2,197 \pm \$135$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

21.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$524	\$524	\$2,197 $\pm$ \$135	\$2,197
200K	\$974	\$487	\$3,558 $\pm$ \$231	\$1,779

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 funded. **Copying:** no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$3,558 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$3,558 a month (1 accounts).

21.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,199 $\pm$ \$137	+\$1,549	21.5	28.1%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,867 $\pm$ \$131	+\$1,257	20.5	27.2%
$\times 2$	\$1,788 $\pm$ \$245	+\$1,178	20.1	25.5%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

21.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account; Nasdaq with a stop of at least 1.066 sd at 1.75% risk (funded 1:10, margin at most 60%) or USDJPY
- take-profit capped at the day's remaining \$3,000
- one open position at a time, risking at most 1.75% plus cost: Goat Guard's 2% cannot trigger without an intraday gap
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/13575169-2-step-standard; help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/9549359-all-about-rewards-and-profit-splits; <https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/10742107-what-is-goat-guard>.

BrightFunded 2-Step Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 12$, $m = 1$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$2,607 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$259); in the plan: 1 $\times$ 200K, \$5,208 a month.

22.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	€497 for 100K (\$559.42 at 1.1256); €997 for 200K (\$1,122.22); refund only with the paid refund add-on
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first payout about 30 days after funding, then every 14 days
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:40 gold
Per person	\$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	allowed between your own accounts at any firm
Trading days	a day counts only if at least one trade stays open 60 seconds or more

22.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$559.42
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 30 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

22.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	12	1	30%	\$2,207 $\pm$ \$709	28.4%	19.1
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$2,197 $\pm$ \$659	29.1%	19.5
1.75%	3.5	1	20%	\$2,183 $\pm$ \$488	28.4%	19.4
1.75%	8	0.6	20%	\$2,080 $\pm$ \$898	25.6%	18.2
1.75%	5	1	20%	\$2,073 $\pm$ \$318	28.6%	19.4
1.75%	6	0.75	30%	\$2,058 $\pm$ \$897	26.6%	17.2
1.50%	6	0.75	20%	\$2,052 $\pm$ \$572	27.0%	18.8
1.75%	6	1	10%	\$2,051 $\pm$ \$305	28.6%	22.3

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.38	1.65	1.81	1.90	1.35	1.45
2	1.61	1.93	1.96	1.96	2.12	1.68
3	1.70	2.19	2.31	2.06	1.97	2.04
4	1.75	1.96	2.09	2.40	2.65	1.72
6	1.55	2.08	2.38	1.97	2.48	1.96
8	1.70	1.85	2.30	1.86	2.02	2.14

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
12	1.67	1.81	2.32	2.14	2.22	2.44

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $1.0K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

22.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 12 / 1 / 30%	\$2,607 $\pm$ \$259	29.4%	\$7,621	19.6	+\$1,681

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,766 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

22.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$639,413$; \$20.58 **per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 196.4 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3022$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,071,614$; duration about 2.31 h of open market (losers 1.87 h, winners 3.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): \$12,000 at risk \$1,750; take-profit 585 points away, $p = 0.1269$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: \$31,971 = 32.0% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

22.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4684$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.35$, $K = \$595$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4698$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6154$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.95$, $K = \$628$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$10,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6240$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4684 \times 0.6154 = 0.2882$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2940 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

22.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$12,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2352$; expected paid cycles 0.3076; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,232.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 10,000 - 768 = \$9,232$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,386 per funded account.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,621** per funded account; 8.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 50 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7648	\$0
1	0.1799	\$24,000
2	0.0423	\$48,000
3	0.0100	\$72,000
4	0.0023	\$96,000

22.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2882 \times 7,386 - 559.42 = \$1,569$; engine \$1,681.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.63$ days per attempt, so 1.55 attempts a month per slot and \$867 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.1 days on average; a passed one 21.2 days, then 18.6 days funded with 0.41 payouts; 33.7 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,681/19.63 = \$2,607 \pm \$259$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

22.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$559.42	\$559	\$2,607 $\pm$ \$259	\$2,607
200K	\$1,122.22	\$561	\$5,208 $\pm$ \$518	\$2,604

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** allowed between your own accounts. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$5,208 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$10,426 a month (4 accounts).

22.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,433 $\pm$ \$435	+\$1,562	19.5	29.5%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,949 $\pm$ \$381	+\$1,178	18.4	26.6%
$\times 2$	\$1,881 $\pm$ \$473	+\$1,125	18.2	25.4%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

22.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account (recommended) or four, Nasdaq
- every counted day includes a trade held at least 2 minutes (the plan's trades last hours on average, but a stop can be hit in seconds, so the day's count never relies on it)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: <https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-what-are-the-current-rules-for-the-evaluation-process>; [help.brightfunded.com \(refund add-on\)](https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-refund-add-on).

Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 4$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 15% of the account; **\$2,231 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$159); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$4,469 a month.

23.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$579 for 100K list (often half price with a code); \$1,162 for 200K; refunded after the fourth payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 4%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the initial balance below the higher of balance and equity at 5 pm New York (fixed) / 8% static
Minimum days	3 profitable days per phase
Funded split and payouts	85% every 14 days; the payout requires the minimum trading days requirement (read strictly as 3 profitable days in the cycle), the account above its initial balance and all positions closed; minimum \$100 by crypto, \$500 by Rise
Guardian Shield (funded)	all trades closed at a 2% open loss; first time the split falls to 50%, second time the account closes
Leverage	1:10 on indices
Per person	\$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each
Copying	your own accounts only
Prohibited	margin use above 80% counts as gambling
Holding time	the minimum holding time is 2 minutes (tick scalping)
News (funded)	no opening or closing 5 minutes before and after red-folder news

23.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$579
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000 (4% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$4,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000 (4% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$1,600)
Funded account	maximum loss \$8,000, static; daily loss \$4,000 (4% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 85%; \$579.00 of the fee returned with payout number 4; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$100; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

23.3 The search

Searched: 315 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	4	1.25	15%	\$2,058 $\pm$ \$331	29.8%	18.7
1.50%	12	0.92	15%	\$1,934 $\pm$ \$473	28.8%	17.8
1.75%	2	1.07	8%	\$1,900 $\pm$ \$216	29.1%	19.3
1.75%	1.75	1.25	10%	\$1,880 $\pm$ \$328	29.3%	19.1
1.75%	2.5	1.25	10%	\$1,872 $\pm$ \$254	29.5%	19.1
1.75%	3	1.07	15%	\$1,869 $\pm$ \$285	28.9%	17.6
1.75%	3	1.25	10%	\$1,844 $\pm$ \$575	29.6%	19.2
1.75%	2	1.07	10%	\$1,840 $\pm$ \$402	29.0%	18.5

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%
1.5	1.59	1.82	1.68	1.84	1.70
2	1.77	1.76	1.93	2.28	1.58

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%
3	1.45	1.67	2.01	2.18	2.01
4	1.54	1.76	1.97	1.75	2.24
6	1.54	1.38	1.85	1.90	1.76
8	1.65	1.58	1.91	1.87	2.14
12	1.59	1.54	1.91	1.87	1.90

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.3$ – $0.7K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.25$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

23.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 15%	\$2,231 $\pm$ \$159	30.1%	\$6,554	19.1	+\$1,397

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$2,328 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

23.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.2737\% = 0.3421\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **106.3 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$511,530$; **\$16.46 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$32.74$, $\rho = c/l = 1.87\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 164.0 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3933$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,723,958$; duration about 2.41 h of open market (losers 2.13 h, winners 2.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): **\$6,000** at risk **\$1,750**: take-profit 366 points away, $p = 0.2249$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: **\$51,153** = 51.2% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

23.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4722$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 12.94$, $K = \$390$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4756$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$4,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6301$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 12.75$, $K = \$393$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8,000$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6339$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$1,600; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4722 \times 0.6301 = 0.2975$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.3014 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

23.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$15,000$; split 85%; per-trade cap \$6,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3306$; expected paid cycles 0.4938; expected withdrawn before the split **\$7,425**.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 8,000 - 575 = \$7,425$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): **\$6,318** per funded account, of which the refund term **\$7**.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,554** per funded account; 12.3% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6694	\$0
1	0.2213	\$12,750

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.0732	\$25,500
3	0.0242	\$38,250
4	0.0080	\$51,579

Chain values.

23.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2975 \times 6,318 - 579.00 = \$1,301$; engine \$1,397.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 19.05$ days per attempt, so 1.60 attempts a month per slot and \$925 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.2 days on average; a passed one 19.6 days, then 16.2 days funded with 0.64 payouts; 30.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,397 / 19.05 = \$2,231 \pm \$159$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

23.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$579	\$579	\$2,231 $\pm$ \$159	\$2,231
200K	\$1,162	\$581	\$4,469 $\pm$ \$324	\$2,235

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each. **Copying:** your own accounts only. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$4,469 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$8,925 a month (4 accounts).

23.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,011 $\pm$ \$301	+\$1,221	18.5	29.6%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,765 $\pm$ \$218	+\$1,046	18.1	28.4%
$\times 2$	\$1,576 $\pm$ \$384	+\$908	17.5	26.2%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

23.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account, Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10
- risk at most 1.75%: a stop-out stays below the 2% shield unless the price gaps
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: help.blueguardian.com/en/articles/14062291-2-step-standard-rules.

Maven 2-Step

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 3$, $m = 1$, payout target 4.9% of the account; **\$1,409 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$82); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$, \$1,409 a month.

24.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$440 for 100K (largest 2-Step size); refunded with the third payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% of the higher of equity and balance at 00:00 UTC (relative: 4% of \$1,100 in the FAQ's example) / 8% static
Profitable days	3 per phase, each at least +0.5%
Funded split and payouts	80%; a withdrawal every 10 business days after the first trade; 3 profitable days (+0.5%) in the funded phase before a withdrawal; at most \$10,000 per trader per rolling 30 days, counted on the date the profit is closed, the excess voided
Leverage	1:75 forex; 1:20 indices and commodities
Per person	\$200,000
Consistency (funded)	if the total profit exceeds \$5,000, the best day (trades with less than 24 hours between a close and the next opening count as one day) or single trade may not exceed 50% of the cycle's profit; the 20% consistency score belongs to instant accounts
Risk interview	after \$5,000 of total profit; a payout is not processed without it
News	no opening or closing within 2 minutes of a red-folder release, in evaluations and funded accounts
Gambling	large bets at a reward:risk of 1:1.25 or lower ('random odds')
Refund	with the third withdrawal

24.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$440
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200); every trade at least 1:1.5
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000); every trade at least 1:1.5
Funded account	maximum loss \$8,000, static; daily loss 4% of the day's starting balance, recomputed at every reset; split 80%; \$440.00 of the fee returned with payout number 3; first payout 14 days after the first funded trade, then every 14 days; plan: funded profit never above \$4,900, a margin under the \$5,000 above which the firm's 50% rule applies; plan: closed profit in any 30 days never above \$10,000 (the excess would be voided); every trade at least 1:1.5; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

24.3 The search

Searched: 336 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.50%	3	1	4.9%	\$1,393 $\pm$ \$97	27.1%	24.5
1.50%	4	1.25	4.9%	\$1,357 $\pm$ \$226	27.1%	26.1
1.75%	2	1	4%	\$1,356 $\pm$ \$63	26.6%	24.4
1.75%	4	1	4%	\$1,328 $\pm$ \$108	26.6%	24.8
1.75%	6	1.25	4.9%	\$1,311 $\pm$ \$134	27.1%	25.6
1.75%	12	1.25	4%	\$1,305 $\pm$ \$175	27.4%	26.4
1.50%	3	1	4%	\$1,296 $\pm$ \$162	26.2%	24.4
1.75%	12	0.75	4.9%	\$1,275 $\pm$ \$179	24.6%	23.1

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	2%	3%	4%	4.9%
1.5	0.99	1.27	1.26	1.17
2	1.09	1.28	1.29	1.45
3	0.90	1.21	1.46	1.48
4	1.12	1.16	1.19	1.26
6	1.13	1.29	1.26	1.34
8	1.05	1.23	1.40	1.28
12	1.08	1.17	1.35	1.35

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.2$ – $0.5K$ for most cells) at risk \$1,500 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

24.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.5% / 3 / 1 / 4.9%	\$1,409 $\pm$ \$82	26.3%	\$5,964	24.4	+\$1,130

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 7 reported \$1,627 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

24.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$548,068$; **\$17.64 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$35.08$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 153.2 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3570$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,052,615$; duration about 1.80 h of open market (losers 1.53 h, winners 2.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win, with every cap the engine applies (the plan's 40%, the firm's best-day share, day cap or ceiling): **\$1,960** at risk **\$1,307** (lowered from \$1,500 so that the reward:risk is at least 1:1.5); take-profit 130 points away, $p = 0.3963$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: **\$27,403** = 27.4% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.457$.

24.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4697$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.01$, $K = \$475$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4703$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5742$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.90$, $K = \$483$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$8,000$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5782$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6154$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4697 \times 0.5742 = 0.2697$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2632 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

24.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$4,900$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$1,960.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.5942$; expected paid cycles 1.4646; expected withdrawn before the split \$6,886.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 8,000 - 1,114 = \$6,886$ (gap -0.00).

Cash (chain): \$5,601 per funded account, of which the refund term \$92.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$5,964** per funded account; 16.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 33 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.4058	\$0
1	0.2411	\$3,920
2	0.1433	\$7,840
3	0.0851	\$12,200
4	0.0506	\$16,120

Chain values.

24.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2697 \times 5,601 - 440.00 = \$1,071$; engine \$1,130.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 24.41$ days per attempt, so 1.25 attempts a month per slot and \$549 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 11.1 days on average; a passed one 19.8 days, then 40.0 days funded with 1.78 payouts; 37.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,130 / 24.41 = \$1,409 \pm \$82$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

24.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$440	\$440	\$1,409 $\pm$ \$82	\$1,409

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$200,000; at most \$10,000 of profit closed per rolling 30 days per person. **Copying:** –. **The plan:** $1 \times 100K$, worth \$1,409 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 100K$, worth \$1,409 a month (1 accounts).

24.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$1,371 $\pm$ \$158	+\$1,097	24.4	27.3%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,161 $\pm$ \$147	+\$868	22.8	25.0%
$\times 2$	\$1,069 $\pm$ \$91	+\$762	21.7	23.2%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

24.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one 100K account, Nasdaq
- every trade at a reward:risk of at least 1:1.5
- funded profit never above \$4,900 (payout targets of 2–4.9%), \$100 under the threshold, so the 50% rule never applies even with a take-profit filled a few points better
- no win placed that could take the profit closed in any 30 days above \$10,000
- the risk interview booked as soon as it is offered
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase takes at least three winning days
- at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no take-profit and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so fewer than 1 trade in 1,000 can close within 2 minutes
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when the room above the floor is below a tenth of the normal risk, one last trade with its stop at the floor: the account recovers or ends in a breach that frees its allocation
- minimum trading days completed, where fillers are allowed, with one minimal trade a day held at least 2 minutes and a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K

Sources: <https://maventrading.com/faqs> (read 4 Oct 2026).

Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures in whole contracts, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the risk per trade is searched as well.

25.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$49 a month (Standard path); a reset after a breach \$49; \$149 activation per Express Funded Account
Target / maximum loss	\$3,000 / \$2,000 trailing at the end of each day, locking at the start balance
Consistency (Combine)	best day at most 55% of the profit target (the model uses 50%)
Funded payouts	after 5 winning days of \$150+; at most 50% of the balance and \$2,000 a request; 90%; every payout after the first needs net profit since the last; after the first payout the maximum loss level moves to the starting balance
Per person	up to 5 Express Funded Accounts at once
Trading hours	flat by the daily close (the plan: by 20:00 UTC)

25.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$49 a month (renewed while the evaluation lasts); activation \$149 on passing
Evaluation	target \$3,000; maximum loss \$2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; at least 2 trading days; best day at most 50% of the profit; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$1,200)
Funded account	maximum loss \$2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; split 90%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least \$150; payout caps \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000; a payout at most 50% of the balance; each later payout needs net profit since the last
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd

25.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1.5	1	\$950	\$737 ± \$248	25.3%	5.1
1.5	0.75	\$950	\$733 ± \$342	24.2%	4.4
2	0.75	\$1,100	\$711 ± \$354	26.2%	4.6
4	0.5	\$400	\$619 ± \$387	24.5%	5.1
2	0.75	\$600	\$582 ± \$133	25.4%	4.9
2	1	\$600	\$570 ± \$177	27.3%	5.9
3	0.75	\$600	\$558 ± \$249	25.2%	5.1
3	0.5	\$600	\$500 ± \$251	23.5%	4.6

The ten best grid settings (4,000 attempts each), re-run for 16,000 attempts on paths 111–114.

25.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 1.5$, $m = 1$, risk \$950: at the reference level of 31,070 the stop is 85.0 points and one MNQ contract loses \$170 at the stop, so 5 contracts (rounded down), a risk of \$850; the engine recomputes this at every entry from the path's price (10.1).

Fresh paths: **\$665 ± \$107** a month per account (pass rate 25.2%, 5.1 days per attempt).

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is worth paying only at a deep discount (Apex), and whole contracts make the smallest trade large next to a \$2,000 allowance. The static withdrawal identity does not apply to these accounts (7.1); the values are the engine's.

25.5 How many

5 Express Funded Accounts at once: 5 accounts, worth \$3,323 a month together. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

25.6 How the plan meets the rules

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts
- risk and k searched (no percentage rule applies)

- whole micro contracts, risk rounded down, never fewer than one
- no trade and no day above 40% of the evaluation target

Sources: <https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy>; [help.topstep.com](https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy) (pricing).

Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures in whole contracts, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the risk per trade is searched as well.

26.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$550 list; public 80–90% codes most of 2026 (about \$55); \$99 activation when passed
Target / maximum loss	\$3,000 / \$2,000 trailing end of day; \$1,000 daily loss limit; evaluations expire after 30 days
Funded payouts	100% split; 5 qualifying days per request; no day may make 50% or more of the request's profit; \$500 minimum; caps \$1,500, \$1,500, \$2,000, \$2,500, \$2,500, \$3,000; at most 6 payouts, then the account closes; safety net of drawdown + \$100
Per person	up to 20 funded accounts; copying between your own accounts allowed
Trading hours	flat by 4:59 pm ET every session

26.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$55; activation \$99 on passing
Evaluation	target \$3,000; maximum loss \$2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss \$1,000 (2% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; at least 1 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$1,200); expires after 30 days
Funded account	maximum loss \$2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss \$1,000 (2% of the initial balance) below the day's reference; split 100%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least \$250; minimum payout \$500; payout caps \$1,500, \$1,500, \$2,000, \$2,500, \$2,500, \$3,000; best day below 50% of a payout's profit (strictly); at most 6 payouts; buffer \$2,100 kept in the account
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends; at least 10 minutes between a close and the next entry; no stop or target closer than 0.6 hourly sd

26.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1.5	1	\$600	\$211 ± \$64	25.5%	14.1
3	0.75	\$400	\$190 ± \$142	25.6%	13.2
2	0.75	\$400	\$184 ± \$65	25.4%	14.2
2	1	\$400	\$180 ± \$86	26.6%	16.6
1.5	0.75	\$400	\$175 ± \$58	25.1%	14.6
2	0.75	\$600	\$166 ± \$122	24.2%	12.8
1.5	1	\$400	\$163 ± \$55	26.0%	17.0
1.5	0.75	\$600	\$158 ± \$87	23.4%	13.4

The ten best grid settings (4,000 attempts each), re-run for 16,000 attempts on paths 111–114.

26.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 1.5$, $m = 1$, risk \$600: at the reference level of 31,070 the stop is 85.0 points and one MNQ contract loses \$170 at the stop, so 3 contracts (rounded down), a risk of \$510; the engine recomputes this at every entry from the path's price (10.1).

Fresh paths: **\$242 ± \$38** a month per account (pass rate 25.8%, 14.3 days per attempt).

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is worth paying only at a deep discount (Apex), and whole contracts make the smallest trade large next to a \$2,000 allowance. The static withdrawal identity does not apply to these accounts (7.1); the values are the engine's.

26.5 How many

20 funded accounts: 20 accounts, worth \$4,839 a month together. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

26.6 How the plan meets the rules

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction
- only at 80–90% off: at the list price the value is negative
- whole micro contracts, risk rounded down, never fewer than one
- no trade and no day above 40% of the evaluation target

Sources: <https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/eod-trailing-drawdown-accounts/eod-payouts/>; apextraderfunding.com help centre.

One person, many accounts

Part II valued one account at a time, as a long-run rate. This part runs them together for one person: how much each firm allows, how to fill it, what a first year looks like, what the long run is, how much cash it takes, and what happens if costs are higher, markets move together, news must be avoided, or payouts are refused.

The maximum allocation per person

27.1 Firm by firm

Firm (tier)	Per-person limit	Copying between accounts	Market	Recommended	EV/month	Full allowance	EV/month
FTMO (A)	\$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included	your own accounts, within the cap	Nasdaq	4×100K	\$10,049	4×100K	\$10,049
FundingPips (A)	\$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts	your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services	USDJPY	4×100K	\$9,917	4×100K	\$9,917
The5ers (A)	one 50K or 100K account across Classic and New together; New also 3 × 2.5K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 10K and 1 × 25K (Classic's own small slots not used: fees not readable)	your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$3,099	1×100K, 1×25K, 3×10K, 3×5K, 3×2.5K	\$5,182
FXIFY (A)	one active account of each size	between your own FXIFY accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	\$3,734	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	\$3,734
FundedNext (A)	\$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account	EURUSD	1×200K	\$2,841	1×200K	\$2,841
Fintokei (B)	€500,000 of accounts	your own trades across your own accounts	Nasdaq	5×100K	\$14,386	5×100K	\$14,386
Hola Prime (B)	\$500,000	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms	gold	2×100K	\$4,826	2×100K	\$4,826
Alpha Capital (D)	\$400,000 per household, \$300,000 per strategy	from your own external accounts with proof	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$5,278	1×200K, 1×100K	\$7,931
FunderPro (D)	\$200,000	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$5,976	1×200K	\$5,976
GFT (D)	\$400,000 funded	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$3,558	1×200K	\$3,558
BrightFunded (D)	\$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	allowed between your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$5,208	4×100K	\$10,426
Blue Guardian (D)	\$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each	your own accounts only	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$4,469	4×100K	\$8,925
Maven (D)	\$200,000; at most \$10,000 of profit closed per rolling 30 days per person	–	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$1,409	1×100K	\$1,409
Topstep (A)	5 Express Funded Accounts at once	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–	5×50K	\$3,323
Apex (B)	20 funded accounts	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–	20×50K	\$4,839
Total, CFD firms					\$74,751		\$89,161

EV per month: each account's long-run renewal–reward value from its programme chapter (fresh paths), summed. A firm whose programme is not worth it under the plan's policies has no accounts. The full-allowance column includes The5ers' optional small accounts. It is the largest allocation the plan models under each firm's limit and copying rule; at GFT and FundedNext, whose rules forbid duplicated trades between their own funded accounts, a second account on a market of its own (within GFT's \$400,000 and FundedNext's \$300,000) is not modelled. Futures (Topstep, Apex) are an optional layer, not in either total.

27.2 Four 100K accounts or two 200K?

Scale every dollar amount of a programme by λ (account, targets, limits, risk, payout target, safety margins). The engine's rules then scale exactly: every trade's win, loss and cost scale by λ , the pass probabilities and the time are unchanged, and the funded account's trading cash scales by λ . The fee need not scale, and the refund follows the fee actually paid. Writing $G(S)$ for the funded cash *excluding* the refund, $R(S)$ for the refund and q_R for the chance of reaching the payout that carries it (given a pass):

SCALING AN ACCOUNT (RULES THAT SCALE)

$$\mathbb{E}[V(\lambda S)] = P[\lambda G(S) + q_R R(\lambda S)] - F(\lambda S), \quad \mathbb{E}[T](\lambda S) = \mathbb{E}[T](S).$$

With $R = F$, one account of size λS is worth more than λ accounts of size S by $[\lambda F(S) - F(\lambda S)](1 - P q_R)$ per attempt: the fee saving, less the part of it that would have come back as a refund. (Version 6's formula scaled the refund with the account; it does not.) The formula does not apply where a rule is a fixed dollar amount: GFT's \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap, Maven's \$5,000 threshold (the plan's \$4,900 ceiling) and \$10,000 rolling cap, the minimum payouts (\$50 to \$150), and whole futures contracts. Chapter 11 checks the scaling path by path on the same seeds, once with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee (the rules) and once with the real fee (the contracts).

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K – 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference
FTMO 2-Step	\$607.82	\$1,215.65	\$0.00	\$5,024	\$5,024	+\$0
FundedNext Stellar	\$549.99	\$1,049.99	–\$49.99	\$2,778	\$2,841	+\$63
Fintokei ProTrader	\$549.00	\$1,249.00	\$151.00	\$5,754	\$5,560	–\$195

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K – 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	\$497.00	\$997.00	\$3.00	\$5,306	\$5,278	–\$28
FunderPro Classic	\$539.00	\$989.00	–\$89.00	\$5,838	\$5,976	+\$138
GFT Standard	\$524.00	\$974.00	–\$74.00	\$4,395	\$3,558	–\$836
BrightFunded Classic	\$559.42	\$1,122.22	\$3.38	\$5,213	\$5,208	–\$5
Blue Guardian 2-Step	\$579.00	\$1,162.00	\$4.00	\$4,463	\$4,469	+\$6

Same setting scaled, same sixteen paths and random numbers. Where every rule scales with the account, the only differences are the fee and the refund that follows it (11.1 checks the scaling path by path); GFT's flat \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap do not scale.

The answer, firm by firm. With the corrected formula of 27.2, 200K beats 2 × 100K exactly when $F(2S) < 2F(S)$, by $(2F(S) - F(2S))(1 - P_{q_R})$ per attempt, unless a rule fails to scale. Where the plan holds one account (FunderPro, whose \$200,000 cap allows one 200K; GFT and FundedNext, which forbid duplicated trades between their own funded accounts, so a second account would need a market no other account of the firm trades), the larger size is used if it is worth more than one smaller account. GFT is the case where the formula fails: its \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap bind harder at 200K, so one 200K account is worth less than two 100K accounts would be; two GFT accounts on the same trades are not allowed, and one 200K account is still worth more than one 100K account.

FTMO, 4 × 100K or 2 × 200K. Same fee per dollar, same rules: the paired difference on the same 1,200 seeds is $-\$0 \pm \0 a month for the whole portfolio. In the model the four 100K accounts copy the same trades, so their cash is exactly twice that of two 200K accounts up to rounding: neither is smoother. Two accounts make half as many payout requests, which matters only if refusals are a per-request risk (Chapter 29). The plan uses four 100K accounts for the headline.

Running every account at once

28.1 What adds up and what does not

By linearity (2.1), the expected cash of a set of slots over a horizon is the sum of their expected cash over that horizon, under the policy actually run, however correlated the accounts are. Correlation changes the spread: in a bad week every Nasdaq account loses together, fees fall due together, and a finite budget can run short together.

28.2 One direction per market

No two of your accounts ever hold opposite positions on one market at the same time. When a new trade opens and another of your accounts already holds that market, the new trade takes the same direction; when none does, the plan's rule decides (the sign of the last five hourly closes). The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its job is to keep every account on one side.

28.3 The lockstep simulation

The portfolio results come from an engine that runs every account of one person on shared price paths and one calendar (lockstep.py), processing trades in the order of their entry time so the shared-direction rule is exact, applying every firm's rules (with the plan's policies) to its own accounts, and writing every fee, credit, phase result and payout to a dated ledger. The settings were frozen before any portfolio run, and each simulated life runs on its own new paths (path numbers 100,000 and up, each market its own stream, 3.3), used by nothing else; version 7's market offsets made one life's yen path another life's Nasdaq path, which version 8 removes. Lives are therefore independent and their average is an unbiased estimate with an ordinary interval. In 8,400 simulated years, no two accounts held opposite positions.

28.4 The portfolios: the first year

Portfolio	Accounts	Firms	First year, EV/month (95%)	Months 2–12	Sum of long-run rates	First-year cash p5	median	p95	Lowest cumulative cash: median
Tier A only	15	5	\$25,306 ± \$947	\$28,756	\$29,640	\$6,494	\$282,489	\$682,968	–\$27,534
Tiers A and B	22	7	\$41,571 ± \$1,392	\$47,010	\$48,853	\$76,345	\$477,581	\$1,052,967	–\$38,442
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	28	13	\$62,198 ± \$2,116	\$70,488	\$74,751	\$96,538	\$710,994	\$1,564,866	–\$55,519
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	26	13	\$62,198 ± \$2,116	\$70,488	\$74,751	\$96,538	\$710,994	\$1,564,866	–\$55,519
Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled)	35	13	\$71,913 ± \$2,563	\$81,604	\$87,079	\$97,992	\$808,462	\$1,866,174	–\$66,194
Full allowance + The5ers' small New accounts	45	13	\$73,526 ± \$2,623	\$83,441	\$89,161	\$94,845	\$815,745	\$1,923,231	–\$67,774
Recommended + futures layer	53	15	\$68,223 ± \$2,442	\$77,346	\$82,913	\$94,221	\$767,171	\$1,782,402	–\$63,832

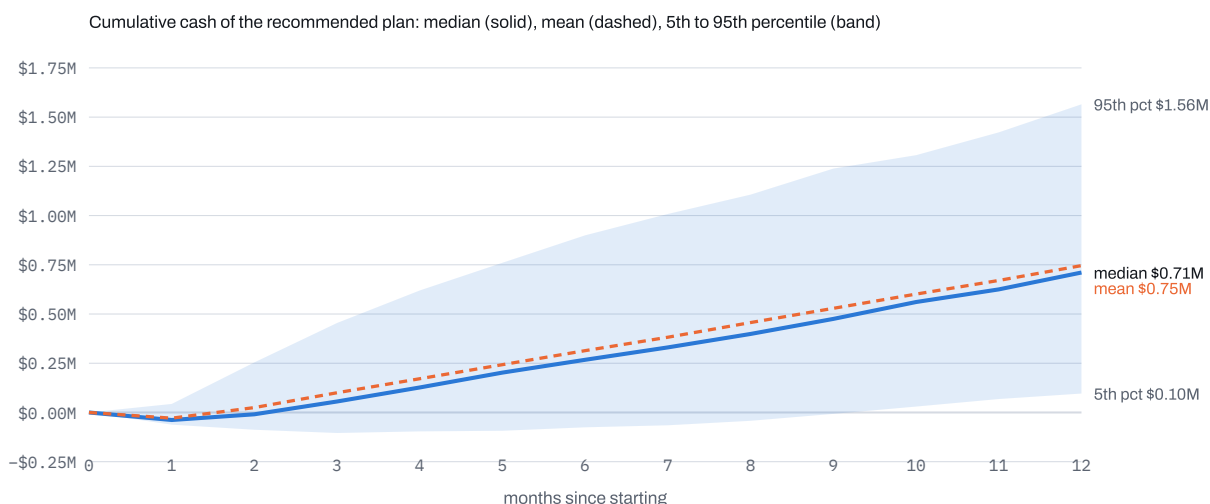
1,200 simulated first years per portfolio, each on its own new price paths (seeds from 100,000; the same seeds for every portfolio, so differences are paired). First year: total cash over 12 months ÷ 12, after every fee modelled. Sum of long-run rates: the accounts' renewal–reward values from Part II, a different quantity (8.5). Lowest cumulative cash: the deepest point of fees paid minus cash received.

Three quantities. The recommended portfolio's first year averages \$62,198 a month (±\$2,116); months 2–12 average \$70,488; the sum of its accounts' long-run rates is \$74,751. They answer different questions (8.5), and Section 28.6 measures the long-run rate of the portfolio itself. 98.0% of simulated first years ended ahead; the 5th percentile of first-year cash is \$96,538.

No account ever opposed another. In 8,400 simulated years the engine recorded 0 moments when two accounts held opposite positions on one market. The recommended plan places about 67 orders a trading day across all accounts.

Paired differences (same seeds, 95%): Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled) minus Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm): +\$9,715 ± \$525; Full allowance + The5ers' small New accounts minus Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled): +\$1,613 ± \$655; Recommended + futures layer minus Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm): +\$6,025 ± \$828; Tiers A and B minus Tier A only: +\$16,265 ± \$884; Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm) minus Tiers A and B: +\$20,627 ± \$1,324.

28.5 Month by month



1,200 simulated first years of the recommended plan (28 accounts), each on its own paths. Cash = payouts received minus fees paid.

Month	Mean cash	p10	median	p90	Cumulative mean	Ahead
1	-\$28,994	-\$55,584	-\$37,486	\$3,777	-\$28,994	11%
2	\$54,396	-\$32,397	\$20,313	\$190,273	\$25,402	46%
3	\$74,765	-\$28,363	\$39,072	\$228,143	\$100,168	66%
4	\$71,242	-\$30,394	\$36,990	\$217,548	\$171,410	76%
5	\$71,898	-\$31,109	\$34,167	\$239,087	\$243,308	82%
6	\$70,999	-\$30,330	\$39,940	\$215,539	\$314,308	87%
7	\$68,368	-\$29,816	\$28,991	\$226,751	\$382,676	91%
8	\$74,478	-\$27,109	\$43,981	\$215,603	\$457,153	93%
9	\$71,850	-\$29,690	\$34,328	\$227,220	\$529,003	95%
10	\$72,322	-\$28,778	\$34,972	\$227,228	\$601,326	96%
11	\$68,797	-\$29,624	\$32,775	\$204,906	\$670,123	97%
12	\$76,253	-\$28,022	\$38,160	\$231,530	\$746,375	98%

28.6 The long run, and what is left at month 12

Period (36-month lives)	Average cash per month (95%)
months 1–12	\$63,862 ± \$2,597
months 13–24	\$73,531 ± \$2,814
months 25–36	\$72,784 ± \$2,742
month 12 alone	\$76,236 ± \$7,749
months 11 and 13	\$78,137 and \$78,991

800 simulated 36-month lives of the recommended plan, each on its own new paths (path numbers 300,000 and up).

Months 13–36. They average $\$73,157 \pm \$1,974$ a month. That is a finite-window estimate, not by itself the asymptotic rate. Its two annual windows differ by $+\$747 \pm \$3,911$ a month (months 13–24 minus 25–36, paired over the same lives, 95%): no measurable trend, so the window average is read as an estimate of the long-run rate. The sum of the accounts' long-run rates from Part II is $\$74,751 \pm \$2,063$; the window average is $\$1,594$ lower (1.1 standard errors). The first year is lower ($\$63,862$) because it carries the start-up: fees at once, payouts later. **Value of the accounts open at month 12:** the cash those accounts (evaluations in progress and funded accounts) go on to pay after month 12 averages $\$168,447 (\pm \$12,509)$; it belongs to the first year's purchases but arrives later.

Each firm alone, on the same paths. On the first 200 of these lives, every firm's accounts were also run alone, on the same paths and calendar. This is a comparison of two policies, not a test of linearity: alone, a firm's account chooses its own direction where in the portfolio it copies the direction of an account already open, so the trades differ. Full portfolio minus the sum of the firms alone: $-\$1,700 \pm \$2,566$ a month over months 13–36 and $+\$595 \pm \$3,297$ in the first year (paired, 95%). Running the accounts together makes no measurable difference here. On those same paths the firms alone average $\$75,847$ a month, against the sum of their long-run rates in Part II of $\$74,751$: every account on the Nasdaq trades the same path, largely in the same direction, so their sampling errors move together and a sample of a few hundred lives can sit some thousands of dollars from the expectation.

28.7 Finite cash, higher costs, correlation, news and behaviour

A finite budget. The first-year figures assume every slot is refilled the moment its attempt ends, which needs cash for fees before payouts arrive. Version 6 quoted the median of the deepest cash shortfall as if it kept every slot filled; half of all years need more. Here the plan is run with a fixed starting budget instead: a purchase waits until the cash is there.

Starting cash	First year, EV/month	of unlimited	Evaluations bought in the year	Ahead at 12 months	First-year cash p5	Lowest cash left (mean)
\$5,000	\$11,327 ± \$4,021	19%	97	18%	-\$4,985	\$14
\$10,000	\$17,907 ± \$4,798	29%	147	28%	-\$9,989	\$11
\$20,000	\$27,517 ± \$5,597	45%	247	44%	-\$19,997	\$75
\$30,000	\$38,757 ± \$5,991	63%	334	62%	-\$29,992	\$736
\$50,000	\$52,210 ± \$6,139	85%	420	79%	-\$49,989	\$6,512
\$75,000	\$56,693 ± \$5,876	93%	472	88%	-\$74,981	\$20,511
\$100,000	\$59,009 ± \$5,720	96%	495	92%	-\$99,954	\$39,696
unlimited	\$61,227 ± \$5,422	100%	521	97%	\$53,088	–

The recommended plan with a finite budget: a purchase waits (checked daily) until the cash for it is there; payouts become spendable when they arrive. Slots are filled in order of value per fee dollar. 200 lives per row, same seeds in every row.

Other scenarios, each a full portfolio run on the baseline's seeds. The news-hours row is a stylised sensitivity (6.5), not a bound.

Scenario (recommended plan)	First year, EV/month	Paired difference to baseline	First-year cash p5	Lowest cumulative cash p5
Baseline (same 200 seeds)	\$61,227 ± \$5,422		\$53,088	-\$150,311
All trading costs × 1.5	\$52,910 ± \$4,996	-\$8,318 ± \$2,782	\$42,279	-\$154,009
All trading costs × 2	\$44,146 ± \$5,073	-\$17,082 ± \$2,822	-\$102,980	-\$182,319
Markets correlated 0.3 (one joint path)	\$61,080 ± \$5,137	-\$148 ± \$7,072	\$131,267	-\$127,536
News proxy: flat 12:00–14:00 UTC every weekday	\$57,114 ± \$5,003	-\$4,113 ± \$4,120	\$51,144	-\$150,735
FundedNext 1% risk (behavioural remedy)	\$60,002 ± \$5,454	-\$1,225 ± \$401	\$34,971	-\$154,286
FundedNext 7-day pause (behavioural remedy)	\$60,842 ± \$5,454	-\$386 ± \$414	\$52,566	-\$150,311

Full portfolio runs, 200 lives each on the baseline's seeds (paired). The correlated run uses joint paths, so its pairing is by seed only.

If payouts can be refused

Every firm keeps the right to refuse a payout it judges to break its rules. Nobody publishes how often it happens. This chapter turns that uncertainty into scenarios; it does not cover payouts lost because a firm judges the strategy itself to break a behavioural rule (Chapter 31.2), which would not be random.

29.1 A model

Suppose each payout request at a firm is refused with probability ϕ , independently, and a refusal ends your use of that firm. The number of paid requests before the first refusal is geometric, with mean $(1 - \phi)/\phi$. If the firm's requests arrive as a Poisson process at rate r a month (an assumption made for this illustration only), each of gross size a , the expected cash actually paid over H months is

PAID CASH UNDER REFUSALS

$$ar(1 - \phi) \frac{1 - e^{-\phi r H}}{\phi r} = arH \times (1 - \phi) \frac{1 - e^{-\phi r H}}{\phi r H},$$

the all-paid cash arH times the average survival fraction *and* the factor $(1 - \phi)$: the refused request itself is not paid. For n requests on a fixed schedule instead, the expected paid amount is $a(1 - \phi)[1 - (1 - \phi)^n]/\phi$. Neither formula is used for the figures below: the simulation applies the refusals to each life's actual dated payout requests. Fees paid while the firm is still used count against the paid cash. In the recommended plan the FTMO accounts together make about 1.00 requests a month: at $\phi = 2\%$, FTMO is expected to last $1/(0.02 \times 1.00) = 50$ months.

29.2 Tiers and scenarios

Tier	Evidence (4 October 2026)	Firms	Refusal chance per request: tiered harsh	
A	PropFirmMap A/A+, TrustPilot profile active	FTMO, FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, FundedNext, Topstep	2%	5%
B	PropFirmMap B+, TrustPilot active	Fintokei, Hola Prime, Apex	5%	10%
D	TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews; PropFirmMap D	Alpha Capital, FunderPro, GFT, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, Maven	15%	30%

Chosen scenarios, not measurements: public ratings do not calibrate refusal rates.

29.3 What it does to each portfolio

Portfolio	All payouts honoured	Tiered	kept	Harsh	kept
Tier A only	\$25,306	\$21,295	84%	\$16,544	65%
Tiers A and B	\$41,571	\$30,687	74%	\$22,361	54%
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	\$62,198	\$42,403	68%	\$28,593	46%
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	\$62,198	\$43,198	69%	\$29,752	48%
Full allowance (each firm at the largest allocation modelled)	\$71,913	\$41,648	58%	\$26,089	36%
Full allowance + The5ers' small New accounts	\$73,526	\$42,313	58%	\$25,610	35%
Recommended + futures layer	\$68,223	\$42,526	62%	\$27,611	40%

First-year average per month. Each payout request is refused with its firm's probability; the refused payout is not paid, and the person stops using that firm (no more fees or payouts there). Ten draws of refusals per simulated year.

Firm	Tier	Payout requests a month	Average request	Net cash a month	Expected months until a refusal (tiered)
FTMO	A	1.00	\$12,826	\$8,348	50
FundingPips	A	0.98	\$11,130	\$8,443	51
The5ers	A	0.23	\$15,333	\$2,650	218
FXIFY	A	0.74	\$5,776	\$2,788	67
FundedNext	A	0.19	\$20,352	\$2,398	259
Fintokei	B	1.38	\$12,215	\$12,099	14
Hola Prime	B	0.56	\$11,673	\$4,431	36
Alpha Capital	D	0.22	\$28,586	\$4,368	30
FunderPro	D	0.25	\$25,993	\$4,791	27
GFT	D	0.60	\$7,532	\$3,242	11
BrightFunded	D	0.17	\$34,687	\$3,972	40
Blue Guardian	D	0.29	\$18,976	\$3,524	23
Maven	D	0.55	\$3,165	\$1,144	12

Recommended plan, first-year averages from the portfolio simulation.

The recommended plan's accounts make about 7.2 payout requests a month. In the tiered scenario it keeps 68% of its first-year value, in the harsh one 46%. Under the 40% policy requests are smaller and more frequent than in version 6, so each firm is exposed to more requests; the scenarios price that.

PART IV

Running it

The settings of every account in one place, the routine that runs them, and everything that could make the numbers wrong.

The routine

30.1 Every account's settings

Programme	Accounts	Market	Risk per trade		Stop	Size	k	Payout target	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	4 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	$0.75 \sigma = 63.8$ points		\$23.52/pt	8	\$20,000	\$10,049
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	4 × 100K	USDJPY	\$1,750	$1.25 \sigma = 23.5$ pips		11.73 lots	12	\$20,000	\$9,917
The5ers HS Classic	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	$0.75 \sigma = 63.8$ points		\$23.52/pt	10	\$30,000	\$3,099
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,750	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$19.23/pt	12	\$15,000	\$2,097
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 50K	Nasdaq	\$875	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$9.62/pt	12	\$7,500	\$936
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 25K	Nasdaq	\$438	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$4.81/pt	12	\$3,750	\$458
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 10K	Nasdaq	\$175	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$1.92/pt	12	\$1,500	\$173
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 5K	Nasdaq	\$88	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$0.96/pt	12	\$750	\$71
FundedNext Stellar	1 × 200K	EURUSD	\$3,500	$1.25 \sigma = 12.0$ pips		29.18 lots	12	\$40,000	\$2,841
Fintokey ProTrader	5 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,750	$1 \sigma = 85.0$ points		\$20.58/pt	10	\$20,000	\$14,386
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	2 × 100K	gold	\$1,750	$1.03 \sigma = 12.2$ dollars		1.43 lots	6	\$20,000	\$4,826
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	$0.75 \sigma = 63.8$ points		\$54.88/pt	12	\$60,000	\$5,278
FunderPro Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$38.47/pt	8	\$60,000	\$5,976
GFT Standard	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	$1.07 \sigma = 91.0$ points		\$38.47/pt	3.5	\$30,000	\$3,558
BrightFunded Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	$1 \sigma = 85.0$ points		\$41.16/pt	12	\$60,000	\$5,208
Blue Guardian 2-Step	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	$1.25 \sigma = 106.3$ points		\$32.93/pt	4	\$30,000	\$4,469
Maven 2-Step	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	$1 \sigma = 85.0$ points		\$17.64/pt	3	\$4,900	\$1,409

Stops in points (Nasdaq), pips (USDJPY, EURUSD) or dollars (gold) at the prices of 2 October 2026; recompute $m\sigma \times \text{price}$ weekly and re-measure σ monthly. The take-profit is the smallest of k times the risk, the distance to the current target, 40% of the current target less today's profit, and any firm cap, plus the cost (4.1).

30.2 Placing a trade, step by step

- Is a trade allowed now?** Weekdays, inside the market's entry hours and not from 19:00 UTC onward; not before 00:05 UTC (after the midnight resets); no restricted news window for this firm, stage and market coming up before the trade could reasonably end (use the firm's own calendar); at least 10 minutes since this account's last close, whatever its result and direction (Hola Prime groups any re-entry within 10 minutes; FundingPips groups trade ideas).
- Direction.** If any of your accounts holds this market, the same direction. Otherwise the plan's rule: long if the last hourly close is above the close five hours earlier, short if below. The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its job is that no two of your accounts are ever opposite.
- Room.** Floor room = $(\text{balance} - \text{floor} - \$100 \text{ per } \$100\text{K}) / (1 + \rho)$; day room = $(\text{daily limit} - \text{today's loss} - \$200 \text{ per } \$100\text{K}) / (1 + \rho)$; margin room = $0.6 \lambda m\sigma \times \text{balance}$. If the floor room is under a tenth of the normal risk, **trade the rest**: one bracket whose stop sits at the floor itself (risk = balance – floor, net of cost, if the day room allows it, else the day room; one contract on futures). It either recovers or ends the account in a breach, which frees its allocation; buy the replacement only then. If only the day room is short, wait until tomorrow.
- Risk.** l = the smallest of the plan's risk and the three rooms. **Stop:** $m\sigma \times \text{price}$; size = $l / (\text{stop in points} \times \text{dollars per point per lot})$, rounded down (whole contracts on futures, never fewer than one: if one contract at this stop risks more than l , trade one contract if the floor and day rooms allow it).
- Take-profit.** w = the smaller of $k l$ and the distance to the current target (or today's profitable-day target), but never a take-profit closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations (finishing a little above a target is fine); then capped by 40% of the current target less today's profit (the whole calendar day's, including any made before a payout request today) and any firm cap (FXIFY 25% of the payout target per day less \$1 per \$100K, GFT's \$3,000 a day less today's profit, Maven: the distance to \$4,900 of funded profit less \$550 per \$100K for each profitable day the cycle still needs after today, and for today as well if this win would leave today short of +0.5%, and the distance to \$10,000 of closed profit in any 30 days). If a cap leaves less than the minimum distance: with nothing made today, lower the risk until the cap is a full minimum-distance win; otherwise no further trade today. At Maven, if $w < 1.5 l$, lower l to $w/1.5$. Distance = stop distance $\times (w + c)/l$.
- Place one bracket order;** never move it. **At 20:00 UTC close everything still open.**
- Log it:** time, account, market, direction, size, stop, target, fill, and the closing reason. The log is the evidence for any review.

30.3 Phases, payouts and refills

- When a phase target (plus \$20 per \$100K) is reached: stop. Where the firm counts trading days, place one minimal trade, held at least 2 minutes with a stop at most \$3 per \$100K away, on each of the next trading days not yet traded (at most five, so they cannot lose the \$20); where it counts profitable days, the daily target of 6.4 has met it.
- When a funded account reaches its payout target: stop, request the payout on the first allowed day (counted from the account's first trade), withdraw everything above the start, and start the next cycle. At Alpha Capital the first request also needs five trading days: until then trade at most once a day, past the target if needed. At Fintokey every request needs three trading days in the cycle (fillers allowed).
- When a payout date arrives before the target is reached, request whatever profit the account holds, if the firm's minimum (FundingPips 1% of the account; FXIFY \$50; Fintokey, GFT, FunderPro, Blue Guardian, Alpha \$100; The5ers \$150) and its consistency and day rules allow it (FXIFY: no day above 25% of it; profitable days at FundingPips 95%, GFT, Hola Prime, Maven, Blue Guardian), and start the next cycle; if a rule does not allow it, keep trading toward a target large enough for the rule to hold.

- When an account fails (a breach, including the last trade of step 3): buy the next evaluation of the same programme (at FundedNext, after a pause if its gambling indicators are a concern: 28.7). Every account ends in a breach or in normal trading; none is left open and unused.
- Credits (The5ers) are spent on the next evaluation at that firm.

30.4 Cash needed

Fees are paid before payouts arrive. In the simulation the running total of the recommended plan falls to −\$55,519 at its lowest in a typical first year, −\$136,974 in the worst 5% and −\$210,180 in the worst 1%. These are not amounts that keep every slot filled in every year: Section 28.7 runs the plan with fixed budgets, purchases waiting for cash, and shows what each budget gives.

30.5 Workload

About 67 bracket orders a trading day across 28 accounts, a daily close-out at 20:00 UTC, payout requests and evaluation purchases.

What could make the numbers wrong

31.1 Higher trading costs

Programme	Market	EV/month: cost × 1	× 1.5	× 2	Days per attempt × 1	× 2
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$2,215	\$1,888	\$1,590	17.0	15.6
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	USDJPY	\$2,629	\$2,237	\$1,970	27.1	24.9
The5ers HS Classic	Nasdaq	\$2,791	\$2,185	\$1,932	17.8	15.9
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	\$2,140	\$1,672	\$1,646	28.6	25.9
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	\$1,560	\$1,045	\$493	22.2	18.7
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	\$2,810	\$2,304	\$1,993	18.2	17.1
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	\$2,129	\$1,623	\$1,375	17.9	16.3
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	\$2,517	\$2,101	\$1,712	16.4	15.1
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	\$2,671	\$2,370	\$2,250	18.5	17.4
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	\$2,199	\$1,867	\$1,788	21.5	20.1
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	\$2,433	\$1,949	\$1,881	19.5	18.2
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$2,011	\$1,765	\$1,576	18.5	17.5
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$1,371	\$1,161	\$1,069	24.4	21.7

One 100K account at the plan's setting, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per cell, the same random numbers in each row. Higher costs lower the value of an attempt and also shorten attempts (more fail, sooner), which is why a value per month can fall less than proportionally.

For the whole recommended portfolio, full portfolio runs (not ratios) give \$52,910 a month at 1.5 times the costs and \$44,146 at twice, against \$62,198 (Section 28.7). **Measure your real costs in the first week** and redo the settings if they differ from 3.1 by more than a quarter.

31.2 Behavioural rules the model cannot state

These rules are applied at the firm's discretion. The figures in this document assume the plan's trading is not judged to break them; if it is, the affected payouts are lost, which is not the same as the random refusals of Chapter 29:

- **FTMO**: gambling, "all-in" trading, account rolling; no gap trading within 2 hours of a close.
- **Fintokei**: reaching a target in one or a few identical trades; token trades. The plan's three-winning-day minimum and minimal filler trades held 2 minutes are its answer.
- **The5ers**: one-trade target attainment (permanent ban). No trade makes more than 40% of a target.
- **FundedNext**: one-sided betting (remedy: a 1% risk limit), account rolling, several breached accounts in a short span (remedies: 40% consistency on on-demand rewards or a lower split). Section 28.7 measures the remedies.
- **Hola Prime**: profitability "materially dependent on concentrated outcomes". **Alpha**: "all or nothing", risk or loss of 2% or more, trades under 2 minutes on average, minimal lots to pass trading days. **FXIFY**: gambling. **Blue Guardian**: margin above 80%, holding under 2 minutes. **Maven**: large bets at 1:1.25 or worse. The terminal trade of step 3 is a normal bracket at the plan's reward:risk with a small risk; a firm could still read a final trade sized to the floor as deliberate, which the model cannot price.

31.3 Payouts refused, accounts closed

Chapter 29: \$42,403 a month if payouts are refused at 2/5/15% per request by tier, \$28,593 at 5/10/30%.

31.4 Spreads, gaps and news

The engine's cost is an average. Spreads widen at the daily break (now outside the plan's hours), at the open and around news. The news-hours sensitivity of Section 28.7 is a stylised scenario, not a bound: the model has no news calendar.

31.5 Rules change

Every rule in Part II was read on 4 October 2026, from the pages listed in Appendix E; rules_snapshot_v8.json quotes the sentences used. Leverage, consistency rules, payout schedules, prices and per-person limits change often. Recheck before buying and rerun the programme's optimisation (optimize_v8.py) when a rule that enters the model changes.

31.6 The model itself

- **Zero skill, zero drift**. If entries are systematically late or fills worse, the edge is negative; the cost stress is the guide. A real trend in a market (the Nasdaq's long-run rise) is left out of the model (3.2); the plan's direction rule is symmetric, but over a given year a trend can favour or hurt it.
- **Markets move together**. The baseline gives gold, euro and yen independent paths; Section 28.7 measures a correlation of 0.3. Real correlations change and rise in crises.
- **Taxes and payment costs** are not modelled.

31.7 What is not allowed, and is not in the plan

No hedging across accounts or firms; no accounts in anyone else's name; no copy-trading services or other people's signals; no trading of restricted news windows; no tick scalping, latency or gap arbitrage; no grid or martingale sizing; no deliberately failed accounts. Do not share or sell the plan: several firms treat traders who run the same marketed strategy as a group.

Corrections: the version 7 review, point by point

A second detailed review, of version 7 (4 October 2026), raised 27 findings. Every rule finding was checked on the firms' own pages (rules_snapshot_v8.json quotes the sentences) and every model finding against the code; 26 are agreed in full and 1 in part. The reviewer had the document but not the code, so for each finding the table says whether the error was in the model, in the text, or both. Fixing them uncovered the further errors of the second table.

#	Finding	What was wrong in version 7	What version 8 does
1	Being flat at the reset does not turn a share of the day's balance into a share of the initial balance AGREED	Version 7 applied every daily loss limit as a fixed share of the initial balance, except Fintokei's. FundingPips (4% of the higher of the day's opening balance and equity), The5ers (5% of the previous day's higher closing balance or equity; the firm's own example is \$5,500 at \$110,000), FXIFY (4% of the previous day's balance), GFT (5% subtracted from the higher of balance and equity), Hola Prime (5% of the previous day's closing balance), Maven (4% of the higher of equity and balance: 4% of \$1,100 in its example) and Alpha Capital (5% of the day's starting balance) all take the share of the day's level. Response 5's claim that flattening alone made the engine's limit the firm's was false for them. Section 6.2 also described FundingPips' base as the initial balance and its reset as Prague time; Blue Guardian was described as 'of the higher', where its rule subtracts a fixed 4% of the initial balance from the higher reset level.	Every programme now carries its base (acct_mc_dll_at): 'rel' (a share of the day's starting balance) for the seven firms above and Fintokei; 'fixed' for FTMO, FundedNext, BrightFunded and Blue Guardian; FunderPro, whose pages say only 'balance-based', takes the stricter of the two at every reset. The allowance is recomputed at every reset; tests_v8.py checks the FundingPips example (\$94,000 start: \$3,760). Section 6.2's table gives each base and reset time from the firms' pages. Measured on paths 141–144 (one 100K account, a month): FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%) \$2,231 with its own base against \$2,270 with a fixed one; FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%) \$1,324 with its own base against \$1,306 with a fixed one; FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%) \$2,629 with its own base against \$2,692 with a fixed one; FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%) \$1,478 with its own base against \$1,610 with a fixed one; The5ers HS \$2,540 with its own base against \$2,547 with a fixed one; The5ers HS Classic \$2,791 with its own base against \$2,775 with a fixed one; FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days) \$2,140 with its own base against \$1,973 with a fixed one; FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days) \$2,241 with its own base against \$2,319 with a fixed one; FXIFY Classic (80%) \$1,650 with its own base against \$1,718 with a fixed one; FXIFY Classic (80%) \$1,666 with its own base against \$1,513 with a fixed one; Fintokei ProTrader \$2,810 with its own base against \$2,475 with a fixed one; Hola Prime 2-Step Prime \$2,129 with its own base against \$2,075 with a fixed one; Hola Prime 2-Step Prime \$1,308 with its own base against \$1,416 with a fixed one; Alpha Capital Pro 10% \$2,517 with its own base against \$2,407 with a fixed one; GFT Standard \$2,199 with its own base against \$2,316 with a fixed one; GFT Standard \$2,013 with its own base against \$1,955 with a fixed one; FunderPro Classic \$2,671 with its own base against \$2,543 with a fixed one; FunderPro Classic \$2,457 with its own base against \$2,449 with a fixed one; Maven 2-Step \$1,371 with its own base against \$1,423 with a fixed one.
2	FXIFY Classic was given a fee refund AGREED	FXIFY's account-type comparison lists Classic as 'No Refund' and its September 2026 refund guide names Two Phase Standard, One Phase and Three Phase as the refunded programmes. Version 7 paid \$549 back with the first payout of every Classic account.	No refund on Classic at any size (firms_v8). The minimum payout of \$50 is added. The search, the final run and the portfolios were all rerun with it.
3	Fintokei ProTrader carried SwiftTrader's payout minimum and a profit threshold on its trading days AGREED	The 3% minimum belongs to SwiftTrader; ProTrader's minimum is \$100. ProTrader needs 3 separate trading days (a trade opened on the day, any result) per phase and before each payout, not 3 days of +0.5%. Section 6.4 presented the stricter reading as the firm's rule.	3 trading days per phase and per payout cycle (fillers allowed, as Fintokei counts any opened trade), minimum payout \$100, payouts 14 days after the first trade or the last payout. A \$100 minimum is a flat amount, so the 200K account is a scaled copy of the 100K only where the minimum does not bind; in the scaling test of Chapter 11 it never did (finding 17).
4	The5ers' Classic and New allowances AGREED IN PART	The engine already valued every small account under the New programme's contract (10% / 5%, New's fees) and the allocation (three each of 2.5K, 5K and 10K, one 25K, plus the plan's single 100K) fits New's limits and the shared large-account limit. The text, however, called them scaled Classic accounts and did not say which programme each slot belonged to.	Every small slot is labelled New High Stakes, with New's fee and targets; the one 50K/100K slot allowed across both programmes is the plan's 100K account. Classic's own small slots (one 2.5K, one 5K, one 10K or 25K) are left out because their fees could not be read on the firm's pages; the full-allowance value is therefore a value of this allocation, not a maximum.
5	Maven's consistency rule was misattributed and its funded-day requirement omitted AGREED	The FAQ requires three profitable days of at least 0.5% in the funded phase before a withdrawal, which version 7 left out. The 20% rule is the consistency score of Maven's instant accounts. Above \$5,000 of profit the best 'day' or single trade may not exceed 50% of the cycle's profit, where a 'day' is a run of trades with less than 24 hours between a close and the next opening: under daily trading a whole week is one such day. Response N6 said the 50% rule was absent.	Funded payouts need 3 profitable days (+0.5%); the 20% rule is removed; the plan never lets a Maven funded account's profit exceed \$4,900, \$100 under the threshold so that a take-profit filled a few points better than its price cannot bring the rule in (payout targets of 2–4.9% of 100K searched, wins capped at the distance to \$4,900), so the 50% rule never applies. tests_v8.py checks every trade of 400 attempts against the ceiling.
6	Maven's overflow rule cannot be met at the payout request AGREED	The \$10,000 per rolling 30 days is counted on the date profit is closed and the excess is voided. Waiting at the request cannot restore voided profit.	The engine keeps a ledger of closed trades and never places a trade whose full win could take the closed profit of any 30-day window containing it above \$10,000 (read as net profit before the split, the stricter reading). The check uses the largest suffix sum of the last 30 days, because a window's total rises when an old loss leaves it; a first version that checked only the current window failed the rule test and was corrected (n8 below).
7	Alpha Capital's first bi-weekly payout had no qualification gates AGREED	Alpha's first bi-weekly request needs 14 days from the first trade on the funded account, five trading days with the same strategy (a trade opened and closed on the day; minimal-lot fillers are not allowed) and \$100 of profit. Version 7 had only a 14-day wait from funding. Its source list pointed to the on-demand policy.	All three gates are in the engine; until the account has five trading days it places at most one trade a day and keeps trading past its cycle target. tests_v8.py checks that no first payout comes before five distinct trading days. The source is the bi-weekly page.
8	Two-minute fillers do not establish the duration rules for the strategy AGREED	Alpha's duration rule concerns the average trade, the majority of trades and the share of profit from trades over 2 minutes; Blue Guardian states a 2-minute minimum holding time for all trades. A bracket can reach a close target within 2 minutes; version 7 gave no evidence about the strategy's own trades.	Version 8 places no target and no stop closer than 0.6 hourly standard deviations to the entry, so even a trade at that distance is touched within 2 minutes with probability below 1 in 1,000; with one-minute sub-steps the engine records every trade's duration. Over every chosen programme: 362 of 20,955,242 trades (0.002%) may have closed within 2 minutes (the most in one programme: 0.007%, The5ers HS Classic); the shortest programme average is 102 minutes, and at most 0.005% of any programme's gross profit came from such trades. Where the plan's own target would have been closer, the target is set at the minimum distance and the account may finish slightly above its target.
9	Hola Prime's on-demand consistency rule was applied to the bi-weekly option AGREED	The 40% consistency score belongs to on-demand payouts; the bi-weekly option needs three profitable days in 14. Version 7 applied 40% as a payout gate and called it a compliance fix.	The 40% rule is removed from the bi-weekly programme; its three profitable days (+0.5%) stay. The plan's own 40% concentration policy still caps every trade and day.

#	Finding	What was wrong in version 7	What version 8 does
10	An entry at the next hour's open is not ten minutes after a close AGREED	A close at 12:59 followed by an entry at 13:00 broke the stated 10-minute rule, and Hola Prime groups any re-entry within 10 minutes, profitable or not.	With one-minute sub-steps the engine knows each exit's minute; an exit after minute 50 delays the next entry by one more hour. tests_v8.py measures the shortest gap between an exit and the next entry: 10382 consecutive trades: shortest time from an exit to the next entry 10 minutes. The routine waits 10 minutes after any close, at every firm.
11	Payout clocks and minimum amounts were not specified per firm AGREED	FTMO counts the first 14 days from the first trade, FundingPips likewise (and has a 1% minimum reward), Alpha needs its gates, Blue Guardian has a \$100 crypto minimum; version 7's engine counted from funding and left most minimums out.	Every funded account's first payout date now counts from its first trade (for the firms that state it; for the others this is at most hours later than funding, a slightly conservative choice), and each firm's minimum is in its rules: FundingPips 1%, FXIFY \$50, Fintokei, GFT, FunderPro, Blue Guardian and Alpha \$100, The5ers \$150. Each programme's table in Part II lists clock origin, cycle, eligible days and minimum.
12	Stopping an account does not free its allocation AGREED	Version 7 stopped trading an account near its floor and bought a replacement at once, although the old account was not breached and could still count against a per-person cap (FTMO's \$400,000, FXIFY's one account per size). Its text was also inconsistent about whether accounts were abandoned.	An account whose room above the floor is below a real trade now trades the rest: one last bracket with its stop at the floor itself (whole contracts on futures). It either recovers or ends in a breach, which closes the account and frees the allocation, with no request to the firm needed. The text, the engine and the chain use this one rule. tests_v8.py checks that every failed attempt ends exactly at the floor.
13	The 40% cap does not give three winning days before every payout AGREED	It does so for reaching a fixed target. A payout taken on its date before the target can rest on one winning day.	The claim is withdrawn for payouts; it stays for phases. Where a firm requires profitable days per payout (FundingPips 95%, GFT, Hola Prime, Maven, Blue Guardian in the stricter reading), they are rules of that programme in the engine.
14	Seed offsets collided across stages and markets AGREED	Paths were seeded with their number alone and other markets used offsets: gold's refine paths reused the random numbers of yen's grid paths, gold's final paths those of yen's refine and euro's grid paths, and inside the portfolio a life's yen path was another life's Nasdaq path.	Every path is drawn from its own numpy SeedSequence stream, keyed by path number, market group, length, sub-steps per hour and correlation. streams_v8.py lists every stream of every stage and checks that independent stages share none (8,501 streams over 8 stages, no clash); the only shared streams are the paired designs it names. Everything was rerun.
15	Independent maxima and minima are not an exact Brownian bridge AGREED	Version 7 called the sub-step extremes exact marginals (true) but drew the maximum and minimum independently, which misstates the chance that one sub-step reaches both levels; its effect was not bounded.	The joint law differs from the product of the marginals only through events where one sub-step's path spans a whole bracket, whose probability is at most $e^{-W^2/v}$ for a bracket of width W and sub-step variance v . Version 8 uses one-minute sub-steps and stops of at least 0.6 sd, so this is at most $e^{-60m^2} < 5 \times 10^{-10}$ per minute of a trade; the engine adds the bound up over every trade: at most 1.9e-48 per trade over every chosen programme's final run, i.e. no trade's outcome probabilities differ from an exact bridge by more than that. Section 3.3 now says the construction is exact up to that bound.
16	The tie tests did not bound the bias at 0.25 percentage points AGREED	Two of version 7's own cells were +0.32 and +0.29 points at $z = 2.3$, so the stated bound did not follow, and averaging cells of opposite sign bounds nothing.	The claim is withdrawn. Version 8 tests convergence at the tightest stop the plan allows (0.6 sd) with 12, 60 and 240 sub-steps per hour on six independent paths per cell, and reports each cell with its interval (Chapter 11): $k = 1$: -0.09 ± 0.28 , -0.08 ± 0.35 , $+0.04 \pm 0.28$ points at 12/60/240; $k = 2$: -0.02 ± 0.87 , $+0.01 \pm 0.52$, -0.09 ± 0.40 points at 12/60/240; $k = 3$: -0.34 ± 0.51 , -0.06 ± 0.79 , -0.16 ± 0.55 points at 12/60/240; $k = 6$: -0.01 ± 0.27 , -0.24 ± 0.66 , -0.03 ± 0.56 points at 12/60/240. The bound of finding 15 is the guarantee for the settings used.
17	The exact Fintokei scaling claim contradicted the fee table AGREED	The test set the 200K fee to twice the 100K fee, so it tested that the trading rules scale, not the real contracts (\$1,249 against $2 \times \$549$).	Chapter 11 runs the test twice and labels each: with the fee doubled (the rules) and with the firm's real 200K fee (the contracts). The scaling test, twice. Rules: with the 200K fee set to twice the 100K fee, a 200K attempt equals twice the matching 100K attempt, path by path, for FTMO, The5ers, Fintokei (largest difference \$0.00 over 4,500 pairs). GFT is not exact, because its \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap are flat amounts: \$1,394 per 100K at 200K against \$1,515 at 100K. Contracts: with the firms' real 200K fees, FTMO \$1,845 per 100K at 200K against \$1,845 at 100K (fee \$1,215.65 against $2 \times \$607.82$); Fintokei \$1,454 per 100K at 200K against \$1,519 at 100K (fee \$1,249.00 against $2 \times \$549.00$); GFT \$1,424 per 100K at 200K against \$1,515 at 100K (fee \$974.00 against $2 \times \$524.00$) (The5ers sells no 200K account of this programme, so its 200K row checks the rules only.) The fee difference is the whole of the gap where the rules scale; 27.2 values it.
18	Worked examples and minimum-stop prose conflicted with the policy AGREED	FXIFY's funded example showed a \$10,500 win where its 25% best-day rule caps it at \$7,500; Maven's showed $w = \$2,000$ against $l = \$1,750$, below its own 1:1.5 minimum; the FunderPro and GFT sheets kept a 0.92 sd minimum stop that is correct only at 1.5% risk (at 1.75%, 1:30 and a 20% cap, or 1:10 and 60%, it is 1.066).	Every worked trade is now computed with every cap the engine applies (concentration, best day, day cap, ceiling, minimum target distance) and with Maven's risk lowered to $w/1.5$; minimum stops in the rule sheets are computed from the chosen risk, leverage and cap.
19	7/5 calendar days per missing day is not a weekday calendar AGREED	Version 7 added 1.4 calendar days per missing filler day, an average.	Filler days are found on the path's own calendar (the next days with a permitted entry hour not yet traded). tests_v8.py: a target reached on a Friday gets its two fillers on Monday and Tuesday. The routine places each filler with a stop of at most \$3 per \$100K, so at most five fillers cannot lose the \$20 margin.
20	The fixed-hours news test is a sensitivity, not a bound AGREED	Blacking out 12:00–14:00 UTC does not contain every restricted release, and removing trading time has no proven monotone effect on cash per month.	It is now called a stylised news-hours sensitivity. The headline is a model without a news calendar; the routine uses the firms' real calendars, which the model does not reproduce.
21	The calendar model does not give i.i.d. renewals, and months 13–36 are not an asymptotic rate AGREED	An attempt's start state includes the weekday, the hour, credits and rolling windows, so attempts are not independent and identically distributed; and the 36-month average is a finite-window estimate.	Section 8.3 now rests the ratio on a Markov renewal argument: the attempt sequence is driven by a finite-state calendar chain plus independent price increments, and the long-run rate is the ratio of the stationary means, which the engine estimates by running attempts back to back on long paths. The months 13–36 figure is labelled as that window's average, and the two annual windows are compared with a paired interval: months 13–24 minus 25–36 +\$747 $\pm$ \$3,911 a month over 800 lives.
22	The standalone comparison changes the direction policy; linearity does not predict equality AGREED	Run alone, a firm's account takes its own direction where in the portfolio it copies another account's, so the two runs are different policies; and four synchronised 100K accounts are not smoother than two 200K accounts.	The check is presented as a policy comparison on the same paths, with its measured difference and no appeal to linearity; the smoothing claim is removed (four 100K and two 200K FTMO accounts give the same cash in the model).

#	Finding	What was wrong in version 7	What version 8 does
23	The general withdrawal identity needs a term for forfeited profit AGREED	With profit removed from the account without being paid (a day-cap deduction, voided overflow), $\mathbb{E}[W] = -\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[K] - \mathbb{E}[Q]$.	Section 7.1 states the identity with Q , and why $Q = 0$ under the plan: wins are capped below GFT's day cap and inside Maven's windows, and no position is open through a gap.
24	Smaller statements without their conditions AGREED	Wald's identity as stated lacked the i.i.d. or martingale-difference condition (the review's counterexample has mean-zero steps and a stopped mean of 1/2); equal long and short counts do not make drift irrelevant; a \$1 minimum win can pass the target; a \$20 buffer alone bounds no filler loss; the refusal formula needs Poisson requests.	Each is restated with its condition: Wald for i.i.d. integrable steps, or for steps whose conditional mean given the past is fixed, with $\mathbb{E}[\tau] < \infty$ and bounded conditional absolute means; zero drift as a modelling assumption, with direction chosen symmetrically; the minimum win now allows a small overshoot that the chain and the engine both count; fillers with stops of at most \$3; the Poisson assumption stated at the formula, with the deterministic-schedule form next to it.
25	The futures conversion is valid only at the reference price AGREED	Version 7 valued one micro contract at 31,070 index points throughout, although the normalised path moves; at a path level of 125 a contract risks a quarter more.	Every entry converts the path's price to the index level, $31,070 \times \text{price} / 100$, before rounding to whole contracts (<code>pathfirm.contract_value</code>); the smallest trade is one contract at that price. <code>tests_v8.py</code> checks the scaling.
26	Audit and reproducibility claims exceeded the materials AGREED	The review had the PDF and the response but no repository, no environment, no stream manifest and no dated rule snapshots; some sources were bare domains or secondary summaries.	The code, the results and the document sources are in the repository (github.com/astrafala/Monthly-EV-Maxxing); <code>environment_v8.json</code> gives the versions, <code>stream_manifest_v8.json</code> every stream, <code>rules_snapshot_v8.json</code> the quoted sentences behind every rule input with its URL and date, and <code>tests_v8.json</code> the rule tests. Appendix E lists exact pages; where only secondary sources were available (FunderPro's number of minimum days) it says so.
27	Remaining text contradictions AGREED	Fintokei's and Alpha's sheets said 1.5% risk where the plan uses 1.75%; Apex's engine row said 'at most 50%' where the rule is strictly less; the FTMO caption pointed to a table without its chosen 1.5% setting; 'all firms at full allowance' was used for two different portfolios.	Each is corrected; the two portfolios are named 'full allowance' and 'full allowance plus The5ers' small New accounts' everywhere.

Further errors found while fixing the review's findings

#	Further error	What it was, and the fix
n1	FunderPro Classic has minimum trading days	Version 7 modelled none. FunderPro sells a 'No Minimum Trading Days' add-on for Classic only, so Classic has a default minimum; review sites give 4 per phase, which version 8 uses (the official pages read do not state the number). Its minimum reward of \$100 is added.
n2	GFT's 3% minimum belongs to on-demand rewards	Version 7 required 3% of profit for every GFT payout; the 3% is the first on-demand reward's condition. The bi-weekly minimum is \$100.
n3	Blue Guardian's payout days	Blue Guardian's payout requirements include completing 'the minimum trading days requirement'. Version 7 had no funded-day rule; version 8 takes the stricter reading, 3 profitable days (+0.5%) per payout.
n4	Trading days were counted on the wrong day	A trade requested in the evening but opened after the night counted toward the day of the request in version 7; days now count on the day the trade opens.
n5	Hourly and sub-step extremes in different precision	Version 7 stored sub-step extremes in single precision and hourly ones in double, so a level at the edge could be inside the hour and outside every sub-step; both are double now.
n6	The tie fallback used the entry's geometry	When a stop and a target fall inside one sub-step, the engine draws the winner with the trade's overall chance $l/(l+w)$, which is not the conditional chance from the sub-step's position. With one-minute sub-steps such sub-steps are covered by the bound of finding 15.
n7	Worked examples left out the funded best-day cap	Beyond the two the review named, every programme's trade example now applies all funded caps the engine applies and the minimum target distance.
n8	A rolling cap checked on the current window only	Found by <code>tests_v8.py</code> in version 8's own first implementation of Maven's overflow rule: a window's net profit grows when an old loss leaves it, so checking the current window at entry let later windows exceed \$10,000. The check now covers every window that will contain the trade.
n9	A cap below the minimum target distance stopped an account for ever	Found during version 8's own grid search: when a rule cap was smaller than the smallest allowed win at full risk (the plan's 40% of a 4% GFT payout target at the tightest USDJPY stop; Maven's small payout targets and its ceiling while profitable days were still missing), the first version 8 engine never traded and the account waited indefinitely (7 GFT settings and every Maven setting gave attempts of thousands of days). The engine now lowers the risk until the cap is a full minimum-distance win when nothing has been made that day, the chain does the same, the affected settings were rerun, and a stall detector, which ends and counts any account that can do nothing for 120 days, reads zero in every reported run.
n10	Maven: the fix for n9 still left ways to wait for ever	Found by the stall detector after the fix for n9, in four steps. (a) The refine stage extended the search past the top of each payout-target grid; for Maven that proposed a \$10,000 target, above the plan's own ceiling. Maven's grid already ends at the ceiling and is no longer extended. (b) The smaller trade of n9 was allowed only when the cap was at least half the minimum-distance win, an arbitrary limit: at a \$2,000 payout target the plan's 40% daily cap is \$800, below half the minimum win at a 1.75% risk and a 0.6 sd stop, and 65 of 300 accounts at that setting waited for ever. The only limit now is the market's smallest position (one futures contract; none for CFDs), in the engine and in the chain alike. (c) The room kept under the ceiling for the profitable days still needed was one day short once today had already counted, and a day that opened with a loss and was then cut by the ceiling ended below the \$500 of a profitable day, so one account in 2,000 reached the ceiling a profitable day short and could never be paid. The reserve is now exact: a win that makes today a profitable day keeps $1.1 \times \$500$ for each day still needed after today; a win that does not also keeps it for today, and is cut or waits for tomorrow. (d) An interim version raised a win to complete the day's amount without raising its risk; near the floor that gave take-profits thousands of times the stop distance, and it was removed. Every Maven setting was searched again (336 settings, 2,000 attempts each, no stall), and <code>tests_v8.py</code> now replays the account of (c) on its own path and seed.

#	Further error	What it was, and the fix
n11	Futures: no trade when one contract risked more than the planned risk	Found by the stall detector in the final validation. On a twelve-year synthetic path the Nasdaq rose 5.7-fold, and one micro contract at the planned stop then risked up to \$969 against the plan's \$600; the engine allowed neither fewer than one contract nor more than the planned risk, so funded Apex accounts on that path stopped trading (9 of 24,000 attempts). The plan now trades one contract when the rooms allow it, which is what whole-contract sizing does. The evaluation engine's loop limit, which had ended a few Topstep attempts silently as failures (all caused by n12), now counts as a stall too, and none occurs.
n12	Trades decided after the daily cut-off were booked to the wrong day	Found while tracing n11; versions 7 and 8's first engine alike. When the engine decided a trade after the 19:00 UTC cut-off, on a weekend or before a closure, the trade waited for the next open but its result was booked to the day it was decided; the next day's loss allowance and profit caps then started again from zero, after that trade. Between 9% and 22% of trades were affected, depending on the programme: the plan's 40% day cap was exceeded on such days, and a day's realized loss could in principle exceed a firm's daily limit. Every trade is now decided on the day it opens, with that day's limits (the engine moves to the next entry before deciding), in the single-account engine and in the portfolio simulation alike. All of version 8's searches and simulations were run again with the corrected engine.
n13	A payout reset the day's profit, and FXIFY's check had a dollar of slack	Found by the new daily-limits test; versions 7 and 8's first engine alike. The funded engine kept one figure for the day's profit and set it to zero at every payout, because the next cycle's profitable days must not count profit made before the request. But the day caps are calendar-day limits: after a payout requested mid-day, GFT's \$3,000 cap and the plan's 40% cap restarted, and one GFT day made \$3,900. The engine now keeps two figures, the calendar day's profit (for every day cap and best-day measure, never reset by a payout) and the part since the payout (for counting the cycle's profitable days). FXIFY's best-day check at a request tolerated a best day up to 25 cents per \$100K above the 25% limit; it is now exact, and the plan keeps each FXIFY day \$1 per \$100K under the limit. tests_v8.py checks every day's loss against the firm's allowance and every day's profit against the caps, days taken from each trade's own entry time, and every FXIFY payout against its best day.
n14	The chain comparison could stall at Maven's ceiling	Found by the stall counts of the verification stage. The engine run that is compared with the chain (Chapter 11) pays only at the payout target, as the chain does; a Maven trade closed at a fair price within \$1 of the ceiling left no room for the smallest win and no payout, and 4 of 12,000 attempts waited for ever (a first fix covered only the last 50 cents and left one). In that comparison the band is now the target, as in the chain; the plan's own engine, which pays whatever profit there is on the payout date, was not affected.
n15	Maven's ceiling had no margin	Found by the end-of-run audit (audit_v8.py), which replays every chosen setting trade by trade: Maven accounts reached exactly \$5,000 of profit. That is within the rule (it applies above \$5,000), but a take-profit filled a few points better than its price, which brokers allow, would take the account over and bring in the 50% rule, which a cycle traded daily cannot meet. The plan now keeps Maven's profit at or below \$4,900 and searches payout targets up to 4.9%. The audit also shows days that end exactly at GFT's \$3,000 cap and 30-day windows exactly at Maven's \$10,000: there a better fill costs only the cents above the cap, which are deducted or voided, so those caps keep no margin.
n16	Portfolio payouts were recorded when an account ended	Found by the stall counts of the portfolio simulation; version 7's portfolio engine alike. The portfolio engine wrote an account's payouts to the ledger only when the account ended, with their dates. The dates were right, but (a) a finite budget received the cash only when the account ended, so the budget scenarios made purchases wait for money that had already arrived, and (b) an account still open at the end of a life had to be traded on, on the wrapped price path, until it ended: a funded Topstep account, whose floor locks at the start after the first payout, could run to the loop limit (10 accounts in 8,400 lives, counted as stalls; nothing after the horizon entered a figure). Payouts are now written, and reach the budget, on the day they are paid, and accounts are no longer simulated a month after the end of a life; every portfolio stage was run again.

The version 6 review, in brief

Version 7 answered a 35-point review of version 6 (34 points agreed, one in part) and found 11 further errors. The main changes it made: no bold play (no trade or day above 40% of a target), flat every day by 20:00 UTC, risk sized net of cost, margin checked at every entry, FTMO risk at most 1.5%, FunderPro's funded margin rule, GFT's flat day cap, Maven's rules as then read, the corrected zero-cost example, the exact chain with the floor rule, Student-t cluster intervals and the separation of first-year, later-month and long-run figures. The full response is docs/v7_review_response.md and Appendix A of version 7 (docs/archive).

Formula sheet

Quantity	Formula	Exact for	Where
Value of one attempt	$\mathbb{E}[V] = \Pr(\text{pass}) \mathbb{E}[C] + \text{credits} - F$	always	1.2
Zero-cost example	$-F + P(\alpha D + qR), q = D/(D + X)$	idealised model	1.3
Notional, target distance	$N = l/(m\sigma), u = m\sigma(w + c)/l$	always	4.1
Win probability, mean, variance	$p = l/(l + w + c); -c; l(w + c)$	fixed cost, binary outcome	4.2–4.3
Cost per unit of risk	$\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$	always	4.4
Pass probability, no cost	$B/(A + B)$	exact landing on A or $-B$	5.1
Pass probability with cost	$(e^{\theta B} - 1)/(e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1), \theta = 2c/v$	approximation	5.2
Risk of the next trade; the terminal trade	$l = \min(L, (x + B - b)/(1 + \rho), \dots)$; if that is $< l_{\min}$: $l = \min((x + B)/(1 + \rho), \text{today's room})$, stop at the floor; on futures at least one contract	the plan's rule	5.4
Exact chain	$V(x) = pV(x + w) + (1 - p)V(x - l - c)$, and N, K, T	binary trades, per-trade caps	5.5
Accounting identity	$P\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \text{pass}] + (1 - P)\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \text{fail}] = -\mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$; with every failure at $-B$: $P = (B - K)/(\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \text{pass}] + B)$	bounded stopped sum, mean of each trade $-c$	5.5
Two phases	$P = P_1 \Pr(2 1); = P_1 P_2$ in the model	always / model	6.1
Withdrawal identity	$\mathbb{E}[W] = -\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}] - \mathbb{E}[Q], Q = \text{profit forfeited}$	cycle-by-cycle stopping	7.1
Funded cash, cycle form	$\alpha(X_1 q_1 + X q_1 q/(1 - q)) + R q_1 q^{r-1}$	repeated cycles	7.2
Two special first cycles (GFT)	$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid}] = q_a + q_a^2/(1 - q_b)$	repeated cycles	7.2
Trade duration	$m^2(w + c)/l$	approximation (arithmetic motion)	8.1
Value per month	$30.44 \mathbb{E}_{\pi}[V]/\mathbb{E}_{\pi}[T_{\text{days}}]$	long-run rate (Markov renewal)	8.3
Cluster-robust variance of a ratio	$\frac{G}{G-1} \sum_g (V_g - \hat{r}T_g)^2 / (\sum_g T_g)^2$	independent clusters	8.4
Margin at entry	$l \leq 0.6 \lambda m\sigma(S + x)$	the plan's rule	10.2
Scaling an account	$\mathbb{E}[V(\lambda S)] = P[\lambda G(S) + q_R R(\lambda S)] - F(\lambda S)$	scale-free rules	27.2
Paid cash under refusals	$ar(1 - \phi)(1 - e^{-\phi r H})/(\phi r)$; n scheduled requests: $a(1 - \phi)(1 - (1 - \phi)^n)/\phi$	Poisson requests; a fixed schedule	29.1

Glossary

Terminal trade	The last bracket of an account whose room above the floor is too small for a normal trade: its stop sits at the floor, so the account recovers or ends in a breach (5.4).
Allowance D	The funded account's maximum loss: the floor sits D below the starting balance.
Attempt	One evaluation bought, from purchase until a phase fails or the funded account that followed it ends.
Bold play	Staking enough on each bet to reach the goal in one win; not used by the plan (5.6).
Bracket	A position with its stop-loss and take-profit attached at entry and never moved.
Concentration policy	No trade and no day above 40% of the current target (6.7).
Daily flat	No entry from 19:00 UTC, everything closed at 20:00 UTC (6.5).
Engine	The rule-by-rule simulation of an account on hourly price paths (acct_mc.py, pathfirm.py, lockstep.py).
Exact chain	The trade-level Markov chain of 5.5, solved by iteration (analytic_v8.py).
Stream	The random numbers of one synthetic path, keyed by path number, market, length and sub-steps (3.3; stream_manifest_v8.json).
Payout target X	The profit at which a funded account stops and requests a payout.
Renewal-reward	The long-run value per unit time of a repeated process: $\mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T]$.
Slot	One account position at one firm, refilled with a new evaluation whenever an attempt ends.
Tier	A firm's reliability class (A, B, D) from public evidence, used for the refusal scenarios.
Winner's curse	The upward bias of the best of many noisy estimates; removed by reporting every figure from paths not used to choose it.

How every number was computed

File	What it does
<code>calibrate.py</code> , <code>sigma_v32.json</code>	costs and trading hours per market; hourly volatilities
<code>multi.py</code> , <code>pathfirm.py</code>	synthetic price paths (one-minute Brownian-bridge sub-steps, one random stream per path and market) and the bracket trader (exit minutes, the 10-minute gap, futures at the path's price, duration statistics)
<code>acct_mc.py</code>	the rule engine: phases, funded accounts, payouts, daily-loss bases, the terminal rule, cost-aware sizing, concentration, minimum target distance, margin, payout clocks and gates
<code>firms_v3.py</code> , <code>firms_v5.py</code> , <code>firms_v7.py</code> , <code>firms_v8.py</code>	every firm's rules; <code>firms_v8</code> holds the version 8 inputs and the plan's policies
<code>rules_snapshot_v8.json</code>	the sentences from the firms' pages behind every rule input, with URLs and date
<code>optimize_v8.py</code>	grid (paths 101–104), refine (111–114), futures, final (121–136) → <code>opt_v8_*.json(l)</code>
<code>analytic_v8.py</code>	the exact chain with the terminal rule and the minimum target distance, written separately from the engine
<code>tests_v8.py</code> → <code>tests_v8.json</code>	direct tests of every new rule mechanism of the engine
<code>streams_v8.py</code> → <code>stream_manifest_v8.json</code>	every random stream of every stage; fails if two independent stages share one
<code>verify_v8.py</code> , <code>sens_v8.py</code>	checks against theory, sub-step convergence, scaling; cost, risk, concentration, flat, daily-loss base and direction sensitivities
<code>lockstep.py</code> , <code>lockstep_portfolio_v8.py</code>	one person's accounts on one calendar; portfolios, 36-month lives, budgets, stress, correlation, news hours, behaviour
<code>progs_v8.py</code> , <code>review_v8.py</code>	the firms' written rules and sources; the review response
<code>build_math_v8.py</code> , <code>doc8_*.py</code> , <code>math_v8_*.html</code>	this document: every number is read from the files above
<code>rerun_v8.sh</code> , <code>environment_v8.json</code>	the whole pipeline after the grid, in order; the software versions used

The repository: github.com/astrafala/Monthly-EV-Maxxing. To reproduce: `python3 optimize_v8.py grid`, then `sh rerun_v8.sh`, then `python3 build_math_v8.py`. Synthetic paths are rebuilt exactly from their stream keys and `sigma_v32.json`; no market data is needed. Every key and seed is fixed in the code; with the versions in `environment_v8.json` every figure reproduces exactly (other platforms may differ in the last digits of floating-point sums). Version 8 uses no real-history run: one two-year history is one sample, and its attempts are not independent validations.

Sources

Programme	Sources (read 4 October 2026; rules_snapshot_v8.json quotes them)
FTMO 2-Step Challenge	ftmo.com/en/faq/how-do-i-withdraw-my-profits/ (first reward 14 days after the first trade); ftmo.com/faq/how-many-accounts-can-i-have/ (\$400,000 per trader); https://ftmo.com/en/blog/how-much-should-you-risk-on-one-trade/; ftmo.com (trading objectives, forbidden practices)
FundingPips 2-Step Flex	https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/47835196271249-2-Step-Flex (2 Step Flex, read 4 Oct 2026); https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/48174287980177-Risk-Per-Trade-Idea (Risk Per Trade Idea; Profit Concentration Policy)
The5ers High Stakes	the5ers.com/faqs/what-is-the-drawdown-rule-for-high-stakes/; the5ers.com/faqs/how-many-high-stakes-accounts-can-i-have/; the5ers.com/high-stakes/
FXIFY Two Phase Classic	intercom.help.fxify/en/articles/12130186-2-phase-account-types (refunds by type); intercom.help.fxify/en/articles/14834680-the-2-phase-classic-account; fxify.com/blog/cheapest-path-funded-50k-fxify/ (refund guide, 14 September 2026)
FundedNext Stellar 2-Step	https://help.fundednext.com/en/articles/9430123-is-there-a-minimum-trading-day-and-profit-target-in-the-fundednext-account-of-the-stellar-2-step-model; help.fundednext.com (copy trading; prohibited strategies)
Fintokei ProTrader	https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538826-how-are-the-daily-loss-limit-and-maximum-loss-limit-calculated; support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538884 (withdrawals, minimum amount); support.fintokei.com/en/articles/8428030 (minimum trading days); https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/9464503-what-is-all-in-trading-and-why-is-it-forbidden-to-achieve-profit-target-in-one-trade
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	holaprime.com/forex/faq/hola-prime-challenges/hola-prime-2-step-prime-challenge/
Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%	help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/10570531-bi-weekly-performance-fee; https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8447268-what-is-the-2-minute-average-trade-duration-rule; help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8420429-alpha-pro-8-10
FunderPro Classic	https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/421458-is-there-a-margin-rule-on-funded-accounts; support.funderpro.com/en/articles/419844 (rewards, \$100 minimum); support.funderpro.com/en/articles/412020 (add-ons); https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/422676-leverage-on-funderpro-challenges
Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard	help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/13575169-2-step-standard; help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/9549359-all-about-rewards-and-profit-splits; https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/10742107-what-is-goat-guard
BrightFunded 2-Step Classic	https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-what-are-the-current-rules-for-the-evaluation-process; help.brightfunded.com (refund add-on)
Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard	help.blueguardian.com/en/articles/14062291-2-step-standard-rules
Maven 2-Step	https://maventrading.com/faqs (read 4 Oct 2026)
Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)	https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy; help.topstep.com (pricing)
Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)	https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/eod-trailing-drawdown-accounts/eod-payouts/; apextraderfunding.com help centre

Reliability evidence: TrustPilot company pages (rating-withheld notices, August–September 2026) and PropFirmMap safety grades, both read on 4 October 2026. Rules change; keep dated copies of the pages that apply to each purchase.